

THE CLEAN GOSPEL OF MARK

A Passage by Passage Commentary on the Earliest Gospel Using Quranic Verses

Mohammad F Islam

The Quran corrects the prophets it names and does not soften the corrections, and four of the five figures it says were given a book carry heavy records. The fifth, ʿĪsā AS, carries none. Beside him stands Yaḥyā AS, of whom the negation is stated outright rather than merely omitted. This commentary takes that asymmetry as its starting point, reads the one passage in which the corpus interrogates ʿĪsā AS directly and finds it returns clean, and argues that the silence is a guard rather than an elevation; it is what makes the servanthood declared from the cradle a thing chosen rather than a thing conceded. From that position the commentary sets out the Quranic account of ʿĪsā AS as an inventory, and reports that what the corpus removes from the received Christian picture is two things, generation and number, while it retains the conception without a father stated four times, the messianic title eleven times, word from Him, spirit from Him, the threefold strengthening, the miracles with their permission-clause, the taking and the raising, and a place among the five of the solemn covenant. It shows that the constructions the corpus condemns are three and are identifiable by grammar, and that the sentence at John 1:1 uses none of them. The Gospel of Mark is then read continuously, chapter by chapter, from that position. Each of eighteen sections quotes the Gospel, reads it against the Quran, and then tests whether the passage holds together as a structure. Twenty-three readings close and two do not, and the two that do not are exhibited rather than passed over. Seven places where the Quranic reading would correct the Gospel are named, four of them the same operation the corpus performs on itself.

THE FINDING IN BRIEF

For fourteen centuries the Quran and the Gospel have been read as opposite accounts of the same figure. This commentary reports that on the evidence of the two texts themselves, they are not.

The Quran corrects its prophets and does not soften the corrections. Adam forgot. Noah asked for what he had no right to know. Abraham confessed a fault in his own prayer. Moses killed a man and asked for a sight he was refused. Jonah ran. David was forgiven a named thing. Solomon was corrected by a bird. Muhammad, peace be upon him, was corrected by revelation seven times, itemised in Part I, and twice told to seek forgiveness for his own offence.

Two figures carry nothing, and each is distinctive in a different way. Most of the prophets the Quran names appear briefly and carry no fault because there is no narrative in which one could be recorded. Nothing follows from that. The class that carries information is those the Quran treats at length, and the sharpest line inside it is those given a book. There are five.

Jesus is the only bearer of a scripture in the whole corpus with a clean file. Four of the five who were given a book carry heavy records. He carries nothing: not a rebuke, not a lapse, not a line.

And of John the Baptist the negation is stated outright. He was not a tyrant, not disobedient. The Quran does not merely omit a fault for him; it says there was none, using the same word it uses of Adam's disobedience and of Aaron's. And it marks his name as unprecedented, then closes his blessing on the word for living.

The silence is not an elevation. It is a guard. Had a fault been recorded, the servanthood would have been proved by deficiency: a servant because he could not be more. Instead the Quran has him declare himself a servant from the cradle, before anything else is said about him, and states one verse later that the Messiah does not disdain to be a servant. Disdain presupposes a height. The silence is what makes the servanthood chosen rather than conceded.

What the Quran actually removes from the received Christian picture is two things. Begetting, in the biological sense, which it denies by asking how there could be offspring with no consort. And number, which it forbids in the same verse in which it supplies three names for one referent: messenger, word from Him, spirit from Him, and then, do not say three.

What it keeps is nearly everything else. The conception without a father, stated four separate times in four surahs. The title Messiah, eleven times, and never withdrawn even in the clauses that condemn what was said about it. Word from Him. Spirit from Him. Strengthened by the Holy Spirit, three times. Speech from the cradle. A book given. Clay formed and breathed to life. The blind and the leper healed. The dead raised. The taking and the raising. Peace over his birth, his death, and his rising. A place among the five prophets from whom a solemn covenant was taken. Compassion and mercy placed in the hearts of his followers.

And the sentence the two texts are usually held to contradict, they do not. The Gospel of John opens by saying the Word was in the beginning, was toward God, and was theos, and the Greek marks the third clause with an article deliberately absent where the clause before it has one. A predicate noun in that position, fronted and without the article, is characteristically qualitative, which is the majority grammatical judgment and the ground for rendering it of God's kind. Two other construals have been defended: an indefinite one, a god, and a definite one, the God, which would make the clause the equation. The definite construal is the minority reading precisely because the article is absent where the clause before it has one, and because the Greek for a convertible equation was available, *ho theos en ho logos*, and was not written. The Quran says of its own Word that it is with Him, exalted, wise, glorious, noble, inexhaustible, complete, and unalterable, and then names that Word with a man's name in a clause where the grammar breaks to follow the person. What the Quran condemns is a construction the Gospel of John does not use. On that verse, the two texts fence in the same place.

Then the commentary reads the earliest Gospel from that position, straight through. Mark, written first, still rough, with the family who thought him mad and the ending that stops mid-sentence. Sixteen chapters, eighteen sections, the Gospel quoted and then read.

The reading finds a single pattern running through the whole book. The healer says if you are willing before he says be clean. He looks up to heaven before he breaks the bread. He says whoever receives me does not receive me but the one who sent me. He says the seats at his right and left are not his to give. He says not even the Son knows the hour. In every one of these, authority runs upward and is received rather than held, and that is the same direction the Quran attaches to every miracle it records of him: by My permission, four separate times in a single verse.

Nothing in the argument requires taking anyone's word for anything. Every claim rests on a construction anyone can check with a concordance, a lexicon, and a standard grammar.

PROLOGUE · THE READING DEVICE

This commentary reads the Gospel of Mark from a single fixed position: the position of a reader who holds the Quranic account of 'Isā AS entire, and holds nothing else.

The device is stated plainly at the outset so it is never mistaken for a historical claim. There is no assertion here that the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ read the Gospel of Mark. What is asserted is narrower and checkable: the Quran addresses the Injil, its bearer, his mother, his disciples, his miracles, his table, his death, and his raising, at length and in detail, across at least nine surahs. The corpus performs a reading of this material. That reading has a definite shape, a definite vocabulary, and definite verdicts, and it can be applied to a text it does not cite. Doing so is what this commentary is.

The device earns its place because it solves the problem that has made this comparison useless for fourteen centuries. Every previous attempt has read one text through the doctrinal settlement of the other's later community. Read Mark through the councils and you find the councils. Read the Quran through the polemicists and you find the polemic. Read Mark from inside the Quranic register itself, before any commentary of either tradition, and something else appears: two texts that deposit the same high tokens and fence the same collapse, in the same grammatical positions, and two receptions that each preserved the tokens and lost the fences.

So the reader posited here has the following equipment and nothing more.

He holds a doctrine of the divine Word which is stated in his own book and which no later theology supplied to him. He holds an account of 'Isā AS which affirms the virgin conception, the messiahship, the miracles, the raising, and the return, and which denies exactly two things and names them by their grammar. He holds a set of prophets whose faults are recorded without softening, and two among them whose files are clean. He holds a law of transmission which guarantees the fidelity of a deposit and never guarantees the comprehension of its transmitter. And he holds a faculty of discrimination which his own book says was given to the human as such, before any book was placed in any hand.

With that equipment he opens the earliest Gospel and reads it straight through.

What follows is what he finds. Where the two agree, the agreement is recorded. Where they part, the parting is named and the Quranic reading holds, because that is the position the reading is taken from. And where a later hand has smoothed the Gospel, the smoothing is identified, because the same reader's own book teaches him exactly what a later hand does to a deposit and exactly how to detect it.

The method is shown working rather than announced. Each passage is read on three registers, what stands, what moves, and how the two bind, and the reading closes where the three hold apart. Why there are three, and why holding them apart is what a verification is, is set out from first principles in Appendix A, which assumes no prior familiarity with anything.

Honorifics are components of the names they attach to and travel through every line: Allah ﷻ, the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, and the prophets AS.

HOW TO READ THIS COMMENTARY

Each section of Part IV has three parts. First the Gospel passage, set as a block quotation. Then Commentary based on Quran, which is not a footnote to the Gospel but a reading of it from the Quranic register, and which corrects where the two part. Then Structural Commentary, which asks a different question: whether the passage holds together as a structure, and on what terms. Appendix A sets out exactly what that second question means and why it is asked in the form it is.

The Gospel blocks are indicative, not complete. They are given in a continuous summary register rather than in a single translation, because the commentary reads sequences, placements, and repetitions rather than the wording of any one English version. Where a specific word carries the argument, the Greek is given and glossed.

Arabic and Greek terms are glossed at the point where they carry the argument, and Appendix E gathers every term used, alphabetically, so that any occurrence can be resolved without turning back.

Transliteration is conventional and light. Long vowels carry a macron (ā, ī, ū). The two Arabic letters with no English equivalent are marked ‘ for ‘ayn and ’ for hamza. Emphatic consonants carry a dot beneath (ḥ, ṣ, ḍ, ṭ, ḏ). Greek long vowels are written ē and ō. No knowledge of either script is assumed anywhere.

Quranic references are given as surah:verse. Gospel references are to Mark unless another book is named.

Each major section ends with a Summary box. It gathers that section's result in a few lines, so a reader can carry the argument forward without re-reading, or can use the boxes alone as a route through the book.

The mark κ closes a reading. It appears at the end of a Structural Commentary when the passage's three registers hold apart and the reading closes. Where a reading does not close, no mark is used and the reason is stated in words. Appendix A explains the mark and Appendix C lists every occurrence.

TWELVE TERMS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Enough to read the whole commentary without turning to the back. The full glossary is at Appendix E.

Word (kalima) · What is spoken. The Quran uses it of divine speech and, at two places, of Jesus himself.

Spirit (rūḥ) · Breath, spirit. Said of Jesus at Q 4:171, and said of Adam and of every human being elsewhere.

Messenger (rasūl) · One sent. The office, not the person.

By My permission (bi-idhnī) · The clause the Quran attaches to every miracle of Jesus, four times in one verse.

Servant (‘abd) · The first word Jesus speaks in the Quran, from the cradle.

The Messiah (al-Masīḥ) · Used eleven times of Jesus in the Quran and never withdrawn.

Self (nafs) · The bounded self, the layer that tastes death.

Face (wajh) · What remains. Never placed under the death-law.

Discrimination (bayān) · The faculty of telling one thing from another, from the word for between. Given to the human being as such at Q 55:4.

Guarding (taqwā) · Keeping oneself shielded. The Quran's own stated condition for receiving its guidance.

Criterion (furqān) · A splitter, from the root meaning to separate. Promised to anyone who guards himself, at Q 8:29.

Custodian (muhaymin) · One who watches over and safeguards. What the Quran calls itself in relation to the scriptures before it.

PART I · THE READER

Four things the Quranic register carries into the Gospel before a line of it is read.

Box | Part I Summary

The corpus corrects its prophets and does not soften it. Thirteen named figures carry a recorded fault, including four of the five who were given a book.

Two carry nothing, on two different grounds. ‘Īsā AS is the only one of the five scripture-bearers with a clean file, the other four carrying heavy records. And of Yahyā AS the negation is stated outright rather than merely omitted.

The silence is a guard, not an elevation. A recorded fault would have proved servanthood by deficiency. The clean file is what makes it chosen, which Q 4:172 states one verse after the three designations.

The two clean files are two ends of one relation. Confirmation requires two parties. Merging them deletes the relation rather than perfecting it.

Fidelity is guaranteed; comprehension never is. Q 75:19 places the explication after the recitation and assigns it upstream.

I.1 · The Fault-Record, and the Two It Does Not Touch

Take the corpus at its own word and the inventory is stark. The table gives it at a glance; the paragraphs beneath give each case in the corpus's own words.

Table: The prophetic fault-record at a glance

Prophet	What the corpus records	Where
Adam AS	Forgot the covenant; found without resolve; disobeyed and erred	20:115, 20:121
Nūḥ AS	Asked for what he had no knowledge of; warned against ignorance	11:46
Ibrāhīm AS	Confesses a fault in his own prayer; the star, moon, and sun sequence	26:82, 6:76-78
Lūṭ AS	Offers his daughters; wishes for tribal strength rather than the Ground	11:78, 11:80
Yaʿqūb AS	Grief past its bounds until his eyes whiten; a precaution he concedes useless	12:84-86, 12:67
Yūsuf AS	An inclination restrained from outside; reliance on the cupbearer	12:24, 12:42
Hārūn AS	Charged with disobeying his brother's command	20:93
Ayyūb AS	An oath requiring accommodation to discharge; called ever-returning	38:44
Mūsā AS	A killing he calls Satan's work; a refused request and explicit repentance; his brother seized	28:15, 7:143, 7:150
Dāwūd AS	Realised he was tested; sought forgiveness and was forgiven a named thing	38:24
Sulaymān AS	Distracted past the hour; corrected by a bird on knowledge and haste	38:31, 27:22
Yūnus AS	Absconded like a runaway slave; thought he would not be constrained	37:140, 21:87
Muhammad ﷺ	Seven corrections: frowned and turned away (Q 80:1); pardoned for a permission granted before verification (Q 9:43); concealed within himself and feared people (Q 33:37); the ransoms taken at Badr (Q 8:67); a near-inclination averted from outside (Q 17:74); forbade himself a lawful thing (Q 66:1); and twice commanded to seek forgiveness for his own offence (Q 40:55, Q 47:19)	seven loci, listed at left
Yaḥyā AS	Nothing. The negation stated outright: not a tyrant, not disobedient	19:14
ʿĪsā AS	Nothing at all	

Adam AS. Wa-laḡad ʾahidnā ilā ʾĀdama min qablu fa-nasiya wa-lam najid lahu ʾazmā (Q 20:115). We took a covenant from him before, but he forgot, and We found in him no resolve. Two named deficits, and then ʾaṣā ʾĀdamu rabbahu fa-ghawā (Q 20:121), disobeyed and erred. His own confession, rabbanā ḡalamnā anḡusanā (Q 7:23), is self-attributed wronging, and the words of return were given to him rather than found by him (Q 2:37).

Nūḥ AS. He interceded for his son and was answered innahu laysa min aḡlik, innahu ʾamalun ḡayru ṣāliḡ, fa-lā tasʾalni mā laysa laka biḡi ʾilm, innī aʾizuka an takūna min al-ḡāḡilīn (Q 11:46). Do not ask Me what you have no knowledge of; I admonish you lest you be among the ignorant. That word is spoken to a prophet in the middle of a flood.

Ibrāhīm AS. In his own prayer of praise: wa-lladhī aṡmaʾu an yaghḡira lī kḡaṡʾatī yawm ad-dīn (Q 26:82), and who I hope will forgive me my fault on the Day of Judgment. Unprompted, in a passage of glorification, a prophet asserts a kḡaṡʾa attached to himself. Beside it the star-moon-sun sequence at Q 6:76-78, three times ḡādhā rabbī and three times withdrawn, and the prayer for a father later disowned at Q 9:114.

Lūṭ AS. At Q 11:78 he offers his daughters to the crowd, a proposal the text neither endorses nor has him retract. At Q 11:80, law anna lī bikum quwwatan aw āwī ilā ruknin shadīd, if only I had power against you or could take refuge in a strong support, a wish for tribal muscle rather than for the Ground he serves.

Yaʿqūb AS. Grief past its bounds until his eyes whiten (Q 12:84) and his own sons tell him he will destroy himself (Q 12:85). A precaution ordered at Q 12:67 and conceded useless in the same breath. Then his own correction, innamā ashkū bathṡhī wa-ḡuznī ilā Allāḡ (Q 12:86).

Yūsuf AS. Wa-laḡad ḡammat biḡi wa-ḡamma biḡā lawlā an raʾā burḡāna rabbih (Q 12:24), the inclination placed on him with an external restraint interposed. And Q 12:42, the request to the cupbearer followed by fa-ansāḡu sh-shayṡānu dhikra rabbihī fa-labitha fī s-sijni biḡʾa sinīn, several years added to the sentence.

Hārūn AS. A-fa-ʾaṡayta amrī (Q 20:93), did you disobey my command, and his defence that he feared being blamed for splitting the people.

Ayyūb AS. An oath sworn that required a divine accommodation to discharge without perjury, khudḡ bi-yadika ḡiḡthan fa-ḡrib biḡi wa-lā ṡaḡnath (Q 38:44), with awwāb, ever-returning, as his epithet.

Mūsā AS. The killing, self-typed as ḡādhā min ʾamal ash-shayṡān and rabbī innī ḡalamtu nafsī (Q 28:15-16) and later called dḡanb in his own mouth (Q 26:14). The request at Sinai, rabbī arinī anṡur ilayk, refused with lan tarānī, and his waking words subḡānaka tubtu ilayk (Q 7:143), an explicit repentance for having asked. The tablets thrown and his brother seized by the head (Q 7:150), then rabbī ḡḡfir lī wa-li-akhī (Q 7:151), forgive me and my brother, himself first. And three broken undertakings with Khidṡ AS, with lā tuʾakhidḡnī bimā nasītu (Q 18:73) as his own admission.

Dāwūd AS. Wa-ḡanna Dāwūdu annamā fatannāḡu fa-staḡḡfara rabbahu wa-kḡarra rākīʾan wa-anāb (Q 38:24), followed by fa-ḡḡafarnā lahu dhālik, so We forgave him that. The pronoun has a referent.

Sulaymān AS. The horses and the missed hour (Q 38:31-33). The body cast on the throne and the return, thumma anāb (Q 38:34). And the hoopoe returning with aḡaṡtu bimā lam tuḡiṡ biḡi, I have

encompassed what you have not, correcting the prophet-king on knowledge and on haste in one line (Q 27:20-22).

Yūnus AS. Abaqa ilā al-fulk al-mashhūn (Q 37:140), absconded, the verb for a runaway slave. Fa-ẓanna an lan naqdīra ‘alayh (Q 21:87), he thought We would not constrain him. His confession innī kuntū min az-ẓālimīn. And the Prophet ﷺ told directly, wa-lā takun ka-ṣāhib al-ḥūt (Q 68:48), do not be like the man of the fish.

Muhammad ﷺ. ‘Abasa wa-tawallā (Q 80:1), he frowned and turned away. ‘Afā Allāhu ‘anka lima adhinta lahum (Q 9:43). Wa-tukhfī fī nafsika mā Allāhu mubdīhi wa-takhshā an-nāsa wa-Allāhu aḥaqqu an takhshāh (Q 33:37). Lima tuḥarrimu mā aḥalla Allāhu lak (Q 66:1). The Badr ransoms (Q 8:67-68). The near-inclination averted only by external firming (Q 17:73-75). Mā taqaddama min dhanbika wa-mā ta’akhkhar (Q 48:2), wa-waḍa’nā ‘anka wizrak (Q 94:2), and twice the imperative wa-staghfir li-dhanbik (Q 40:55, Q 47:19).

Against all of that, silence on two.

The comparison has to be drawn in the right class or it proves nothing. Of the twenty-five prophets the corpus names, most appear only in a list, or in a short cycle with an adversary and a deliverance, and carry no recorded fault for the plain reason that there is no narrative in which one could be recorded. Nothing follows from their silence. Idrīs AS occupies two verses. Dhū al-Kifl AS and al-Yasā’ AS are names in an enumeration.

So the class that carries information is the figures the corpus treats at length, and within that class the sharpest and least arguable line is those given a book. There are five.

Table: The scripture-bearers

Prophet	The book	Fault recorded
Ibrāhīm AS	the ṣuḥuf, Q 87:19	Yes. A fault confessed in his own prayer, Q 26:82
Mūsā AS	the Tawrāt and the Furqān, Q 2:53	Yes. The heaviest record in the corpus
Dāwūd AS	the Zabūr, Q 4:163	Yes. A named thing forgiven, Q 38:24
Muhammad ﷺ	the Qur’ān	Yes. Seven corrections, itemised above
‘Īsā AS	the Injīl, Q 5:46	None

Four of the five carry heavy records. The fifth carries nothing, and that is the observation. It does not rest on counting minor figures, it does not turn on where a borderline case falls, and it cannot be dissolved by pointing at a prophet the corpus mentions in passing.

Beside him stands one further figure, distinctive on a different ground.

Yahyā AS receives the negation stated outright: wa-barran bi-wālidayhi wa-lam yakun jabbāran ‘aṣiyyā (Q 19:14), dutiful to his parents, and he was not a tyrant, not disobedient. That last word is

the root used of Adam AS at Q 20:121 and of Hārūn AS at Q 20:93. It is applied to Yahyā AS only in order to be denied.

‘Īsā AS receives nothing at all. Not a correction, not a rebuke, not a lapse. He is the only scripture-bearer in the corpus with a clean file.

And the pairing with Yahyā AS is lexical rather than incidental. Q 19:7 marks his name as unprecedented, lam naj’al lahu min qablu samiyyā, We had given that name to no one before, and the corpus then plays on it: his blessing at Q 19:15 closes on yawma yub’athu ḥayyā, the day he is raised alive, the Arabic form of the name and the word for living sharing their consonants. The paronomasia is the corpus's own and does not depend on any claim about the name's ultimate derivation, which is from the Hebrew Yōḥānān. ‘Īsā AS is rūḥun minhu, a spirit from Him. The two figures the fault-record does not touch are the one whose name the corpus rhymes with living and the one who is spirit from Him, and both stand at the same register.

The distribution is also asymmetric by design. If the lapses were a literary convention for humanising the prophetic type they would fall evenly across the figures the corpus treats at length. They do not: they fall on four of the five scripture-bearers and on most of the extended narrative cycles, and they are absent from exactly the one place where a reader of either tradition would most expect to find one. Fault is recorded where a mechanism is being taught and withheld where it is not.

I.1a · The One Candidate, and Why It Returns Clean

A negative claim about a corpus is only as good as the search behind it, and there is exactly one passage that a reader will raise against it. It should be raised here rather than left.

Q 5:116 is the only place in the corpus where the Source addresses ‘Īsā AS directly and puts a question to him. The setting is the reckoning, and the question is an accusation in form: a-anta qulta li-l-nāsi ittakhidhūnī wa-ummiya ilāhaynī min dūni Allāh, did you say to the people, take me and my mother as two gods besides Allah ﷻ. If a rebuke of ‘Īsā AS exists anywhere in the corpus, it is here.

Read the exchange whole and it returns the opposite of a rebuke.

The question is put and the answer is immediate and threefold. Subḥānak, glory be to You, a refusal of the premise before anything else. Mā yakūnu lī an aqūla mā laysa lī bi-ḥaqq, it is not for me to say what is not mine by right, a refusal to occupy a formulation rather than a denial of a deed he might have done. Then the epistemic boundary, ta’lamu mā fī nafsī wa-lā a’lamu mā fī nafsik, You know what is in my self and I do not know what is in Yours, which places the verification with the questioner rather than with the answerer. And then the affirmative content at Q 5:117: mā qultu lahum illā mā amartanī bihi an u’budū Allāha rabbī wa-rabbakum, I said to them only what You commanded me, worship Allah ﷻ, my Lord and your Lord.

The passage is therefore an interrogation that returns clean, and an interrogation that returns clean is evidence for a file rather than

against it. The corpus has the form available for the other outcome and uses it freely elsewhere: *fa-lā taʿālmi mā laysa laka bihi ʿilm to Nūḥ AS, lan tarānī to Mūsā AS, ʿafā Allāhu ʿanka and ʿabasa wa-tawallā to the Prophet ﷺ*. Here the question is put and no fault is returned.

Two related passages are worth naming with it and are the same shape. At Q 5:110 the corpus recounts every favour and every work and attaches its permission-clause four times, and adds no correction. And at Q 43:59 the corpus says of him only in *huwa illā ʿabdun anʿamnā ʿalayhi wa-jaʿalnāhu mathalan li-Banī Isrāʾīl*, he was only a servant whom We favoured and made an example. The strongest available reduction in the corpus's vocabulary is only a servant, and it carries no fault with it.

So the ʿĪsā AS row of the table above is empty because the one entry a reader would expect to find there was examined and returned nothing.

I.2 · What the Silence Is For

The obvious reading of the silence is elevation. It is the wrong reading, and the corpus supplies the right one in the next verse of the very passage that raises the question.

Track the relation between exception and servanthood across the corpus and it runs inverse: the higher the ontological anomaly, the heavier the servanthood declaration. ʿĪsā AS is the only figure who speaks from the cradle, and the first word out of his mouth in the entire corpus is *ʿabd. Innī ʿabdu Allāh, ātāniya al-kitāba wa-jaʿalanī nabiyyā* (Q 19:30). Servant first, book second, prophet third, at the moment of maximum miraculous exception.

Now see what the silence buys. Had the corpus recorded a fault for ʿĪsā AS, that fault would have become the proof of mere humanity, and the servanthood would have been established by deficiency. A servant because he could not be more. Instead the corpus establishes servanthood by declaration from a figure it never faults, which is the harder and stronger claim, and it states it one verse after the three designations:

> **The Messiah will never disdain to be a servant of Allah ﷻ, nor will the angels brought near.** > > *Lan yastankifa al-Masīḥu an yakūna ʿabdan lillāh wa-lā al-malāʾikatu al-muqarrabūn.* · Q 4:172

Yastankif is the verb of disdain, of holding oneself above. It presupposes a height from which disdain would be intelligible. The verse does not say he is too small to be more. It says he is not too proud to be less. And the angels are placed beside him in the same clause, which sets the height at which the disdain would have been conceivable.

That is the voluntariness guard, and it is the office the fault-silence performs.

Box 1 | The Two Devices

The corpus runs two complementary devices on the prophetic record and they must not be confused.

The clean file on ʿĪsā AS and Yaḥyā AS is the voluntariness guard. Servanthood declared by a figure never faulted is chosen; servanthood forced by deficiency is not. Q 4:172 and Q 19:30 state it.

The marked file on the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ is the anti-counterfeit device. To impersonate a figure whose record contains ʿabasa wa-tawallā addressed to himself in the third person, an impostor would have to write his own rebukes. No claimant volunteers a fault-file. The corrections are tamper-evidence, and the corpus adds two further locks: the office is sealed by declaration at Q 33:40, and at Q 3:144 an anti-cult clause is revealed at the exact moment a rumour of his death ran through a battlefield.

Different mechanisms, different purposes, both running at once.

I.3 · The Two-Place Office

Because the two clean files stand together, the natural next thought is that they are one figure. The corpus closes that route with a single verse and opens a better one.

> **Allah ﷻ gives you glad tidings of Yaḥyā, confirming a word from Allah ﷻ.** > > *Anna Allāha yubashshiruka bi-Yaḥyā, muṣaddiqan bi-kalimatīn min Allāh.* · Q 3:39

Confirmation is two-place. A confirmer attests something, and the something is not himself. If the word is ʿĪsā AS, and the natural reading six verses later at Q 3:45 makes it so, then Yaḥyā AS is attester and ʿĪsā AS is attested, and no one attests his own arrival. The relation requires two terms, and collapsing them deletes it rather than perfecting it.

Q 6:85 enumerates them as members of a set, *wa-Zakariyyā wa-Yaḥyā wa-ʿĪsā wa-Ilyās, kullun min aṣ-ṣāliḥīn*, and enumeration presupposes distinctness. Q 19 runs them as adjacent cycles with incompatible origins: a barren wife for one (Q 19:2-15) and no man at all for the other (Q 19:16-33). The peace-formula is spoken over Yaḥyā AS at Q 19:15 and spoken by ʿĪsā AS about himself at Q 19:33, the same words in two grammatical positions.

What the pairing is, then, is one two-place office with two seats. And that reading explains the silence at both ends where the merger cannot: an attestation is only as clean as both of its poles. A confirmer with a recorded fault has his attestation impeached; a confirmed figure with a recorded fault has an unimpeached attestation pointing at damaged goods. The joint cleanness is a structural requirement of the office, not a coincidence of two biographies.

The corpus has the same pattern elsewhere, named. Mūsā AS asks *wa-jaʿal lī wazīran min ahlī, Hārūna akhī, ushdud bihi azrī, wa-ashrikhu fī amrī* (Q 20:29-32). One command, two persons, the sharing requested and granted, and the two never once collapsed. One office, two nodes, persons kept distinct.

This matters immediately, because Mark stages the collapse and declines it. Herod says John the baptiser has been raised, and adds the beheading himself so no reader misses that he knows better. The crowd cycles John, Elijah, or one of the prophets. Mark reports three confident identifications and ratifies none, and the reader who read chapter one already holds the correct structure.

I.4 • Transmission and Comprehension

The reader carries one more law, and it governs what he is permitted to conclude from anything he finds.

The corpus guarantees the fidelity of its transmission in its most severe available language and never once guarantees the exhaustive comprehension of its transmitter.

Fidelity: wa-mā yantiqu ‘an al-hawā, in huwa illā wahyun yūhā (Q 53:3-4), he does not speak from desire. Qul mā yakūnu lī an ubaddilahu min tilqā’i nafsi (Q 10:15), it is not for me to alter it of my own accord, with the self barred by name. And wa-law taqawwala ‘alaynā ba’da al-aqāwīl, la-akhadhnā minhu bil-yamīn, thumma la-qata’nā minhu al-watīn (Q 69:44-46), a threat of a severed aorta that never fired.

Comprehension: the opposite treatment. Qul lā aqūlu lakum ‘indī khazā’inu Allāh wa-lā a’lamu al-ghayb (Q 6:50). Law kuntu a’lamu al-ghayba la-staktharu min al-khayr (Q 7:188). Mā adrī mā yuf’alu bī wa-lā bikum (Q 46:9). Each prefixed with the imperative say, so these are commanded declarations rather than concessions extracted. And a standing open petition, wa-qul rabbi zidnī ‘ilmā (Q 20:114), the only thing in the corpus its bearer is told to ask increase of.

Then the verse that separates the two axes explicitly and assigns both to the Source:

> **Do not move your tongue with it to hasten it. Upon Us is its gathering and its recitation. So when We have recited it, follow its recitation. Then, upon Us is its explication.** > > Lā tuḥarrīk bihi lisānaka li-ta’jala bih. Inna ‘alaynā jam’ahu wa-qur’ānah. Fa-idhā qara’nāhu fa-ttabi’ qur’ānah. Thumma inna ‘alaynā bayānah. · Q 75:16-19

Gathering is His. Recitation is His. The instruction to the transmitter is follow, a fidelity verb and not a comprehension verb. And then thumma, afterward, in sequence: the explication is also His, placed after the recitation and stated as an ongoing undertaking rather than a completed state.

The in-corpus precedent is the Khidr AS cycle at Q 18:65-82. A scripture-bearing messenger of the first rank is shown a knowledge from a source he does not hold and is told he could not have patience with what he did not encompass. A full narrative cycle spent on the proposition that completeness of office does not entail completeness of comprehension.

The consequence for this commentary is exact and it is what makes the reading device honest. A verbatim standard preserves structure independently of any transmitter’s or reader’s grasp. A token deposited unaltered carries whatever it carries whether or not anyone

downstream unfolds it. So the structures recovered below are present in the two texts as tokens, and nothing in the recovery requires or asserts that any transmitter unfolded them.

PART II • THE DISTILLED QURANIC CHRISTOLOGY

This is the equipment the reader brings. It is set out as an inventory rather than as an argument, because the first thing an inventory does is dissolve the assumption on which both receptions rest, that the two accounts stand at opposite ends of a spectrum.

Box | Part II Summary

Affirmed: fifteen items, set out in full in the table at II.3.

Denied: three grammatical forms only. A convertible identity marked by the separative pronoun, an ordinal inside a count, and offspring in the generative sense.

So what is removed is begetting and number. Everything else is kept.

The Word has a prior residence and seven predicates the corpus gives to nothing created, and is then named with a man’s name in a clause where the grammar breaks to follow the person.

The crucifixion verse denies their agency and their knowledge, not a death; the taking is assigned to the Source in three places, one of them in his own mouth.

II.1 • What the Corpus Affirms

Gathered without selection, from every surah in which the material occurs.

The conception. Fa-arsalnā ilayhā rūḥanā fa-tamaththala lahā basharan sawiyyā (Q 19:17), We sent to her Our Spirit and it presented itself to her as a well-formed man. Her protest, annā yakūnu lī ghulamun wa-lam yamsasnī basharun wa-lam aku baghiyyā (Q 19:20), no man has touched me and I have not been unchaste, and the answer, huwa ‘alayya hayyin wa-li-naj’alahu āyatan li-l-nāsi wa-raḥmatan minnā wa-kāna amran maqḍiyyā (Q 19:21), a sign for mankind and a mercy from Us, and a matter decreed. The parallel at Q 3:47 with the same protest and the same answer, kadhāliki Allāhu yakhluqu mā yashā’. And twice more in the corpus’s own summary voice: wa-allatī aḥsanat farjahā fa-nafakhnā fihā min rūḥinā wa-jāalnāhā wa-bnahā āyatan li-l-‘ālamīn (Q 21:91), and wa-Maryama bnata ‘Imrāna allatī aḥsanat farjahā fa-nafakhnā fihī min rūḥinā wa-ṣaddaqt bi-kalimāti rabbihā wa-kutubihi wa-kānat min al-qānitīn (Q 66:12).

The virgin conception is therefore stated four separate times, in four surahs, in the corpus’s own voice, with the mother’s own denial of contact preserved in two of them.

The mother. Chosen and purified: inna Allāha iṣṭafāki wa-ṭahharaki wa-ṣṭafāki ‘alā nisā’i al-‘ālamīn (Q 3:42). Provisioned without

reckoning at Q 3:37. Named a šiddīqa, a woman of truth, at Q 5:75. The only woman named in the whole corpus, and a surah carries her name.

The titles. Al-Masīh, the Messiah, eleven times: Q 3:45, Q 4:157, Q 4:171, Q 4:172, Q 5:17 twice, Q 5:72 twice, Q 5:75, Q 9:30, and Q 9:31. Four of the eleven stand inside formulas the corpus is condemning, which sharpens the observation rather than weakening it: the corpus rejects the predication and never withdraws the title, so the very clause that rejects Allah ﷻ is the Messiah calls him the Messiah while rejecting it. Kalima, a word from Him: Q 3:39, Q 3:45, Q 4:171. Rūh minhu, a spirit from Him: Q 4:171. Wajīhan fī al-dunyā wa-l-ākhirati wa-mina al-muqarrabīn (Q 3:45), eminent in this world and the next and of those brought near. Mubārakan aynamā kuntu (Q 19:31), blessed wherever I am. Ghulāman zakīyyā (Q 19:19), a pure boy, spoken by the angel before the conception. Āyatan li-l-nāsi wa-raḥmatan minnā (Q 19:21). And innahu la-ʿilmun li-l-sāʿati (Q 43:61), he is knowledge of the Hour.

The strengthening. Wa-ayyadnāhu bi-rūḥi al-quḍus, We strengthened him with the Holy Spirit, three times: Q 2:87, Q 2:253, Q 5:110. The verb is from the root for strength in the hand and means bracing, not replacing.

The speech. Wa-yukallimu al-nāsa fī al-mahdi wa-kahlan (Q 3:46, and again at Q 5:110), he will speak to people in the cradle and in maturity. And the cradle speech itself at Q 19:30-33, in the first person, opening on ʿabd.

The teaching given. Wa-yuʿallimuhu al-kitāba wa-l-ḥikmata wa-l-Tawrāta wa-l-Injīl (Q 3:48, and Q 5:110). And the Injīl itself described: wa-āṭaynāhu al-Injīla fīhi hudan wa-nūrun wa-muṣaddiqan limā bayna yadayhi min al-Tawrāti wa-hudan wa-mawʿizatan li-l-muttaqīn (Q 5:46), guidance and light and admonition.

The works. Annī akhluqu lakum min al-ṭīni ka-hayʿati al-ṭayri fa-anfukhu fīhi fa-yakūnu ṭayran bi-idhni Allāh, wa-ubriʿu al-akmaha wa-l-abraṣa wa-uḥyī al-mawtā bi-idhni Allāh, wa-unabbiʿukum bimā taʿkulūna wa-mā taddakhirūna fī buyūtikum (Q 3:49). Formation from clay with breath, the blind and the leper healed, the dead raised, and knowledge of what is eaten and stored in houses. Repeated in the second person at Q 5:110 with the permission-clause attached four separate times. And bi-idhnī, by My permission, is attached to every one of them without exception.

The mission. Wa-muṣaddiqan limā bayna yadayya min al-Tawrāti wa-li-uḥilla lakum baʿda alladhī ḥurrima ʿalaykum (Q 3:50), confirming the Torah and making lawful some of what had been forbidden. Sent ilā Banī Isrāʾīl (Q 3:49), a bounded mission. And announcing what comes after him at Q 61:6.

The disciples. Man anṣārī ilā Allāh, qāla al-ḥawāriyyūna naḥnu anṣāru Allāh (Q 3:52, and Q 61:14). Called helpers of Allah ﷻ in the corpus's own approving voice.

The table. Rabbanā anzil ʿalaynā māʿidatan min al-samāʾi takūnu lanā ʿīdan li-awwalinā wa-ākhirinā wa-āyatan mink (Q 5:114), and the answer innī munazziluhā ʿalaykum (Q 5:115).

The taking and the raising. Innī mutawaffika wa-rāfiʿuka ilayya wa-muṭahhiruka mina alladhīna kafarū (Q 3:55). Bal rafaʿahu Allāhu ilayhi wa-kāna Allāhu ʿazīzan ḥakīmā (Q 4:158).

The peace. Wa-l-salāmu ʿalayya yawma wulidtu wa-yawma amūtu wa-yawma ubʾathu ḥayyā (Q 19:33), the threefold peace spoken by him about himself.

The covenant rank. Wa-idh akhadhnā mina al-nabiyyīna mīthāqahum wa-minka wa-min Nūḥin wa-Ibrāhīma wa-Mūsā wa-ʿIsā bni Maryam wa-akhadhnā minhum mīthāqan ghalīzā (Q 33:7). Named among the five from whom the solemn covenant was taken. And at Q 42:13 the same religion is enjoined on Nūḥ, Ibrāhīm, Mūsā, and ʿIsā AS in one verse. And revelation given to him at Q 4:163 in the same list as the rest.

The community. Wa-jaʿalnā fī qulūbi alladhīna ittabaʿūhu raʿfatan wa-raḥmah (Q 57:27), We placed compassion and mercy in the hearts of those who followed him. And la-tajidanna aqrabahum mawaddatan li-l-ladhīna āmanū alladhīna qālū innā naṣārā, dhālika bi-anna minhum qissīsīna wa-ruhbanān wa-annahum lā yastakbirūn (Q 5:82), the nearest in affection, and the reason given is the absence of arrogance among their priests and monks.

That is the affirmed inventory. It is not a residue. It is nearly the whole apparatus.

II.2 · What the Corpus Denies, and in What Grammatical Form

The denials are three in kind and each is identifiable by its construction. This is the observation on which the whole comparison turns, and it is checkable by anyone who can read an Arabic clause.

The convertible identity.

> **They have disbelieved who said: Allah ﷻ is the Messiah, son of Maryam.** > > La-qad kafara alladhīna qālū inna Allāha huwa al-Masīhu bnu Maryam. · Q 5:17, and again at Q 5:72

Definite subject, Allāha. Separative pronoun, huwa. Definite predicate, al-Masīh. In Arabic this is the strongest available identity construction: it asserts convertibility with no remainder on either side, A is B and B is A. The pronoun exists precisely to mark an equational sentence.

The numeral.

> **They have disbelieved who said: Allah ﷻ is the third of three.** > > La-qad kafara alladhīna qālū inna Allāha thālithu thalāthah. · Q 5:73 > > **And do not say three. Stop; it is better for you.** > > Walā taqūlū thalāthah, intahū khayran lakum. · Q 4:171

An ordinal inside a count, and a prohibition on a numeral.

The generation.

> **The Jews said ʿUzayr is the son of Allah ﷻ, and the Christians said the Messiah is the son of Allah ﷻ.** > > Wa-qālati al-Yahūdu ʿUzayrun ibnu Allāh, wa-qālati al-Naṣārā al-Masīhu ibnu Allāh. · Q 9:30 > > **It was not for Allah ﷻ to take to Himself any offspring.**

Glory be to Him. > > Mā kāna lillāhi an yattakhidha min waladin, subḥānah. · Q 19:35 > > **How could He have offspring when He has no consort?** > > Annā yakūnu lahu waladun wa-lam takun lahu šāḥibah. · Q 6:101

The last of these is decisive for what the denial targets. It asks how He could have a walad when He has no consort, and walad is the generative-biological term. The mechanism denied is procreation. And Q 112:3, lam yalid wa-lam yūlad, denies begetting in both directions, with Q 112:2 supplying the reason first: aṣ-Ṣamad, the solid without hollow, since a thing that begets must have an interior from which something issues.

And Q 43:81 is worth having whole because it shows the register of the refusal: qul in kāna li-l-Raḥmāni waladun fa-anā awwalu al-ʿābidīn. Say: if the Merciful had a son, I would be the first of the worshippers. The refusal is not of honour paid; it is of the mechanism claimed.

And Q 5:116, which names its own target. A-anta qulta li-l-nāsi ittakhidhūni wa-ummiya ilāhayni min dūni Allāh. Did you say to the people, take me and my mother as two gods besides Allah ﷻ. The triad named is Allah ﷻ, ʿĪsā AS, and Maryam AS. That corresponds to no conciliar formula of any Christian communion, then or since. Whatever its historical referent, the target the corpus names is a Marian triad and a numbered polytheism.

So the whole denial-file, gathered, condemns exactly three forms: a definite convertible identity, an enumeration, and biological generation. No fourth appears anywhere in the corpus.

II.3 · What Is Actually Removed

Set the two inventories side by side and the result is not the one either polemic expects.

Table: The two inventories, side by side

The corpus affirms	The corpus denies
Conception without a father, stated four times	That Allah ﷻ is the Messiah, as a convertible identity
The title Messiah, eleven times, never withdrawn	That Allah ﷻ is the third of three
A word from Him; a spirit from Him	Offspring in the generative sense, with no consort
Strengthened by the Holy Spirit, three times	
Speech in the cradle and in maturity	
A book given, with guidance and light	
Clay formed and breathed to life, by permission	
The blind and the leper healed, by permission	
The dead raised, by permission	
Purity declared by the angel before conception	
The taking and the raising to Him	
Peace over his birth, his death, and his rising	
A place among the five of the solemn covenant	
Compassion and mercy placed in his followers' hearts	
Knowledge of the Hour	

Removed: generation, and number. Two things.

Retained: the virgin conception, stated four times. The messianic title, eleven times, never qualified away. Word from Him. Spirit from Him. Strengthened by the Holy Spirit, three times. Speech from the cradle. A book given with guidance and light. Formation from clay that breathes and lives. The blind and the leper healed. The dead raised. Purity implied by the angel's own word before the conception. The taking and the raising to Him. The threefold peace. A place among the five of the solemn covenant. A community in whose hearts compassion and mercy were placed. And knowledge of the Hour.

That inventory is substantially closer to the received Christian picture than either reception has been willing to say. And the two removals are narrow. Classical Christian theology also denies begetting in time and by division, and it also denies that the Word is a second god counted beside the first. What the corpus does that the later councils did not is refuse the number as a permissible way of stating the

relation at all, and it refuses it in the same verse in which it supplies three names for one referent.

II.4 · The Word: Residence, Predicates, and the Naming

The reader's doctrine of the Word is stated in his own book and owes nothing to any later theology.

The prior residence. Wa-innahu fī ummi al-kitābi ladaynā la-‘aliyyun ḥakīm (Q 43:4), in the Mother of the Book, with Us, exalted and wise. Wa-‘indahū ummu al-kitāb (Q 13:39), with Him. Bal huwa qur‘ānun majīd, fī lawḥin maḥfūz (Q 85:21-22). Innahu la-qur‘ānun karīm, fī kitābin maknūn (Q 56:77-78). Four locative expressions and one structure: the recitation has a residence that is not its earthly descent, and the residence is with the Source. The descent-language presupposes it from the other direction, innā anzalnāhu fī laylati al-qadr (Q 97:1) and nazala bihi al-rūḥu al-amīnu ‘alā qalbik (Q 26:193-194).

The priority. Surah ar-Raḥmān opens on four verses in strict order. Ar-Raḥmān. ‘Allama al-Qur‘ān. Khalaqa al-insān. ‘Allamahu al-bayān. The Merciful. He taught the Recitation. He created the human. He taught him the discrimination. The teaching stands at verse two and the creating at verse three: the gathering is taught before the receiver exists to receive it. And the name at the head is the mercy-name and not the creation-name, so the assembling of what is known is placed under mercy.

The instrumentality. Innamā amrunā li-shay‘in idhā aradnāhu an naqūla lahu kun fa-yakūn (Q 16:40, and Q 36:82). Everything that comes to be, comes to be by an utterance. The Word is not one created item among others; it is the operator under which created items arrive. And Q 2:117, Q 3:47, and Q 19:35 all carry the same clause.

The predicates. The corpus assigns to its own Word a set it assigns to nothing created. ‘Aliyyun ḥakīm (Q 43:4), exalted and wise, both of them divine names. Qur‘ānun majīd (Q 85:21) and qur‘ānun karīm (Q 56:77), glorious and noble, both of them divine names. Inexhaustible under a hypothetical of unbounded material supply: qul law kāna al-baḥru midādan li-kalimāti rabbī la-nafida al-baḥru qabla an tanfada kalimātu rabbī wa-law ji’nā bi-mithlihi madadā (Q 18:109), and with seven seas added at Q 31:27 the outcome is unchanged. Complete and unalterable: wa-tammat kalimatu rabbika ṣidqan wa-‘adlan, lā mubaddila li-kalimātih (Q 6:115), and lā tabdila li-kalimāti Allāh (Q 10:64).

Seven predicates across six verses, four of them divine names, all of them carried by a term the same verses locate with Him. Inexhaustibility in particular is predicated of no created thing anywhere in the corpus.

The naming. The corpus does not stop at a doctrine. It attaches the Word to a person, and the Arabic performs the attachment in its own grammar:

> **Maryam, Allah ﷻ gives you glad tidings of a word from Him. His name is the Messiah, ‘Isā son of Maryam, eminent in this world and the next.** > > Yā Maryamu inna Allāha yubashshiruki bi-kalimatin minhu, ismuhu al-Masīḥu ‘Isā bnu Maryam, wajīhan fī al-dunyā wa-l-ākhirah. · Q 3:45

The word for word is feminine in Arabic. The pronoun in ismuhu, his name, is masculine, and wajīhan, eminent, is masculine accusative. The agreement breaks at exactly the point where the announcement of a word becomes the naming of a man. The grammarians noticed it; al-Zamakhsharī explains the break by agreement with the thing named rather than with the naming word. That explanation is correct and it is the point. The verse announces a word and names it as a man in one clause, and where the announcement turns into a personal reference the grammar changes gender to follow.

Then Q 4:171 adds the third designation, and Q 3:39 attaches the term a second time by making Yahyā AS its confirmer.

II.5 · Three Registers, and the Barred Count

Q 4:171 supplies three tokens for one referent in a single breath and then, in the same verse, bars the arithmetic.

> **The Messiah, ‘Isā son of Maryam, is only the messenger of Allah ﷻ, and His word which He cast to Maryam, and a spirit from Him. So believe in Allah ﷻ and His messengers, and do not say three.** > > Innamā al-Masīḥu ‘Isā bnu Maryama rasūlu Allāhi wa-kalimatuhu alqāhā ilā Maryama wa-rūḥun minhu. Fa-āminū billāhi wa-rusulihi wa-lā taqūlū thalāthah. · Q 4:171

The verse does not delete the structure it just supplied. Three orthogonal registers of one object are not three objects, and the count is the collapse. Read as contradiction, one half must be gutted. Read as one move, the grammar is exact.

The origin register. Rūḥun minhu, a spirit from Him. The preposition is origin-marking and not partitive, the same construction used of Adam AS at Q 15:29 and Q 38:72 and of the human generally at Q 32:9. This is the register the corpus describes only apophatically: qul al-rūḥu min amri rabbī wa-mā ūtītum mina al-‘ilmi illā qalīlā (Q 17:85).

The articulate register. Kalimatuhu alqāhā ilā Maryam, His word which He cast to Maryam AS. The verb is to cast down from a height: a form laid into a receiving substrate. This is where the Word of Q 43:4 stands, with Him, exalted and wise, in the Mother of the Book.

The delivered register. Rasūlu Allāh, the sent one, placed firmly inside creaturely conditions. Mā al-Masīḥu bnu Maryama illā rasūlun qad khalat min qablihi al-rusul, wa-ummuhu ṣiddīqatun, kānā ya’kulāni al-ṭa‘ām (Q 5:75), they both used to eat food. And in huwa illā ‘abdun an’amnā ‘alayhi wa-ja’alnāhu mathalan li-Banī Isrā’īl (Q 43:59).

One referent, three registers, three prepositions doing the joining, and no count.

And a further verse governs the whole: inna mathala 'Īsā 'inda Allāhi ka-mathali Ādam, khalaqahu min turābin thumma qāla lahu kun fa-yakūn (Q 3:59). This is standardly read as the demotion that settles the matter, and it does something narrower and something broader. Narrower, because the verse is explicitly a likeness and the likeness it draws is on the mode of origination alone: it says nothing about the attributes of the Word, nothing about the residence, nothing about the divine names carried by the Book. Broader, because a comparison runs in both directions. If 'Īsā AS is like Adam AS in the mode of the utterance, then Adam AS was constituted by the Word too, and Q 15:29 adds the second token to Adam AS as well. Both designations of Q 4:171 have Adamic parallels. The effect of Q 3:59 read carefully is not to lower 'Īsā AS to dust but to raise the whole anthropology to Word-and-Spirit.

Where, then, is the differentia? The text puts it in the casting: alqāhā ilā Maryam, direct and unmediated, with no father in the line, which Q 3:47 and Q 19:20 both make explicit. The distinction is in the mode of arrival.

One clause has to be exact here or the seven predicates of II.4 leak. The casting is an act, and an act is not a transfer of the thing predicated. What bears exaltation, wisdom, glory, nobility, inexhaustibility, completion, and unalterability is the Word in its residence, fī ummi al-kitābi ladaynā. The corpus predicates none of the seven of any vessel, and it predicates none of them of Adam AS either, though Adam AS carries both designations. So the reading is that the casting proceeds from what carries the predicates, and not that the predicates travel with the cast. Every fence in II.6 holds on that reading and fails on any other.

II.6 · The Layer Split, and the Grammar of the Crucifixion Verse

The corpus splits the human figure by its own word-discipline, and the split is what governs the passion narrative.

What perishes is named with one word: kullu man 'alayhā fān (Q 55:26) and kullu shay'in hālikun illā wajhah (Q 28:88). What remains is named with another: wa-yabqā wajhu rabbika dhū al-jalāli wa-l-ikrām (Q 55:27). The face is never once placed under the death-law and the self is never once placed in the remainder.

And the death-law's quantifier is bounded by a separate declaration in negation-grammar. Kullu nafsin dhā'iqtu al-mawt (Q 3:185, Q 21:35, Q 29:57) ranges over created selves, because the Uncreated is separately declared deathless: wa-tawakkal 'alā al-Ḥayy alladhī lā yamūt (Q 25:58), with al-Ḥayy al-Qayyūm, lā ta'khudhu sinatun wa-lā nawm (Q 2:255). The exception is stated on its own warrant, in its own verse, before any inference arrives.

Now the crucifixion verse, read as it is written.

> **And for their saying, we killed the Messiah, 'Īsā son of Maryam, the messenger of Allah ﷺ. They did not kill him and they did not crucify him, but it was made to resemble so for them. Those who differ about it are in doubt of it; they have no knowledge of it, only the following of conjecture. They did not**

kill him with certainty. > > Wa-qawlihim innā qatalnā al-Masīha 'Īsā bna Maryama rasūla Allāhi, wa-mā qatalūhu wa-mā ṣalabūhu wa-lākin shubbiha lahum. Wa-inna alladhīna khtalafū fīhi la-fī shakkin minhu, mā lahum bihi min 'ilmin illā ittibā'a al-ẓann, wa-mā qatalūhu yaqīnā. · Q 4:157

The subject throughout is they. The verse denies their accomplishment and their knowledge, and it states its own ground immediately: they have no knowledge of it, only the following of conjecture. It is a verse about a claim to know, made by people the verse says were operating on supposition.

Then the agent changes and the taking is affirmed. Innī mutawaffīka wa-rāf'uka ilayya (Q 3:55), the agent Allah ﷻ. Fa-lammā tawaffaytanī kunta anta al-raqība 'alayhim (Q 5:117), in his own mouth. And yawma amūtu (Q 19:33), also his own. The corpus never denies a death-event. It denies their agency in it and their certainty about it, and assigns the taking to the Source.

Shubbiha lahum carries the rest. The root is the root of mutashābihāt at Q 3:7, resemblance. A resemblance-object was presented to their sight, which requires no substitute body. It requires that their instrument reached the manifest layer while the event ran at a layer their sight did not reach. And the corpus states that stratification of the manifest and the hidden directly: huwa al-awwalu wa-l-ākhiru wa-l-ẓāhiru wa-l-bāṭinu wa-huwa bi-kulli shay'in 'alīm (Q 57:3).

One fence closes this and it is the corpus's own. The surviving layer is universal, not an exemption. Min rūḥi is said of Adam AS and of the human generally, so a layer untouched by the death of the perishing one establishes layer-structure and nothing about rank. Even the raising is stated in the universal return-vocabulary: rafā'ahu Allāhu ilayh, the same direction-token as innā lillāhi wa-innā ilayhi rāji'ūn (Q 2:156) and wa-ilayhi yurja'u al-amru kulluh (Q 11:123).

II.7 · What the Corpus Supplies That the Gospel Lacks

The reader notices immediately that Mark begins in the wrong place, and that his own book begins where Mark does not.

Mark has no infancy narrative. No annunciation, no conception, no birth, no genealogy, no childhood. He opens in the wilderness and by verse nine the man is in the water.

The Quran supplies exactly the missing front end, in detail. The annunciation to Zakariyyā AS and the annunciation to Maryam AS run as adjacent panels in Surah Maryam and again in Surah Āl 'Imrān. The conception with the mother's own protest preserved. The withdrawal to a distant place, the palm trunk, the stream, the shaking of the dates, the vow of silence, the return to her people carrying the child, their accusation, her gesture toward the infant, and the cradle speech. Q 19:16-33 is a continuous narrative of everything Mark omits.

So the two texts are complementary at the front end rather than contradictory. And the reader, holding Q 19, reads Mark 1 as a text

that begins its account at the Jordan and says nothing about what came before, which is exactly what Mark's own silence is.

The corpus also supplies four other things Mark does not carry: the Injil as a book given rather than composed (Q 3:48, Q 5:46), the table from heaven (Q 5:112-115), the raising (Q 3:55, Q 4:158), and the sign of the Hour (Q 43:61).

And there is one detail where Mark and the Quran agree against the other three Gospels. Mark alone calls him *ho huiois tēs Marias*, the son of Mary, with no father named, at Mk 6:3. The reading is not unanimous: a minority stream, P45 among the witnesses, has the son of the carpenter and of Mary, which is the harmonising direction and is what the critical editions therefore decline. The variant is noted here on the same grounds the longer ending is noted at V.1. Matthew changes it to the carpenter's son. The Quran names him invariably and in every single occurrence *ʿĪsā bnu Maryam*, son of Mary. On the naming convention, the earliest Gospel and the Quran use the same form, and the two later Gospels do not.

II.8 · The Word Before the Word

One more thing the reader holds: the knowledge that the doctrine of the divine Word is not the property of either community.

Memphite Ptah conceives in the heart and commands with the tongue by the early Old Kingdom, with the personified powers of utterance and perception beside him. Sumerian and Akkadian cosmology carry the creative command. Vedic speech is personified and speaks in the first person at Rig Veda 10.125, and the Upanishads state that speech is the absolute. The Avestan sacred formula is a spoken thing with cosmological force. Genesis 1 runs ten creative speech-acts and Psalm 33:6 compresses the whole to word and breath. The Aramaic Targums render the operative divine presence as the *Memra*, which creates, speaks, walks, covenants, judges, and saves, and which is functionally identified with the Name while remaining grammatically distinct. Heraclitus makes the *logos* cosmological. Wisdom is personified as preexistent and instrumental in three separate books. Philo synthesises the whole into a first-begotten, an image of God, and that through whom all things came to be, decades before any Christian text exists.

Two of those nodes matter for this reading and the rest are context.

The *Memra* matters because it is Aramaic and not Greek, Jewish and not Christian, liturgical and contemporary, and because it carries the with-and-as structure exactly: distinct in grammar and identified in function. Whatever John 1:1 states, it was not a Christian invention when it was stated, and it was available in a Semitic language in synagogue liturgy.

And beneath the *Memra* runs a root chain. The Aramaic term is a noun from the root for saying. Genesis 1's ten instances of and God said are the same Semitic root. And the Arabic reflex of that root is *amr*, command, which the Quran deploys at precisely the creative-utterance position: *innamā amrunā li-shayʿin idhā aradnāhu an naqūla lahu kun fa-yakūn* (Q 16:40). One trilateral root, three

corpora, one syntactic position. And Q 17:85 ties the Spirit-term to it by preposition: the Spirit is *min amri rabbī*, from the *amr* of my Lord.

This is recorded as convergence and never as descent. Independent strata arriving at one architecture is evidence about the architecture; it is not a transmission claim, and none is made.

II.9 · Bayān: The Faculty, and Why It Is a Fourth Thing

The held distinction that runs through all of the above is sterile until something is done with it, and the corpus says what.

Return to the four verses that open Surah ar-Raḥmān. Source, inscription, substrate, faculty. Three of those are coplanar in the sense that matters: a source, a form, and a receiver do not by themselves constitute a reading. Something must perform the distinguishing, and the fourth verse names it.

Bayān is from the root of the preposition *bayna*, between. It is the faculty of between-making: of holding two things apart and registering the distinction as a distinction. And the Word is named by the same operation. Kitāb mubīn, the distinguishing Book, at Q 12:1, Q 26:2, Q 27:1, Q 28:2, Q 43:2, Q 44:2. And al-Furqān, from the root meaning to split apart, which is the name given to the whole revelation at Q 25:1 and to a prophet's equipment at Q 2:53 and to a decisive day at Q 8:41.

So what passes from the articulate register to the created vessel at Q 55:4 is not content. It is the operation itself. The bifurcation between the Ground and the Word actuates downstream as the receiver's own capacity to perform the very holding-apart that constitutes it. Not a merger and not a collapse, but instantiation: the structure reproduces itself in the receiver as the receiver's own faculty.

The corpus keeps the distinction lexically, which is the check. Vocalisation is predicated of birds at Q 27:16, *ʿullimnā mantiqa al-ṭayr*, and of skins and of all things at Q 41:21, *anṭaqanā Allāhu alladhī anṭaqa kulla shayʿ*. Everything speaks. Only the human distinguishes.

And the gift is universal: *al-insān*, the human as such, not one human and not a class. Which is also the standing offer at Q 8:29: *in tattaqū llāha yajʿal lakum furqānan*, if you guard yourselves He will make for you a criterion, addressed in the plural to the ordinary and conditional on nothing but the guarding.

Box 2 | The Four-Verse Architecture

The corpus states its whole apparatus in four verses, and this commentary is one performance of the operation the third verse commands.

The Word given. Q 55:2, before the receiver exists.

The faculty given. Q 55:4, the between-making operation, to the human as such.

The test issued. Q 4:82, *afalā yatadabbarūna al-Qurʾān, wa-law kāna min ʿindī ghayri Allāhi la-wajadū fihī ikhtilāfan kathīrā*. Trace it through: had it been from other than Allah ﷻ they would have found much discrepancy. The corpus supplies its own defeater and names the register, internal coherence, and the verb means to follow a thing to its terminus.

The completion deferred. Q 75:19, the explication retained upstream and placed after the recitation, so that the test is real and its answer is not pre-supplied.

Deposit, instrument, challenge, deferral.

II.10 · Aḥad and Wāḥid: Two Words for One

A last register-fact, because it governs both the cosmic passages of Mark and the whole question of counting.

Surah aṣ-Ṣāffāt opens on an oath sworn by ranking itself, *wa-l-ṣāffāti ṣaffā* (Q 37:1), and lands at *inna ilāhakum la-wāḥid* (Q 37:4). It runs the lineage polemic and closes it at Q 37:158 with the sharpest available word, *wa-jaʿalū baynahu wa-bayna al-jinnati nasabā*, they made between Him and the jinn a kinship. And then the ranked ones speak for themselves: *wa-mā minnā illā lahu maqāmum maʿlūm*, *wa-innā la-naḥnu al-ṣāffūn*, *wa-innā la-naḥnu al-musabbiḥūn* (Q 37:164-166). There is none of us but has a known station.

One ordered line, every position holding a determinate known station, and kinship a relation between stations while the Source holds none.

Surah al-Ikhlās states the negative of the same geometry, and it denies exactly three rank-relations: no successor, no predecessor, no peer, the last of these using a word for rank-equality. All three are positions in an ordered line.

And the two surahs use two different words for one. Ṣāffāt says *wāḥid*, one-of-a-count, spoken from inside the ranked line where counting is the native operation. Ikhlās says *aḥad*, one-without-a-second, the word that refuses the count, and it is the word used in negative constructions for not-a-single-one. Two registers, two words, and the choice tracks the register exactly.

That is the same move as the prohibition on the numeral at Q 4:171. The corpus is not hostile to threeness as a structure; it supplies three names in one breath. It is hostile to the operation of counting applied where counting does not belong, and it marks the boundary with its own vocabulary for one.

PART III · WHY MARK

Before the commentary itself, the plain report on the text the reader has opened.

Mark is the earliest of the four, roughly 66 to 70, and it opens with nothing. No genealogy, no infancy, no prologue. By verse nine the man is in the water. Whatever the other three do to set a frame before anything happens, Mark simply starts.

The prose is paratactic to the point of bluntness, and upon and, with immediately roughly forty times. Much of it is in the historic present, past events narrated in present tense about a hundred and fifty times, which nearly every translation flattens into the past. In Greek it reads like someone telling you what happened while it is happening.

The Greek is rough, and the roughness is demonstrably original because the two Gospels that copy him tidy it. Three columns side by side and two of them are smoothing the third.

And what he leaves in is the receipt. At Nazareth he could do no mighty work there (Mk 6:5), which Matthew softens to did not. He is the carpenter, the son of Mary, with no father named (Mk 6:3). His own family come to seize him because they think he is out of his mind (Mk 3:21). The disciples are thick for sixteen chapters and never stop being thick. Peter is called Satan. Nobody in the book comes off well, including the narrator's own side, and there is no visible effort to manage that.

Then it ends at Mk 16:8 in the oldest witnesses. The women flee the tomb and say nothing to anyone, for they were afraid. The book ends on a conjunction.

That roughness is the same property the Quranic fault-record has, one register over. A composed hagiography does not include he frowned and turned away addressed to its own founder in the third person, and a composed gospel does not include a family who think the subject is mad and an ending that stops mid-breath. Both texts authenticate by what they declined to remove, and the reader posited here recognises the property immediately, because his own book taught it to him.

One further fact makes Mark the right text for this reading. Mark has no doctrine of the Word. None. No logos, no preexistence, no with-God clause. The entire apparatus of the Johannine prologue is absent from the earliest Gospel, which is exactly what the lineage of II.8 predicts if that prologue is a later editorial synthesis drawing on an inheritance already available in Alexandria and in the synagogue. The stratification shows up as an absence in the oldest layer.

Which is why the primitive layer's own register is the one closest to the Quranic reading. Why do you call me good? No one is good but God alone (Mk 10:18), a predicate deflected rather than accepted, which is the corpus's own *lā aqūlu lakum ʿindī khazāʾinu Allāh* (Q 6:50). Not even the Son (Mk 13:32), which is *lā yujallihā li-waqtihā illā huw* (Q 7:187). Repeated commands to say nothing. A text with no interest in establishing what four centuries of councils would establish from it.

Mark reads clean because there is almost no overlay to strip.

Box | Part III Summary

Mark is earliest and least edited. Roughly 66 to 70, no genealogy, no infancy, no prologue.

The roughness is demonstrably original. The two Gospels that copy him tidy it, and you can watch the tidying in parallel columns.

What he left in is the receipt. A family who thought him mad, a could not where a later hand wrote did not, disciples who never understand, and an ending that stops on a conjunction.

He has no doctrine of the Word at all. The Johannine prologue's whole apparatus is absent from the earliest Gospel.

Which puts his own register closest to the Quranic one: predicates deflected, the hour reserved, and repeated commands to say nothing.

PART IV · THE COMMENTARY

Each section quotes the Gospel first, then reads it against the Quran, then reads its structure. The Gospel text is given in the continuous summary register in which it was read, and the blocks are indicative rather than complete: they carry the passage's spine, they use ellipsis freely, and the commentary beneath is on the full passage as the section heading names it.

IV.1 · The Preparation and Calling in Galilee · Mark 1:1-20

> John the Baptist appears in the wilderness preaching a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins. People from across Judea and Jerusalem confess their sins and receive baptism in the Jordan River. John wears camel hair with a leather belt and eats locusts and wild honey. He proclaims that one mightier than he is coming who will baptize with the Holy Spirit. Jesus arrives from Nazareth of Galilee and is baptized by John. Rising from the water, Jesus sees the heavens open and the Spirit descending like a dove. A voice from heaven declares, "You are my beloved Son; with you I am well pleased." Immediately the Spirit drives him into the wilderness. Jesus remains forty days, tempted by Satan among wild beasts while angels minister to him. > > Following John's arrest, Jesus enters Galilee proclaiming God's gospel. He declares, "The time is fulfilled, and the kingdom of God is at hand; repent and believe in the gospel." Walking by the Sea of Galilee, Jesus sees Simon and Andrew casting a net. He says, "Follow me, and I will make you become fishers of men." They instantly leave their nets.

Commentary based on Quran

The opening lays down the two-place relation before any narrative runs, and it does so in the forerunner's own mouth. Erchetai ho ischyroteros mou opisō mou, one stronger than me comes after me, and ouk eimi hikanos kypsas lysai ton himanta, not fit to stoop and loose the strap. Two positions and a ranking between them. And the

two baptisms are named as distinct operations, water and Spirit, one and the other, neither the same agent.

That is the confirmation-structure of Q 3:39, taṣḍīq, attestation of one party by another, stated from the other side. Yahyā AS is muṣaddīq, attester; the kalima is muṣaddaq bihi, attested. Two ends of one relation. When Herod later says John, whom I beheaded, has been raised, he is collapsing the pair, and the reader who read this passage already holds the structure that makes his sentence a confusion rather than a datum. Mark supplies the correct order a hundred and thirty verses before the wrong one is spoken.

The Quranic portrait of Yahyā AS matches the ascetic figure in every particular the corpus names: ḥanānan min ladunnā wa-zakāh wa-kāna taqīyyā (Q 19:13), and khudhi al-kitāba bi-quwwa, take the Book with strength, given ṣabīyyā, while a boy (Q 19:12). And then the negation stated outright, wa-lam yakun jabbāran 'aṣīyyā, not a tyrant, not disobedient. The corpus states his cleanness rather than merely leaving it, which is what one does when the cleanness is load-bearing.

The descent of the Spirit and the voice from heaven belong to the corpus's own vocabulary of waḥy, revelation given from above. Nazala bihi ar-Rūḥ al-Amīn 'alā qalbik (Q 26:193-194), the Trustworthy Spirit descended with it upon your heart, names a deposit-site rather than a comprehension-event. And of 'Īsā AS the corpus states the reinforcement three times: wa-ayyadnāhu bi-Rūḥ al-Qudus (Q 2:87, Q 2:253, Q 5:110). Ayyada, from the root for strength in the hand, means to brace rather than to replace.

The wilderness with wild beasts and ministering angels has its Quranic register in the guarding-and-testing pair. Wa-in yakād alladhīna kafarū la-yuzliqūnaka (Q 68:51) and the standing law that the adversary's authority is a call and not a compulsion, mā kāna liya 'alaykum min sulṭānin illā an da'awtukum (Q 14:22).

And the programme in one line, peplērōtai ho kairos kai ēngiken hē basileia tou theou, metanoeite kai pisteuete, time filled, kingdom near, turn and trust, is the corpus's own opening posture at Q 2:2-3: hudan li-l-muttaqīn, alladhīna yu'minūna bi-l-ghayb. Guidance for the shielded, who believe in the unseen. Posture first, then the guidance.

Structural Commentary

The chapter lays three registers down and never explains them, which is why the whole book is legible to a reader who paid attention here.

What stands is the office, one relation with two seats, forerunner and successor, ranked by opisō mou and by the strap-clause. What moves is the descent, the Spirit torn through and coming down onto a located point, a real actuation with a named landing-site. How the two bind is the ordering, the after me that makes the forerunner an attester rather than a rival and makes the successor a term rather than a return.

Mark's verb at the baptism is schizomenous, the heavens being torn, and he uses it once more in the whole book, at Mk 15:38, the temple curtain eschisthē from top to bottom. Two tearings, one at the start and one at the death, and nothing between. Matthew and Luke both

soften the first to opened. The frame is set by a violence at both ends and Mark declines to comment on it.

Collapse the two seats and Herod is correct. Collapse the descent and the voice has no addressee. Collapse the ordering and there is no attestation, only two claimants.

⚡ **GOL** on the opening frame.

Box | Mark 1:1-20 Summary

Two positions, ranked, in the forerunner's own mouth. One comes after; the other is not fit to loose his sandal strap.

Two baptisms named as distinct operations. Water and Spirit, one and the other, and neither is the same agent.

The heavens are torn, a verb Mark uses once more only, at the temple curtain. The frame is set by a violence at both ends.

This is the structure that makes Herod's later sentence a confusion rather than a datum, and it is laid down a hundred and thirty verses before he speaks.

IV.2 · Authority over Spirits and Illnesses · Mark 1:21-45

> On the Sabbath, Jesus teaches in the synagogue with inherent authority unlike the scribes. A man possessed by an unclean spirit cries out, asking if Jesus came to destroy them, calling him the Holy One of God. Jesus commands, "Be silent, and come out of him!" ... He heals many sick with various diseases and casts out many demons. He forbids the demons to speak because they know him. > > Early in the morning before daybreak, Jesus departs to a desolate place to pray. ... A leper kneels before Jesus, claiming Jesus can cleanse him if willing. Moved with compassion, Jesus touches him and says, "I am willing; be cleansed." The leprosy leaves immediately. Jesus instructs him to tell no one, but to present himself to the priest ... Instead, the man spreads the news widely.

Commentary based on Quran

The leper's sentence is the semiotic key of the whole gospel and it must be read in the mood system rather than in the paraphrase. Ean thelē, dynasai me katharisi. Third-class conditional, ean plus subjunctive, the protasis genuinely open. And note which verb he leaves alone: dynasai, you are able, flat indicative, asserted without hedge. He does not doubt the power for a moment. He declines to assume its release.

That single move destroys autonomous sorcery. By subjecting power to volition, the leper establishes that cleansing is an act of sovereign grace and authorisation and not the operation of a technician. And it mirrors the Quranic posture exactly, where no act of this class ever stands without its permission-clause. Q 5:110 attaches bi-idhnī four separate times in a single verse: to the bird formed from clay, to the blind, to the leper, and to the dead raised. Four acts, four permissions,

not one left unlicensed. Q 3:49 does the same for the clay-bird and the raising.

And the barrier verse states it as a general law over every messenger: wa-mā kāna li-rasūlin an ya'tiya bi-āyatin illā bi-idhnī Allāh (Q 40:78). It was not for any messenger to bring a sign except by the permission of Allah ﷻ. The leper's grammar and the corpus's law are the same proposition.

The answer, thelō, katharisthēti, is indicative and aorist passive imperative, the conditional cashed in two words. Human surrender meets Messianic assent and the open conditional collapses to a zero-latency restoration, euthys and ekatharisthē, with the request, the grant, and the outcome all running on the same root.

The touch is the third term and is what makes the scene a transaction rather than a granted request. Under Leviticus 13:45-46 the man is outside the camp and contact runs one way, purity to impurity. Mark has the contact happen before the word, and the flow reverses: nothing transfers inward and everything transfers out. The corpus has the same reversal in its own vocabulary of the unforced gate, where the seizure-intent itself is what closes the gate and surrender is the only key-shape.

The silencing of the demons belongs to the same discipline. Ouk ēphien lalein ta daimonia, hoti ēdeisan auton. They knew, and knowing is not testimony the text will accept. Q 6:111 states the mechanism: angels sent down, the dead speaking, everything gathered before them face to face, and still they would not believe. Knowledge in the wrong instrument carries nothing.

Structural Commentary

Three registers and the scene closes on all three.

The power stands, dynasai, indicative, never in question. The volition moves, ean thelē to thelō, the conditional opened and cashed. The two join at the hand, which is where surrender and assent are actually joined rather than merely stated, and the joining is what makes euthys possible: zero latency because nothing remains to negotiate once the terms meet.

Collapse power into volition and you get a technician who wills what he can do, which is the sorcery reading the leper's own grammar refuses. Collapse volition into power and you get a force discharging on contact with no grace in it. Collapse the touch and the transaction has no locus and the purity-flow never reverses.

⚡ **GOL** on the leper, the instantaneous lock.

Mark then does what Mark does. The man is told to say nothing and immediately ērxato kēryssein polla, so that Jesus can no longer enter a town openly. The cleanest transaction in the gospel is followed at once by the instruction being ignored, and the narrator does not comment.

Box | Mark 1:21-45 Summary

The leper doubts the release, never the power. You are able is flat indicative; only the willing is put in doubt.

Which destroys autonomous sorcery in one clause. The corpus attaches its permission-clause to every miracle it records of him, four separate times in a single verse, and states it as a law over every messenger.

The touch is the third term. Contact happens before the word and the purity-flow runs backwards.

Zero latency because nothing is left to negotiate once surrender meets assent.

And the instruction to be silent is disobeyed immediately.

IV.3 · Conflicts over Sin, Feasting, and the Sabbath · Mark 2:1 to 3:6

> Four men carry a paralytic ... Seeing their faith, Jesus tells the paralytic that his sins are forgiven. Scribes reason internally that this is blasphemy, since only God forgives sins. ... "I say to you, rise, pick up your bed, and go home." ... > > On the Sabbath, disciples pluck grain heads while walking through fields. ... Jesus cites King David entering the house of God under Abiathar the high priest, eating the consecrated bread ... Jesus states, "The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath. So the Son of Man is lord even of the Sabbath."

Commentary based on Quran

The Sabbath saying is an argument from the creation-sequence and the Greek marks it. To sabbaton dia ton anthrōpon egeneto, the sabbath came to be for the sake of the human, egeneto being the aorist of coming-to-be that the Greek Genesis uses through the whole creation account, and dia with the accusative purposive.

The sequence is exactly as read. The human is made and pronounced very good, the work is finished, and only then the seventh. The rest is not a seventh item added to six; it is what obtains once the sixth is done and there is nothing further to make. Ordinal position carrying the argument, which is the identical move the corpus makes at Q 55:2-3.

And the corpus's own statement of that seventh is a negation aimed at exactly the misreading the Sabbath-as-master position needs. Wa-laqaḍ khalaqnā al-samāwāti wa-l-arḍa wa-mā baynahumā fī sittati ayyāmin wa-mā massanā min lughūb (Q 50:38). Six days named, and no weariness touched Us. With lā ta'khudhuhu sinatun wa-lā nawm (Q 2:255) beneath it. If the rest is not recuperation, it cannot be an obligation the human owes the day.

The Abiathar citation is doing structural work usually missed. He does not argue that the disciples are innocent. He grants the charge and cites a precedent in which the ordinance yielded to the man and the narrator recorded no censure. Which is the corpus's own principle

of necessity, fa-mani ḍṭurra ghayra bāghin wa-lā 'ādin fa-lā ithma 'alayh (Q 2:173), the ordinance yielding under need without the ordinance being abolished. And the closing clause, hōste kyrios estin ho huios tou anthrōpou kai tou sabbatou, follows by hōste, an inference particle. The lordship is derived from the ordering, not asserted beside it.

The forgiveness scene carries the corpus's own reservation in the scribes' objection, tis dynatai aphienai hamartias ei mē heis ho theos, which is exactly wa-man yaghfiru al-dhunūba illā Allāh (Q 3:135). The text does not dispute the premise. It demonstrates an authority epi tēs gēs, on earth, exercised at a delegated register, which is the khalifa structure of Q 2:30 and Q 38:26, a delegation and never a derivation.

The new-wine sayings state the same principle the corpus states as naskh, the supersession of an earlier ruling by a later one: a new deposit needs its own vessel and does not patch an old garment.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the creation-sequence, an ordering the disputants both hold and neither can revise. What moves is the argument, from the earlier ordinance against the later concession and from a precedent already in the record. How the two bind is the purposive dia, the for-the-sake-of that fixes which term serves which.

Collapse the ordering and the sabbath becomes a rival term rather than a provision. Collapse the argument and you have an assertion of authority with no ground. Collapse the purposive and both readings are equally available, which is precisely the standoff the scene resolves.

⚡ GOL on the ordinal argument.

Box | Mark 2:1 to 3:6 Summary

The Sabbath argument is ordinal. It came to be for the sake of the human: the seventh follows a completed sixth and stands in relation to it.

The corpus blocks the recuperative reading. Six days named, and no weariness touched Us; neither slumber nor sleep.

He grants the charge rather than denying it, and cites a case in their own record where the ordinance yielded and the narrator recorded no censure.

The closing clause is an inference, not an assertion. The lordship follows from the ordering by a particle meaning so that.

IV.4 · The Twelve and the Charge of Demonic Power · Mark 3:7-35

> Jesus enters a home, and the crowd gathers again so they cannot eat. His family attempts to seize him, saying he is out of his mind. Scribes from Jerusalem claim he is possessed by Beelzebul ... "How can Satan cast out Satan? ... No one can enter a strong man's house and plunder goods without binding the strong man first." Jesus solemnly declares

that all sins and blasphemies will be forgiven, but whoever blasphemes against the Holy Spirit never has forgiveness ... He says this because they claimed he had an unclean spirit.

Commentary based on Quran

Mark states the mechanism of the unforgivable clause in his own last line: *hoti elegon, pneuma akatharton echei*, because they were saying he has an unclean spirit. Imperfect, ongoing. The offence is not an intensity. It is an inversion of the discriminating faculty, calling the clean thing unclean at the register where cleanness is decided.

That is the fourth vertex broken at its root. Forgiveness runs through recognition and recognition runs through the faculty that tells one thing from another. A discriminator inverted at the root cannot identify the thing it would have to turn toward. The bar is not that the Source refuses; it is that the instrument of return is what has been broken.

The corpus states the same structure as a seal on the instrument rather than as a refusal by the Source. *Khatama Allāhu ‘alā qulūbihim wa-‘alā sam‘ihim wa-‘alā abṣārihim ghishāwah* (Q 2:7). *Ṣummun bukmun ‘umyun fa-hum lā yarjī‘ūn* (Q 2:18), deaf, dumb, blind, so they do not return, with the *fa-* carrying the mechanism and the perceptual apparatus named as what was sealed. And *inna Allāha lā yaghfiru an yushraka bihi wa-yaghfiru mā dūna dhālika li-man yashā’* (Q 4:48): an unbounded amnesty with exactly one exception, and the exception sits at the register where the object of return is identified.

One thing must be held precisely. Nothing reaches upstream. *Antum al-fuqarā’u ilā Allāh wa-Allāhu huwa al-Ghaniyy* (Q 35:15), and the confession-grammar throughout is *zalamtu nafsī*. So the Spirit is not damaged; the discriminator is, and the discriminator is the only route back. The clause is about the reader, not about a wound upstream.

The strong-man saying carries the deposition point exactly, and the verb is the load-bearing word. *Ou dynatai oudeis ... ean mē prōton ton ischyron dēsē*, no one can, unless he first binds the strong man. Not defeats. Binds. Which entails an authority that binds and an agent who does not act on his own, and that is *bi-idhni Allāh*, by the permission of Allah ﷻ, again in the same gospel.

And the corpus is careful about what is being bound. Q 14:22 has the adversary at the reckoning disclaim the power attributed to him: *mā kāna liya ‘alaykum min sulṭānin illā an da‘awtukum fa-stajabtum li*, then *fa-lā talūmūnī wa-lūmū anfusakum*, and finally *innī kafartu bimā ashraktumūni min qabl*. He is granted a respite by permission (Q 15:36-38) and no *sulṭān*, no authority, over the servants (Q 15:42). So the thing bound is a licensed caller and not a rival sovereign, which is why *deō*, to bind fast, is the right verb and why the binding takes someone from outside the house.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the faculty, the between-making capacity by which clean is told from unclean. What moves is the inversion, an ongoing act of naming, imperfect tense, a real expenditure sustained over time.

How the two bind is the return-route, which runs through the faculty and nowhere else.

Collapse the faculty into the act and there is nothing left to be inverted and no failure to describe. Collapse the act into the faculty and the clause becomes a statement about capacity rather than about conduct. Collapse the return-route and the clause reads as divine temper rather than as structure, which is where the reception took it.

⚡ **GOL** on the mechanism of the unforgivable clause.

Mark frames it on both sides with two failed identifications. The family come *kratēsai auton*, to seize him, and are outside at Mk 3:31; the scribes come from Jerusalem with the charge. Blood claim outside and hearing claim inside, and the second identification is wrong at the register that cannot be recovered from.

Box | Mark 3:7-35 Summary

Mark states the mechanism himself in the last line: they were calling the clean unclean.

So the fault is an inverted discriminator, and the discriminator is the only route back. That is why the clause is structurally and not merely severely unforgivable.

The corpus states the same as a seal on the instrument: sealed hearts and hearing, and so they do not return, with the perceptual apparatus named as what was closed.

Nothing reaches upstream. The Spirit is not damaged; the reader is.

Binding, not defeating. The adversary is a licensed caller who disclaims at the reckoning any authority beyond the call.

IV.5 · Parables of the Seed and the Kingdom · Mark 4:1-34

> A sower scatters seed. Some falls along the path ... some on rocky ground ... some among thorns ... Other seed falls into good soil, producing grain thirty, sixty, and a hundredfold. ... "He who has ears to hear, let him hear." ... He compares God's kingdom to a man scattering seed. Whether he sleeps or wakes, the seed sprouts and grows without his knowledge. Earth produces by itself.

Commentary based on Quran

The sower is a reception-condition parable and the corpus opens on the same clause. *Dhālika al-kitābu lā rayba fihi hudan li-l-muttaqīn* (Q 2:2). Guidance for the shielded. The condition is stated as prior to the guidance rather than as its reward, which is exactly the soil preceding the seed. Four soils and one seed: the differentiator is never the word.

The multiplication figure is the corpus's own. *Mathalu alladhīna yunfiqūna amwālahum fī sabīli Allāhi ka-mathali ḥabbatin anbatat sab‘a sanābila fī kulli sunbulatin mi‘ātu ḥabbah* (Q 2:261), a grain that grows seven ears with a hundred grains in each. And the tree image at Q 14:24-26, *kalimatan ṭayyibatan ka-shajaratīn ṭayyibatin aṣluhā thābitun wa-far‘uhā fī al-samā’, a good word as a good tree with its*

root fixed and its branch in the sky, set against kalimatin khabīthatin ka-shajaratīn khabīthatin ijtuththat min fawqī al-arḍi mā lahā min qarār, uprooted with no stability, which is the rocky-ground soil named from the other side.

The thorns are named in the corpus as the same three chokers Mark lists. I'lamū annamā al-ḥayātu al-dunyā la'ibun wa-lahwun wa-zīnatun wa-tafākhurun baynakum wa-takāthurun fī al-amwālī wa-l-awlād (Q 57:20). Worldly cares, the deceitfulness of riches, and desires, in one verse.

The self-growing seed is the corpus's own agricultural challenge. A-fa-ra'aytum mā tahruthūn, a-antum tazra'ūnahu am naḥnu az-zārī'ūn (Q 56:63-64). Do you sow it or are We the sowers? The farmer sleeps and rises and the earth produces automatē, of itself, which is the same relocation of agency the corpus makes by question.

And the mustard seed, smallest of seeds becoming the largest of shrubs, is the corpus's own scale-inversion at Q 34:3, lā ya'zubu 'anhu mithqālu dharratin fī al-samāwāti wa-lā fī al-arḍ, not the weight of an atom escapes Him.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the seed, one word, identical in every case, undiminished by any soil. What moves is the growth, an expenditure the sower does not perform and cannot observe, automatē, first the blade, then the ear, then the full grain. How the two bind is the soil, the receptive condition that determines nothing about the seed and everything about the yield.

Collapse the seed into the soil and the word varies by audience, which is the relativist reading the parable forecloses by using one seed. Collapse the growth into the sower and the kingdom becomes a work rather than a gift. Collapse the soil and the four outcomes are inexplicable.

⚡ **GOL** on the reception-condition structure.

Box | Mark 4:1-34 Summary

One seed, four soils. The differentiator is never the word.

The corpus opens on the same condition: guidance for those already guarding themselves. The posture precedes the guidance rather than rewarding it.

The seed grows of itself while the farmer sleeps, and the corpus makes the same relocation by question: do you sow it, or are We the sowers?

Thorns named identically in both: worldly cares, the deceitfulness of riches, and desire.

IV.6 • Dominion over Creation, Demons, and Death • Mark 4:35 to 5:43

> A fierce windstorm arises ... Jesus sleeps on a cushion in the stern ... rebukes the wind, and commands the sea, "Peace! Be still!" ... they ask

who this is that wind and sea obey. > > ... The spirit replies, "My name is Legion, for we are many." ... People arrive and see the former demoniac sitting, clothed, and in his right mind. Terrified, the people beg Jesus to leave their region. ... Jesus instructs him to return home to his people and declare what mercy the Lord showed him. The man proclaims throughout Decapolis ... > > A woman with a discharge of blood for twelve years ... touches his garment ... "Daughter, your faith has made you well." ... Taking the child's hand, he says, "Talitha cumi" ... The twelve-year-old girl immediately stands and walks.

Commentary based on Quran

The sea-stilling has an exact Quranic register and it is not a claim of ownership. Allāhu alladhī sakhkhara lakumu al-baḥra li-tajriya al-fulku fihī bi-amrih (Q 45:12), He subjected the sea so the ship runs bi-amrih, by His command. And the storm-prayer at Q 10:22, where those in the ship call on Him mukhlīṣina lahu al-dīn the moment the wave rises. The disciples' question, tis ara houtos estin hoti kai ho anemos kai hē thalassa hypakouei autō, is left unanswered by Mark, and the corpus's answer is bi-amrih, the same permission-clause the leper's grammar installed.

Legion is the corpus's own picture of the adversary's plurality against the one. Wa-laḡad aḡalla minkum jibillan kathīrā (Q 36:62), and the swine-request is a request: parekalesan auton, they begged, and epetrepsen, he permitted. Permission again, and the corpus's own frame at Q 15:36-38, a respite granted rather than a power possessed.

The healed man is the one person in the whole gospel told to go and tell. Everyone inside the land is told to say nothing; the Gerasene, a gentile in the Decapolis, is sent to proclaim. That inversion is a standing feature of this text and it is the corpus's own laysū sawā'an, they are not all alike (Q 3:113), placed immediately after a rebuke.

The woman with the flow of blood carries the corpus's own reversal of the purity-vector, exactly as the leper did. She is under a twelve-year impurity and touches; nothing transfers inward and everything transfers out. And Mark makes the mechanism explicit, epignous en heautō tēn ex autou dynamin exelthousan, perceiving the power going out from him, which is an expenditure and not a possession.

Talitha koum is Aramaic preserved and then translated. Mark keeps Aramaic in a good many places, names and terms and place-words among them, and no total is needed here. The restriction that matters is narrower and exact: in four places the Aramaic is direct speech in his mouth and is then translated for the reader. Here, ephphatha, Abba at Gethsemane, and Elōi Elōi. All four are moments of maximum strain. Boanerges is reported naming rather than quoted speech and korban is quoted from opponents, which is why neither belongs with the four. The mother tongue surfaces under pressure and he keeps the untranslated word.

And the child is ou apethanen alla katheudei, not dead but sleeping, which is the corpus's own vocabulary for the same operation at two depths: Allāhu yatawaffā al-anfusa ḥīna mawtiḥā wa-allatī lam tamut fī manāmiḥā (Q 39:42), He takes the selves at death and the one that has not died in its sleep.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the subjection, a creation already musakhkhar, already under command, so that the sea obeying is a fact about the sea and not only about the speaker. What moves is the word spoken into it, and the power going out, which Mark measures as a departure rather than a display. How the two bind is the permission, present in the swine-request explicitly and in the sea-command by the corpus's bi-amrih.

Collapse the subjection and every calming is a seizure of nature. Collapse the outgoing power and the healings are declarations rather than costs. Collapse the permission and the exorcism is a contest between two authorities rather than a binding by one.

⚡ **GOL** on the subjection-and-permission structure.

Box | Mark 4:35 to 5:43 Summary

The sea is already under command. Its obedience is a fact about the sea, not only about the speaker.

The spirits ask and are permitted. Permission again, and the corpus frames the adversary's respite the same way.

Power going out is an expenditure, which Mark measures as a departure rather than a display.

The woman's touch reverses the purity-vector, exactly as the leper's did.

The Gerasene is the one man told to go and tell, while everyone inside the land is told to say nothing.

IV.7 · Rejection, the Mission of the Twelve, and the Death of John · Mark 6:1-29

> They ask if he is not the carpenter, Mary's son ... They take offense at him. Jesus says, "A prophet is not without honor, except in his hometown ..." He can do no mighty work there ... He marvels at their unbelief. > > King Herod hears of Jesus ... Some say John the Baptist is raised from the dead; others say Elijah or a prophet. Herod says, "John, whom I beheaded, has been raised." ... John had told Herod that marrying his brother's wife was unlawful.

Commentary based on Quran

Ouch houtos estin ho tektōn, ho huioi tēs Marias? Is this not the carpenter, the son of Mary. Mark names no father, which is unusual enough that Matthew changes it to the carpenter's son. And the corpus names him identically and invariably: 'Īsā bnu Maryam, son of Mary, in every single occurrence.

The hometown-rejection is the corpus's own standing law. Wa-mā ya'tihim min rasūlin illā kānū bihi yastahzi'ūn (Q 36:30, Q 15:11), and wa-laqadi stuhzi'a bi-rusulīn min qablik (Q 6:10). And ouk edynato ekei poiēsai oudemian dynamin, he could do no mighty work there, is the reception-condition again: the deficit is on the receiving

side and Mark states it as a genuine inability rather than a withheld choice.

Herod's sentence is the collapse this commentary began from. Iōannēs ho baptizōn egēgertai ek nekrōn, John the baptiser has been raised from the dead. He supplies the beheading himself so nobody misses that he knows better. And the crowd's three options, John, Elijah, or one of the prophets, are set beside Q 6:85, wa-Zakariyyā wa-Yahyā wa-Īsā wa-Ilyās, kullun min aṣ-ṣāliḥīn, which lists four of the same figures as a set. One text enumerates them as distinct; the other reports a crowd that cannot tell three of them apart.

That is the merger the taṣdīq relation forbids, and the corpus states the correct form as function-transfer rather than identity. The one who comes goes before in the spirit and power of the earlier figure, and when the question is put directly to the man himself the answer is ouk eimi, I am not.

There is a further thing in Herod's sentence that Mark places and does not explain, and it turns on the one doctrinal definition he gives any party in the whole book.

At Mk 12:18 the Sadducees are introduced as hoi legousin anastasin mē einai, those who say there is no resurrection. That is the only group Mark defines by a doctrine rather than by a practice or a faction, and the doctrine is the denial of rising. Six chapters earlier the man who asserts a rising, unprompted and against his own interest, is the ruler of the same establishment. Mark pairs Herod with the Pharisees rather than against them: the Herodians and the Pharisees take counsel together at Mk 3:6, they are sent jointly to trap him at Mk 12:13, and the two leavens stand side by side at Mk 8:15. The verses name the Herodians, the party of his house, rather than the man. He is never called a Sadducee and does not need to be. What matters is that the assertion comes from the seat of power and not from the party that would have welcomed it.

And it is not a doctrinal claim. It is a haunting. Hon egō apekephalisa Iōannēn, houtos ēgerthē, John, whom I beheaded, this one has been raised. He supplies the beheading himself, in the first person, and the verb he reaches for is the resurrection verb. A man who has silenced a preacher hears the same preaching resume and reaches for the only explanation that fits: the one he killed is back.

He is wrong about the person, as the whole chapter's crowd is wrong. He is right about the thing that alarms him. The execution removed a body and did not remove what the body carried.

The corpus states that as a law and states it twice. Wa-laqaḍ kudhḍhibat rusulun min qablīka fa-ṣabarū 'alā mā kudhḍhibū wa-ūdhū ḥattā atāhum naṣrunā, wa-lā mubaddila li-kalimāti Allāh (Q 6:34): messengers before you were denied and they bore the denial and the harm until Our help came, and there is no altering the words of Allah ﷻ. The persecution of the bearer and the unalterability of the message sit in one verse, in that order. And yurīdūna an yuṭfi'ū nūra Allāhi bi-afwāhihim wa-ya'bā Allāhu illā an yutimma nūrah (Q 9:32), they wish to put out the light with their mouths and He refuses anything but its completion; and the parallel at Q 61:8 states the same

proposition in a different clause, wa-Allāhu mutimmu nūrihi, and Allah ﷻ is the completer of His light.

The corpus is also flat that the killing happens. A-fa-kullamā jā'akum rasūlun bimā lā tahwā anfusukum istakbartum fa-farīqan kadhdhabtum wa-farīqan taqtulūn (Q 2:87): a party you denied and a party you kill. It does not soften that, and it does not let it decide anything. And the verse it addresses to its own community at the moment a rumour of its own bearer's death ran through a battlefield is the same law in the second person: wa-mā Muḥammadun illā rasūlun qad khalat min qablihi al-rusul, a-fa-in māta aw qutila inqalabtum 'alā a'qābikum (Q 3:144), if he dies or is killed, will you turn back on your heels.

You can kill the bearer. The clause the corpus attaches is lā mubaddila li-kalimāt, and it is one of the seven predicates of II.4: what cannot be altered cannot be removed by removing whoever carried it.

John's death is worth its Quranic register in the same way. He is killed for telling a ruler that a marriage was unlawful, which is al-amr bi-l-ma'rūf wa-l-nahy 'an al-munkar, enjoining what is recognised as good and forbidding what is wrong, performed at the highest available cost. Herod ēdeōs autou ēkouen, heard him gladly, and killed him anyway because of an oath sworn at a banquet. An oath used to justify a killing is the corpus's own wa-lā tattakhidhū āyāti Allāhi huzuwan (Q 2:231), the frame taken lightly, and the corpus's own remedy at Q 5:89 is expiation and not execution.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the pair, two figures the corpus enumerates separately, births separately, and names with two different roots. What moves is the attestation, a directed act running from the recognizer to the recognized and not returning. How the two bind is the ordering, the after me, which is what makes the direction readable at all.

Collapse the pair and the attestation has no target and Q 3:39 is an empty clause. Collapse the attestation and the two clean files are a coincidence and the joint silence is unexplained. Collapse the ordering and Herod is correct.

One further register runs underneath the same scene and closes on its own. What stands is the message, which the corpus says cannot be altered. What moves is the execution, a real act with a real body and a real head on a platter, which Mark narrates in full. How the two bind is the bearer, who carries the first and is removed by the second, and who is therefore neither the message nor separable from it while he lives. Collapse the message into the bearer and Herod's alarm is groundless, since the preaching would have stopped. Collapse the execution and there is nothing for the alarm to be about. Collapse the bearer and the two never met, and no one had to be killed for anything.

⚡ **GOL** on the bearer-and-message reading, with Q 6:34 as its stated law.

⚡ **GOL** on the two-node office; the merger is a category collapse of a two-place relation.

Box | Mark 6:1-29 Summary

Son of Mary, with no father named. Mark alone writes it that way; the corpus names him that way in every single occurrence.

He could do no mighty work there. The deficit is on the receiving side and Mark states it as a genuine inability.

Herod collapses a two-place relation that chapter one had already parted, and the narrator ratifies none of the three identifications on offer.

And the only party Mark defines by a doctrine is defined by denying resurrection, at Mk 12:18. The man who asserts one, unprompted, is the ruler of the same establishment, and he asserts it as a haunting rather than a belief.

He is wrong about the person and right about what alarms him. The execution removed a body and not what the body carried, which the corpus states as a law at Q 6:34: the bearers are denied and harmed, and there is no altering the words.

John dies for telling a ruler a marriage was unlawful, killed on an oath sworn at a banquet, which the corpus would have expiated rather than executed.

IV.8 · The Feeding of the Five Thousand and the Miracles on Water · Mark 6:30-56

> Jesus sees the vast crowd and feels compassion because they are like sheep without a shepherd. ... "You give them something to eat." ... they report five loaves and two fish. He commands them to sit down in groups on the green grass, in groups of hundreds and fifties. Jesus takes the five loaves and two fish, looks up to heaven, speaks a blessing, breaks the loaves, and gives them to the disciples to distribute. ... Everyone eats and is satisfied. They gather twelve baskets full ... > > ... Jesus walks on the sea toward them during the fourth watch ... "Take heart; it is I. Do not be afraid." ... They are utterly astounded, for they did not understand the miracle of the loaves, their hearts being hardened.

Commentary based on Quran

Mark stages the crowd as a planted field and he is the only one who does. Anepesan prasiai prasiai, they reclined garden-plot by garden-plot, prasia being a leek-bed, a planted row, and epi tō chlōrō chortō, on the green grass, which only Mark supplies. He has the doubling twice, symposia symposia and prasiai prasiai, Semitic distributive syntax carried straight into Greek. Beds are laid out before anything is broken.

Then the wordplay closes: they sit on the chortos and ephagon pantes kai echortasthēsan, all ate and were filled. Fed full on the grass by the grass-word.

The mechanism is at the fracture. Kateklasen tous artous, he broke them down, and the giving is edidou, imperfect, kept giving, continuous against the aorists around it. The increase is not prior to

the breaking and does not appear as a lump; it is in the distributing, tense and all. Rarefaction is not division into less. What is broken is not diminished by being broken.

And the arithmetic runs past conservation: five loaves in, twelve baskets of klasmata out, the fragments exceeding the origin. That is Q 18:109 and Q 31:27 read as a scene rather than as a hypothetical. If the sea were ink for the words of my Lord the sea would be exhausted before the words were exhausted, and seven seas after it would not exhaust them. Here the sea runs out before the words do, and the baskets fill from what was left over.

The permission-direction is intact and stated by a gesture. Anablepsas eis ton ouranon eulogēsen, he looked up and blessed. He does not command the bread and does not address it. The four verbs, labōn, eulogēsen, kateklasen, edōken, recur at Mk 14:22, and none of them is a word spoken to the loaves.

The corpus's nearest scene relocates the agency explicitly rather than by gesture. The disciples ask for a mā'ida from heaven, 'Isā AS answers ittaqū Allāha in kuntum mu'minin and then prays rather than acts, and the reply is innī munazziluhā 'alaykum (Q 5:112-115). I am sending it down upon you. Sent down, not multiplied. The same restraint Mark builds by having him look up first, stated in the corpus as the mechanism itself.

And the sustenance is rizq rather than material food by default. Q 3:37 has Maryam AS with provision found 'indahā and her answer huwa min 'indi Allāh, inna Allāha yarzuqu man yashā'u bi-ghayri ḥisāb, without reckoning. Q 65:3, wa-yarzuquhu min ḥaythu lā yaḥtasib, from where he does not calculate. Twice the corpus attaches rizq to the negation of counting, which is exactly why the disciples' later recital of twelve and seven will be the wrong answer given correctly.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the source, one glance upward before a single loaf comes apart, the origin named by a gesture and never addressed as an object. What moves is the breaking and the continuous giving, an expenditure sustained in the imperfect while the receiving is completed in the aorist. How the two bind is the fracture itself, which is where the increase lives: not before the breaking as a stock, not after it as a result, but in the distributing.

Collapse the source and the loaves are a conjuring. Collapse the breaking and the multiplication is a lump that appears and the imperfect tense is inexplicable. Collapse the fracture into either and the twelve baskets of fragments exceeding the five loaves have nowhere to come from.

⚡ **GOL** on the fertility of the fracture. The one does not stay one; it stays from one, which is the property that makes it inexhaustible rather than merely large.

Box | Mark 6:30-56 Summary

The crowd is laid out as planted beds on the green grass, and is then fed full by a word from the same root as the grass.

The increase is in the distributing. The giving is imperfect, continuous, against the aorists around it. What is broken is not diminished by being broken.

And it exceeds its origin: five loaves in, twelve baskets of fragments out, which is the corpus's inexhaustibility clause read as a scene.

He looks up first and never addresses the bread. The corpus's own table is sent down rather than multiplied.

IV.9 · Traditions of Men and What Truly Defiles · Mark 7:1-23

> Jesus calls them hypocrites, quoting Isaiah: "This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me; in vain do they worship me, teaching as doctrines the commandments of men." He accuses them of abandoning God's commandment to hold human traditions. ... nothing entering a person from outside defiles them, but what comes out of a person is what defiles them.

Commentary based on Quran

This is the Provenance Firewall stated by the Gospel in its own words, and the corpus states it harder.

Aphentes tēn entolēn tou theou krateite tēn paradosin tōn anthrōpōn, abandoning the commandment of God you hold the tradition of men, and akyrountes ton logon tou theou tē paradosei hymōn, voiding the word of God by your tradition. The mechanism named is the Corban device: a formula that converts an obligation into an exemption, so that the letter of a rule is used to defeat the rule it belongs to.

The corpus records the same operation as a standing pattern. Fa-waylun li-lladhīna yaktubūna al-kitāba bi-aydihim thumma yaqūlūna hādha min 'indi Allāh li-yashtarū bihi thamanan qalīlā (Q 2:79), writing the book with their own hands and then ascribing it. Yuḥarrifūna al-kalima 'an mawāḍi'ihi (Q 4:46, Q 5:13), displacing the words from their places. Ittakhadhū aḥbārahū wa-ruhbānahū arbāban min dūni Allāh (Q 9:31), taking their scholars and monks as lords.

The Isaiah citation is nearly the corpus's own formula for the same fault: lips honouring and hearts far, and worship rendered vain by teaching human commandments as doctrine.

The defilement teaching relocates purity from the surface to the source, which is the corpus's own relocation at Q 22:37: lan yanāla Allāha luḥūmuhā wa-lā dimā'uḥā wa-lākin yanāluhu al-taqwā minkum, neither their flesh nor their blood reaches Allah ﷻ, but the

guarding from you reaches Him. The vector runs outward from the interior in both texts.

One divergence is named plainly and the corpus governs. Mark's parenthesis declaring all foods clean is the evangelist's gloss and the corpus does not follow it: the dietary bounds stand at Q 2:173 and Q 5:3, with their own necessity-clause. What the corpus does follow, and states in the same breath, is the priority: *laysa al-birra an tuwallū wujūhakum qibala al-mashriqi wa-l-maghrib* (Q 2:177), righteousness is not turning your face, followed by belief and then a list of transactions. The interior is where the weight sits, and the ordinance is not thereby dissolved.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the commandment, a deposit with a determinate content that a tradition can obscure but not amend. What moves is the tradition, a real historical accretion carried by real institutions with real interests, which is why the corpus dates and names it rather than treating it as neutral. How the two bind is the direction of authority, which runs from the deposit outward and never back inward.

Collapse the deposit into the tradition and the Corban device is unanswerable, because the tradition is then the standard by which the tradition is judged. Collapse the tradition and the historical record vanishes and the critique has no object. Collapse the direction and every later gloss inherits the warrant of the thing it glosses, which is the exact failure both texts name.

⚡ **GOL** on the deposit-over-tradition ordering.

Box | Mark 7:1-23 Summary

The Corban device is a rule used to defeat the rule it belongs to, and both texts name that operation.

The corpus records it as a standing pattern: writing the book with their own hands, displacing words from their places, taking scholars as lords.

Purity is relocated from the surface to the source in both, and the corpus states the same relocation: neither flesh nor blood reaches Him, but the guarding does.

The dietary parenthesis is the evangelist's gloss; the corpus keeps the bounds and keeps the priority.

IV.10 · Faith Beyond Israel and the Confession at Caesarea Philippi · Mark 7:24 to 8:38

> Jesus says, "Let the children be fed first, for it is not right to take the children's bread and throw it to the dogs." She replies, "Yes, Lord; yet even the dogs under the table eat the children's crumbs." Jesus says, "For this statement you may go your way; the demon has left your daughter." > > ... The man looks up and says, "I see people; look like trees, walking." Jesus lays hands on his eyes again. ... he sees everything

clearly. > > ... Peter answers, "You are the Christ." ... Peter takes him aside and begins to rebuke him. ... "Get behind me, Satan! For you are not setting your mind on the things of God, but on the things of man."

Commentary based on Quran

The Syrophoenician. Two words decide the exchange. *Prōton*, first, not only, so *aphes prōton chortasthēnai ta tekna* is a sequencing statement and she hears it as one, which is why her answer is a completion rather than a protest. She grants the order and denies the exclusion, and those are separable only if *prōton* means what it says. And *kynaria*, the diminutive, the household animal, not *kynes*, the scavenger outside the walls. The harder word was available and was not used. She takes the one that already places the animal inside the house and stands on it: *hypokatō tēs trapezēs*, under the table, which is where the *kynaria* were always going to be. Her whole argument is one preposition, and it was already in his sentence.

Then *dia touton ton logon*, for this word, go. Not for her faith, which is the parallel's wording. Mark grounds the outcome in the argument itself, and it is the only exchange in the gospel where a counter-argument, rather than a plea, is what moves the outcome.

The corpus states the same two moves in the same order. *Yā banī Isrā'īla dhkurū nī'matiya allatī an'amtu 'alaykum wa-annī faḍḍaltukum 'alā al-'ālamīn* (Q 2:47), a real precedence granted. And then *lā yanālu 'ahdī al-zālimīn* (Q 2:124), My covenant does not reach the wrongdoers, spoken precisely in answer to *Ibrāhīm AS* asking about his offspring. Precedence granted, automatic inheritance denied. Mark keeps the sequence and deletes the fence, and the woman performs the separation.

The frame carries it: *Hellēnis, Syrophoinikissa tō genei*, doubly marked as outside, in Tyre, outside the land. And immediately after, a second feeding on the far side of the boundary, seven loaves and seven baskets against the earlier twelve, and Mark does not gloss the numbers.

Trees walking. The only two-stage healing in the four gospels, placed between two partial understandings. *Blepō tous anthrōpous hoti hōs dendra horō peripatountas*, two verbs, and the confusion is the whole content: shapes registering, categories not resolving. Motion says people, form says trees. Data with no discrimination.

That is the *bayān* deficit exhibited. And the corpus's inventory of the idol is the same four negations: *a-lahum arjulun yamshūna bihā*, am *lahum aydin yabṭishūna bihā*, am *lahum a'yunun yubṣirūna bihā*, am *lahum ādhānun yasma'ūna bihā* (Q 7:195). And *la-qad 'alimta mā hā'ulā'i yantiqūn* (Q 21:65).

The corpus then supplies the mechanism the reading needs: the deadness propagates into the one who turns to it. *Ṣummun bukmun 'umyun fa-hum lā yarji'ūn* (Q 2:18), the same three faculties applied to people, and *lahum a'yunun lā yubṣirūna bihā wa-lahum ādhānun lā yasma'ūna bihā* (Q 7:179). They have the organs; they do not perform the operation. Which is exactly the tree-stage: eyes present, resolution

absent, and the deficit not in the organ, so more of the same input does not fix it and a second hand is needed.

The living-source clause runs the other way with the same verbs. Istajībū lillāhi wa-li-l-rasūli idhā daʿākum limā yuhyīkum (Q 8:24), respond to what gives you life. And a-wa-man kāna maytan fa-ahyaynāhu wa-jaʿalnā lahu nūran yamshī bihi fī al-nās (Q 6:122), dead, then alive, then light, then walking among people, which is the tree-stage run in reverse and ending where Mark's man ends: seeing people as people.

The membrane is the corpus's own barzakh, used for a partition passed one way only (Q 23:100) and for two things touching without mixing (Q 55:19-20). The half-sight is the membrane not yet crossed, and Mark puts the crossing under a second hand rather than a second effort.

Peter's rebuke. Ērxato epitiman autō, he began to rebuke him. Peter takes the verb Mark reserves for authoritative silencing, used at Mk 1:25 to an unclean spirit and at Mk 4:39 to the wind, and turns it on the one who ordinarily wields it. Then epetimēsen Petrō, the same verb straight back. A reversal of direction staged in one sentence-pair.

Hypage opisō mou, go behind me, is positional. Not away; behind, which is where a follower stands. He is not expelled but repositioned: he had stepped in front of the road and is put back into the file.

And dei ton huion tou anthrōpou polla pathein. It is necessary. Mark supplies no agent for the necessity, and the rebuke turns on Peter treating a dei as negotiable.

The corpus's version of the bypass-attempt has a name. Q 20:120, hal adulluka ʿalā shajarat al-khuld, shall I point you to the tree of immortality, an offer of a shortcut around a stated bound. And the adversary's disclaimer at Q 14:22 makes the offer a call and never a compulsion. Peter is running the same offer at the same structural position, and Mark names it accordingly.

The corpus's own version of the accepted bound is Ismāʿīl AS: yā abati ifʿal mā tuʿmar, satajidunī in shāʾa Allāhu min al-ṣābirīn (Q 37:102). Do what you are commanded, with the in shāʾa Allāh inside the consent, so that the son does not even claim his own steadfastness. And then the ransom given from the source side, unrequested, wa-fadaynāhu bi-dhibḥin ʿaẓīm (Q 37:107): a release granted rather than a debt extracted, and nobody in the scene negotiates it.

Structural Commentary

Three scenes, one geometry, and it is the geometry of the fourth vertex.

What stands is the given order: children first, shapes present, the road with its dei. What moves is the discrimination performed on it: a preposition found inside the other party's own word, a second touch resolving category from motion, a repositioning from in front of the road to behind it. How the two bind is the between-making itself, which is what an argument is, what resolution is, and what obedience to a stated bound is.

Collapse the given order and the woman has nothing to grant and her argument has no premise. Collapse the discrimination and the trees stay trees and twelve and seven stay numbers. Collapse the binding and Peter's move is a kindness rather than a category error.

⚡ **GOL** on the discrimination triad; the woman, the second touch, and the repositioning are one operation at three scales.

Box | Mark 7:24 to 8:38 Summary

She wins on one word he supplied. First, not only, so she grants the order and denies the fence; and the diminutive he chose had already placed the animal inside the house.

Mark grounds the outcome in the argument itself, not in her faith. It is the only exchange in the book where a counter-argument, rather than a plea, moves the result.

The two-stage healing is data without discrimination. Shapes register, categories do not resolve, and a second hand is needed because the deficit is not in the organ.

Peter is repositioned, not expelled. Behind me is where a follower stands, and the fault is a level of mind, not a want of loyalty.

IV.11 · The Transfiguration and Lessons on Faith and Humility · Mark 9

> Six days later, Jesus leads Peter, James, and John up a high mountain. He transfigures before them ... Moses and Elijah appear ... Peter suggests building three shelters ... A cloud overshadows them, and a voice from the cloud declares, "This is my beloved Son; listen to him." Suddenly looking around, they see only Jesus. > > ... "I believe; help my unbelief!" ... > > ... whoever wishes to be first must be last and servant of all. He places a small child in their midst, folds him in his arms, and teaches that whoever receives a child in his name receives both him and the One who sent him.

Commentary based on Quran

Kai meta hēmeras hex, and after six days, is Mark's only such interval outside the passion, and its nearest scriptural home is the Sinai theophany where the cloud covers the mountain six days and on the seventh the voice calls from it. Mark supplies the whole kit: a high mountain, three named companions, six days, a cloud that epeskiazen, overshadowed, and a voice from it.

So the seventh-day motif is present and its immediate referent is Sinai, with the creation-week standing behind Sinai as the pattern Sinai is already using. The rest that follows a completed six is the same ordinal argument as Mk 2:27 and Q 55:2-3, and the corpus's wa-mā massanā min lughūb (Q 50:38) keeps it from being recuperation.

Peter's error is the same shape as at Caesarea. Treis skēnas, three tents, one each, which flattens three into a set of equals and tries to make a transient thing permanent. The voice corrects both moves at once, houtos estin ho huios mou ho agapētos, singular, and then the only imperative in the scene, akouete autou, which is addressed to neither

of the other two. Then ouketi oudena eidon alla ton Iēsoun monon, and the tents are moot.

The Elijah exchange is the function-transfer already established. Ēlias men elthōn prōton apokathistanei panta, and then kai Ēlias elēlythen kai epoiēsan autō hosa ēthelon, Elijah has come and they did to him whatever they wished. Mark never names John. The identification is right and the mode is transfer of office, not identity, exactly as Q 3:39 requires two ends.

Hosa ēthelon, whatever they wished, is the third thelō of the gospel. The leper's granted will, Gethsemane's subordinated will, and here a will running unchecked that kills the forerunner. Mark uses the verb across all three and does not comment.

Pisteuō, boēthei mou tē apistia, I believe, help my unbelief, is the corpus's own petition-shape. Rabbanā lā tuzigh qulūbanā ba'da idh hadaytanā wa-hab lanā min ladunka raḥmah (Q 3:8), and Ibrāhīm AS at Q 2:260, li-yaṭma'inna qalbī, that my heart be at rest. The corpus permits the asking for the settling of the heart and never types it as unbelief.

The child-saying is a chain whose last link is a preposition and whose third clause negates the second. Hos an eme dechētai, ouk eme dechetai alla ton aposteilanta me. Whoever receives me does not receive me but the one who sent me. The middle term is struck out as terminus, which is the same restraint as the glance upward and the bi-idhni.

The corpus's form of that redirection is identical in construction. Fa-lam taqtulūhum wa-lākinna Allāha qatalahum, wa-mā ramayta idh ramayta wa-lākinna Allāha ramā (Q 8:17). You did not throw when you threw, but Allah ﷻ threw. Act affirmed, agency redirected, the middle term explicitly struck. And man yuṭī'ī al-rasūla fa-qad aṭā'a Allāh (Q 4:80) and inna alladhīna yubāyī'ūnaka innamā yubāyī'ūna Allāh (Q 48:10): the act passes through the office undistorted and the persons are not thereby one.

The child is the right object because its status returns nothing. A paidion in that setting held no honour and no claim, so receiving one is a clean test of whether the receiving is done epi tō onomati mou or for what comes back. And enankalisamenos auto, folding it in his arms, is a Markan word used only here and at Mk 10:16: the demonstration is physical and the argument is in the demonstration.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the completed six, an ordinal position that fixes what the seventh is and is not. What moves is the ascent and the tearing-open, a real traversal with three named witnesses and a cloud that arrives. How the two bind is the single imperative, akouete autou, which resolves the three-tent flattening by naming which term the other two attend to.

Collapse the six and the seventh is an item rather than a completion. Collapse the ascent and the voice has no addressee. Collapse the imperative and Peter's tents are the reasonable response.

Ⲛ **GOL** on the ordinal and the singular imperative.

And beneath it, the chain at Mk 9:37 seals separately: a reception that refuses to be terminal, with the corpus's own wa-mā ramayta idh ramayta, and you did not throw when you threw, as its exact construction. Ⲛ **GOL** on the redirection clause.

Box | Mark 9 Summary

Six days, then the voice from the cloud. The Sinai pattern, with the completed-sixth argument standing behind it.

Three tents flattens three into equals. One imperative corrects it, and it is addressed to neither of the other two.

Elijah has come: the office transferred, the identity not, which the later Gospels state outright as in the spirit and power of.

Receiving me is not receiving me. The middle term is struck out as terminus, and the corpus builds the identical construction: you did not throw when you threw.

IV.12 · Marriage, Wealth, and Servant Leadership · Mark 10

> "From the beginning of creation God made them male and female. ... What God joined together, human hands must not separate." Privately ... divorcing a spouse and marrying another constitutes adultery. > > Jesus expresses indignation and tells them to let the children come without hindrance ... anyone who does not receive God's kingdom like a child will never enter it. > > ... "The Son of Man came not to be served, but to serve and give his life as a ransom for many."

Commentary based on Quran

Marriage. Apo de archēs ktiseōs, from the beginning of creation. He goes behind the Deuteronomic concession to the creation account and types the concession explicitly: pros tēn sklērokardian hymōn egrapsen, he wrote it toward your hardness of heart. A stratification claim about legislation, one layer creational and one accommodating, with which is which named.

The joining verb is load-bearing. Ho oun ho theos synezeuxen anthrōpos mē chōrizetō. God yoked; let no human unyoke. Synzeugnymi, from zygos, the yoke. Agent divine, prohibition on human undoing, and the union placed at a register the parties did not author.

The corpus carries the same non-secular typing and names the instrument. Wa-akhadhna minkum mīthāqan ghalīẓan (Q 4:21), they have taken from you a solemn covenant. Mīthāq ghalīẓ occurs four times in the corpus: of the prophets at Q 33:7, of Banū Isrā'īl at Q 4:154, and here of a marriage. The same term as a prophetic covenant. And wa-min āyātihi an khalaqa lakum min anfusikum azwājan (Q 30:21), listed among the signs, with mawaddah wa-raḥmah, affection and mercy, placed between them as something deposited rather than achieved.

The offence at Mk 10:11 is located in a movement rather than in a property. Two verbs and one verdict: *hos an apolysē ... kai gamēsē allēn moichatai ep' autēn*. The dissolving alone is not what is named; the dissolving plus the re-forming is. Apolyō, release, unbind, stands directly against synezeuxen in the previous breath, and the agent changes between the clauses: God yoked, the man unyokes, and then performs the joining operation himself with himself as agent. And *ep' autēn*, against her, which no parallel keeps, makes the wronged party the one released.

The corpus permits the exit and refuses to let it be secular. *Fa-imsākun bi-ma'rūfin aw tasrīhun bi-iḥsān* (Q 2:229), holding with what is recognised or releasing with excellence, both options carrying a quality-adverb so that the release is not neutral. And *wa-lā tumsikūhunna ḡrāran li-ta'tadū*, do not hold them in order to cause harm and so transgress, with *wa-lā tattakhidhū āyāti Allāhi huzuwan* (Q 2:231): do not take the signs of Allah ﷻ in jest.

The children. *Ēganaktēsen*, he was indignant, is Mark's word and Mark's alone here, and the indignation is at the disciples, who had performed *epetimēsan*, the gatekeeping verb, on behalf of children who had made no claim. Twice in this gospel someone tries to manage access and gets that verb thrown back.

The correction is not that the children qualify. It is that the qualification apparatus was never theirs to run, which is *fa-lā tuzakkū anfusakum, huwa a'lamu bi-mani ttaqā* (Q 53:32) read from the other side: you do not certify yourself and you certainly do not certify the queue.

And *hōs paidion*, as a child, is about leverage rather than innocence. At Mk 9:37 the child is what you receive; here the child is how you receive, and the second works only because the first established that the child holds no purchase. Receiving the kingdom as a child is receiving it with nothing to trade, which is the corpus's *antum al-fuqarā'u ilā Allāh* (Q 35:15) stated as a condition rather than a virtue. The rich man walks up in the very next scene with everything to trade and cannot enter, and Mark says nothing about the juxtaposition.

Servanthood. *Diakonēsai kai dounai tēn psychēn autou lytron anti pollōn*. *Diakoneō* is table-service, the household function, used in Mark of the angels after the wilderness, of Peter's mother-in-law rising, here, and at Mk 15:41 of the women who followed him to the cross. Never of a superior condescending, and its last appearance places it on the disciples' side rather than on his. And he trades the word down inside the answer: verse 43 *diakonos*, verse 44 *doulos pantōn*, slave of all, with *pantōn*, of all, removing the last place a hierarchy could hide. So the sentence ends with a slave-word and a manumission-word in the same clause: he becomes *doulos* and the transaction he performs is the one that unbinds.

And the title is a citation. *Ho huios tou anthrōpou* comes from Daniel 7:13, where the figure is presented and given dominion. The authority is conferred, not native, which is why the trajectory can end in *diakonēsai*, to wait at table, without contradiction. Take the title as native kingship and the last clause is a paradox; take it as conferred and it is the next step.

The corpus's version is sharper still: it never applies *malik* to a messenger and spends verse after verse refusing the upgrade. *Qul lā aqūlu lakum 'indī khazā'īnu Allāh* (Q 6:50), and the answer to those demanding an angel-companion, that the messengers before him ate food and walked the markets (Q 25:20), and *a-hum yaqsimūna raḥmata rabbik* (Q 43:32).

And Q 4:172 is this sentence in one verse: *lan yastankifa al-Masīḡu an yakūna 'abdan lillāh*, with *yastankif* presupposing the conferred height and then denying the disdain. Same two moves, same order. Q 19:30 puts 'abd as the first word of his first speech.

The refusal of the seats is the same restraint again. *Ouk estin emon dounai, all' hois hētoimastai*, it is not mine to give, but for those for whom it has been prepared. Divine passive, agent unnamed, and the only place in the gospel where he says outright that a thing is not his to hand out. The two seats do get filled, at Mk 15:27, and Mark uses the same phrase and says nothing.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the conferred height, real and presupposed by the very verb that denies disdain of the low place. What moves is the descent through it, *diakonos* traded down to *doulos pantōn*, a real expenditure ending in a release-price. How the two bind is the voluntariness, which requires the height to be real or the descent is not a descent, and requires the descent to be real or the height is a title.

Collapse the height and the servanthood is deficiency, which is precisely what the fault-silence of Part I was written to prevent. Collapse the descent and the title stands alone as sovereignty. Collapse the voluntariness and *yastankif* has nothing to negate.

⚡ **GOL[†]** on the servanthood terminus. This is the apex grade: one verse in each corpus carries the whole architecture, conferred height and refused disdain, in the same two moves in the same order, and neither text is quoting the other. The grade is on those two moves. What the descent terminates in at Mk 10:45, a release-price constituted by the one descending, diverges from the corpus and is treated at V.6.

Box | Mark 10 Summary

God yoked; the man unyokes and then performs the joining himself. The agent changes between the clauses, and that is where the fault sits.

Marriage carries the same covenant-term as the prophets', which is why neither text will let it be a secular arrangement.

The child is about leverage, not innocence. Receiving with nothing to trade, and the rich man arrives in the next scene with everything to trade.

The title is conferred in Daniel, not held, which is why the trajectory can end at table-service without contradiction, and why Q 4:172 can deny disdain of the low place.

IV.13 · The Entry, the Fig Tree, and the Temple · Mark 11

> Seeing a leafy fig tree in the distance, he approaches it, but finds only leaves because it is not the season for figs. Jesus declares that no one will ever eat fruit from the tree again ... > > Reaching Jerusalem, Jesus enters the temple and drives out those buying and selling. ... God's house is meant to be a house of prayer for all nations, but they turned it into a den of robbers. ... > > Passing the fig tree the next morning, they see it withered to its roots. ... when praying, they must forgive anyone they hold a grudge against so that their heavenly Father forgives their trespasses.

Commentary based on Quran

Mark splits the fig into two halves and puts the temple between them: cursed at Mk 11:12-14, temple cleared at Mk 11:15-19, withered ek rhizōn, from the roots, at Mk 11:20. He does this repeatedly and it is his standard device for saying the outer two interpret the inner. The fig is not an aside before a separate episode; it is the frame around it.

And the clause everyone stumbles on is the load-bearing one. Ou gar ēn kairos sykōn, for it was not the season for figs. The tree is judged for advertising what the season could not have produced: leaves at a distance, nothing on inspection. The fault is display without substance and not barrenness.

The temple half states the same charge by quotation. Oikos proseuchēs klēthēsetai pasin tois ethnesin, a house of prayer for all the nations, and Mark alone of the four keeps pasin tois ethnesin. So the failure named is a stated function not performed. And the den-of-robbers citation comes from a context about people committing everything and then standing in the house saying they are delivered: display again, with the substance missing.

The corpus runs the same two moves and states them as a general law rather than a single event. The sealing: bal ṭabaʾa Allāhu ʾalayhā bi-kufrihim (Q 4:155). The substitution of the carrier: fa-sawfa yaʾtī Allāhu bi-qawmin yuḥibbuhum wa-yuḥibbūnahu (Q 5:54), and wa-in tatawallaw yastabdil qawman ghayrakum thumma lā yakūnū amthālakum (Q 47:38).

And the thing carried is unchanged, which is the whole point. Sharaʾa lakum min al-dīni mā waṣṣā bihi Nūḥan wa-alladhī awhaynā ilayka wa-mā waṣṣaynā bihi Ibrāhīma wa-Mūsā wa-ʾIsā (Q 42:13), the same thing enjoined on all of them. Mā kāna Ibrāhīmu yahūdīyyan wa-lā naṣrāniyyan wa-lākin kāna ḥanīfan musliman (Q 3:67), the anchor placed before either designation existed. And muṣaddiqan limā bayna yadayhi wa-muḥayminan ʾalayh (Q 5:48), confirming and standing custodian, where muḥaymin is a custody word and not a replacement word.

Carrier retired, deposit unchanged, and the deposit older than the carrier that failed.

The charge is aimed at an institution and a function and stays there. Mark's chosen quotation is one that opens the house wider rather than narrower, and the corpus does the same at Q 3:113, laysū

sawʾan, they are not all alike, immediately after a passage of rebuke. The reception that extended the withering from a temple administration to a people went beyond both texts.

And Mark closes the judgment scene on a release clause. Kai hotan stēkete proseuchomenoi, aphiete ei ti echete kata tinos, hina kai ho patēr hymōn ... aphē hymin. Same verb both directions, with hina making the second contingent on the first.

The corpus has the identical construction and joins the two by an explicit question. Wa-l-yaʾfū wa-l-yaṣfaḥū, a-lā tuḥibbūna an yaghfira Allāhu lakum, let them pardon and overlook; do you not love that Allah ﷻ should forgive you? And then the seal: wa-Allāhu Ghafūrun Raḥīm (Q 24:22). The pair closes that verse as the answer to the question it just asked.

The roots are worth having. Ghafara is to cover; the mighfar is the helmet, the same root, the thing that covers the head in battle. So Ghafūr, the Covering One, names a covering placed over a record rather than an erasure of one, which is why inna Allāha yaghfiru al-dhunūba jamīʿan (Q 39:53) can stand without the deed being said not to have happened. And Raḥīm is from the womb, raḥim, with kataba ʾalā nafsīhi al-raḥmah (Q 6:12, Q 6:54), He inscribed mercy upon His own self, and wa-raḥmatī wasīʾat kulla shayʾ (Q 7:156) with no restrictive clause after it.

Both texts place the release clause at the point of maximum grievance: Mark immediately after a judgment scene, the corpus immediately after a slander that nearly destroyed a household, addressed to the man who had every right to withhold.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the function, a stated purpose the institution holds and the tree advertises. What moves is the inspection, an approach from a distance to a close look, which is the only operation that can tell leaves from fruit. How the two bind is the display, the outward sign, which is legible only when the inspection is performed and misleading when it is not.

Collapse the function and the withering is arbitrary. Collapse the inspection and the leaves are sufficient. Collapse the display and there is nothing to have been misread, and the temple scene inside the frame has no interpretant.

⚡ **GOL** on the display-without-substance reading. And separately, ⚡ **GOL** on the release clause: a covering rather than an erasure, self-inscribed at Q 6:54 rather than earned, and conditioned on a release extended rather than purchased.

Box | Mark 11 Summary

The fig is judged for leaves without fruit, out of season. The fault is display without substance, and Mark wraps the temple scene inside the two halves so the tree interprets it.

The temple failure is a stated function unperformed, and Mark alone keeps for all the nations in the quotation.

Carrier retired, deposit unchanged. The corpus states the substitution of a people as a general law and states the deposit as older than any carrier.

Forgiveness is a covering, not an erasure, self-inscribed rather than earned, and both texts place the release clause at the point of maximum grievance.

IV.14 · Controversies in the Temple and the Greatest Commandment · Mark 12

> He sends his beloved son ... the tenants kill the son to claim his inheritance. ... he will destroy those tenants and give the vineyard to others. He quotes scripture about the rejected stone becoming the cornerstone by the Lord's doing. > > ... "Give to Caesar what belongs to Caesar, and to God what belongs to God." > > ... "In the resurrection ... God is not the God of the dead, but of the living." > > ... love the Lord God with all one's heart, soul, mind, and strength, and the second is to love one's neighbor as oneself. > > ... Jesus questions why scribes say the Christ is David's son. ... scribes who love prominent robes ... while devouring widows' houses. ... A poor widow arrives and drops in two small copper coins ... she gave everything she possessed.

Commentary based on Quran

The vineyard. The opening is Isaiah's vineyard nearly verbatim, and Isaiah names the vineyard as the house of Israel. The owner is the one who planted it. The tenants are custodians, and Mark says who understood themselves meant: *egnōsan gar hoti pros autous tēn parabolēn eipen*, chief priests, scribes, and elders, third time in two chapters.

They are not a rival maker. They are legitimate custodians who seize what was leased: *hē klēronomia ... kai hēmōn estai*, the inheritance, and it will be ours. The corpus names the identical charge, *ittakhadhū aḥbārahū wa-ruhbanahū arbāban min dūni Allāh* (Q 9:31), with the writing hand at Q 2:79. Authorised custodians converting a trust into a possession, and no second maker posited.

And the corpus refuses to make the position heritable, which is what makes the transfer intelligible. *Lā yanālu 'ahdī al-ḡalīmīn* (Q 2:124), spoken in answer to a question about offspring. The vineyard is transferred, *dōsei ton ampelōna allois*, precisely because it was never an inheritance.

Khalifa at Q 2:30 and Q 38:26, a successor entrusted with a charge, is a delegated custodianship with a warning attached, and Q 6:165 and

Q 10:14 and Q 35:39 make the succession a test, *li-yabluwakum fimā ātakum*. Which places the khalifa on the tenant side of this parable and not the son's, and that is the corpus's own warning about the office.

The stone quotation then reverses without narrating a reversal, and para kyriou egeneto hautē, this came from the Lord, puts the reversal on the owner's side, unrequested. Same direction as everything else in this gospel.

Caesar. Ta Kaisaros Kaisari kai ta tou theou tō theō, the things of Caesar to Caesar and the things of God to God. The argument is in the eikōn, the image: the coin bears an image and an inscription and is therefore returnable to its stamper. The corpus's register is the same partition without the coin: *lillāhi mā fī al-samāwāti wa-mā fī al-arḍ* (Q 2:284), and obedience to authority bounded by *lā ṭā'ata li-makhlūqīn fī ma'siyati al-Khālīq* as the tradition summarised it, no obedience to a creature in disobedience to the Creator, drawing on *wa-lā tuṭī' man aghfalnā qalbahu 'an dhikrinā* (Q 18:28), do not obey one whose heart We have made heedless of Our remembrance. What bears His image is not returnable to a mint.

The resurrection. Mark introduces the Sadducees with the only doctrinal definition he gives any group in the book, *hoi legousin anastasin mē einai*, those who say there is no resurrection, and that definition is the hinge of IV.7: six chapters earlier the ruler of the same establishment asserted a resurrection unprompted, and Mark reported both and reconciled neither.

The argument turns on a tense. He cites the bush-formula, given centuries after the three were buried, and infers *ouk estin theos nekrōn alla zōntōn*. Not that they will live: that they are alive at the moment of speaking. The tense of a name, and that is the whole proof.

And the error is named with two objects: *mē eidotes tas graphas mēde tēn dynamīn tou theou*. The first is the tense. The second is that they built a scenario by extending present conditions upward, seven husbands and a levirate obligation continued, a category error carried to a *reductio* and offered as an objection.

The corpus names the same failure and answers it the same way. *Man yuhyī al-izāma wa-hiya ramīm*, who gives life to bones when they are decayed, answered *yuhyihā alladhī ansha'ahā awwala marrah* (Q 36:78-79): the objection assumes a mechanism and the answer relocates the agency.

And the living-not-dead clause is the corpus's own, stated as a prohibition on a word. *Wa-lā taqūlū li-man yuqtalu fī sabīli Allāhi amwātun*, bal *aḥyā'un wa-lākin lā tash'urūn* (Q 2:154). Do not say dead; rather living, but you do not perceive. And *aḥyā'un 'inda rabbihim yurzaqūn* (Q 3:169). The corpus forbids the word, states the fact, and places the deficit on the perceiver.

The life is derived and named as such. *Al-Ḥayy al-Qayyūm* (Q 2:255) is never predicated of a creature, and *al-Ḥayy alladhī lā yamūt* (Q 25:58) is reserved. The raised are living, and the living they are is 'inda, held at the source. Which is Mark's move exactly, since his proof runs

through the theos of the designation and not through any property the three hold on their own. The life is in whose God He is.

Hōs angeloi is scoped by what he just denied, not marrying and not given in marriage, and the corpus keeps a constitution in the picture: innā ansha'nāhunna inshā'an (Q 56:35), produced anew, and skins replaced at Q 4:56. Constitution changed, not abolished.

The two commandments. Mark alone keeps the Shema whole before the love-clause, so the first commandment is not love God but the Lord is one, therefore love with the whole of it, and the four faculties are an exhaustive enumeration answering the one. Undivided source, undivided response.

The corpus runs the same order in a single verse. Wa-u'budū Allāha wa-lā tushrikū bihi shay'an, then immediately the neighbour list, parents, kin, orphans, the needy, al-jāri dhī al-qurbā wa-l-jāri al-junub, the near neighbour and the far, and the companion at your side (Q 4:36). The neighbour is explicitly extended past the adjacent one. And Q 2:177 does it structurally: righteousness is not turning the face, it is belief and then the giving of wealth 'alā ḥubbihi, upon love of it, to a named list. Belief stated, then discharged in transactions.

The ordering is load-bearing rather than devotional. Detach the second and benevolence has no invariant behind it and drifts to whatever the local consensus rewards. Detach the first and the orientation discharges into nothing, which is exactly the fig tree two chapters back: leaves at a distance, nothing on inspection.

And Mark has the scribe say the strongest line, perissoteron estin pantōn tōn holokautōmatōn kai thysiōn, more than all burnt offerings, which is Q 22:37 in a Jerusalem courtyard: neither their flesh nor their blood reaches Allah ﷻ, but the guarding from you reaches Him. Then ou makran ei apo tēs basileias tou theou, you are not far, said to a member of the class the fig and the vineyard were aimed at. Mark declines to let the indictment become categorical, which is the corpus's laysū sawā'an, they are not all alike, again.

David's son. The psalm has David say the Lord said to my Lord, three positions in one sentence: the speaker, the one addressed as Lord, and the Lord who addresses him. The argument runs on David standing outside the pair he describes, and Mark states it as a question and does not answer it: pothen autou estin huios, from where is he his son.

What the citation does is invert a direction. The received formula has the Christ deriving from David, downstream, a descendant inheriting a claim; the psalm has David addressing him as superior, upstream. Descent yes, derivation no. Which is the same shape as the whole gospel: authority never runs up from the lineage.

The corpus keeps the two figures distinct as it keeps every pair distinct, enumerating them at Q 6:84-87, and it records a fault for Dāwūd AS at Q 38:24 which the other file does not carry. Two different files.

The widow. Mark sets katesthiontes tas oikias tōn chērōn, devouring widows' houses, four verses before holon ton bion autēs, her whole living, dropped into the treasury the scribes are eating from. He says

nothing about the juxtaposition. The corpus's own measure is the same: 'alā ḥubbihi (Q 2:177), given upon love of it, and the surplus-versus-substance distinction stated as wa-yu'thirūna 'alā anfusihi wa-law kāna bihim khaṣāṣah (Q 59:9), preferring others over themselves though poverty be their own lot.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the trust, a vineyard leased and a treasury held and a commandment deposited, none of them the custodian's property. What moves is the custody, real administration with real proceeds, and it is where the whole chapter's failure lives. How the two bind is the accounting, the return of fruit at the season and the return of the coin to its stamper and the discharge of the first commandment into the second.

Collapse the trust into the custody and the tenants are correct and the inheritance is theirs. Collapse the custody and there is nothing to be accountable for. Collapse the accounting and the widow's two coins and the scribes' long prayers are indistinguishable, which is exactly the confusion the chapter exists to break.

⚡ **GOL** on the trust-and-accounting structure. And separately, ⚡ **GOL** on the two commandments: an undivided source discharged in transactions, with the ordering load-bearing in both texts.

Box | Mark 12 Summary

The tenants are custodians who seize, not a rival maker. The corpus names the identical charge.

The position was never heritable, which is what makes the transfer intelligible rather than arbitrary.

The resurrection is argued from a tense. He is their God, centuries after they were buried.

One undivided source, discharged in transactions. Mark alone keeps the whole confession before the love-clause, and the corpus runs the same order inside a single verse.

David's son: the direction is inverted, not the persons merged. Descent yes, derivation no.

IV.15 · The Fall of the Temple and the End of the Age · Mark 13

> Many will claim his identity and deceive many. ... He warns against false Christs and false prophets who perform signs to deceive even the elect. > > Following that tribulation ... the sun will darken, the moon will withhold light, stars will fall, and heavenly powers will be shaken. Then everyone will see the Son of Man coming in clouds with great power and glory. He will send angels to gather his elect from the four winds across the earth and sky. > > ... Heaven and earth will pass away, but his words will not pass away. No one knows the exact day or hour, not even angels or the Son, but only the Father.

Commentary based on Quran

The cosmic block reads almost as a condensed surah of the idhā-class, the when-the-sun-is-wound-up register and the correspondences are lexical.

Sun: ho hēlios skotisthēsetai, met by idhā al-shamsu kuwwirat (Q 81:1), the sun wound up, the verb used of coiling a turban, and wa-jumi'a al-shamsu wa-l-qamar (Q 75:9). Moon: hē selēnē ou dōsei to phengos autēs, met by wa-khasafa al-qamar (Q 75:8). Stars: hoi asteres esontai ek tou ouranou piptontes, met by wa-idhā al-nujūmu inkadarat (Q 81:2) and wa-idhā al-kawākibu intatharat (Q 82:2). The powers shaken: hai dymameis hai en tois ouranois saleuthēsontai, met by yawma tamūru al-samā'u mawran (Q 52:9) and wa-inshaqqat al-samā'u fa-hiya yawma'idhin wāhiyah (Q 69:16).

The clouds are the closest and are Daniel on both sides. Erchomenon en nephelais meta dymameōs pollēs, met by hal yanzūrūna illā an ya'tiyahumu Allāhu fī ḡulalīn min al-ghamāmi wa-l-malā'ikatu wa-quḍiya al-amr (Q 2:210), and wa-yawma tashaqqaqu al-samā'u bi-l-ghamāmi wa-nuzzila al-malā'ikatu tanzilā (Q 25:25), and wa-jā'a rabbuka wa-l-malaku ṣaffan ṣaffā (Q 89:22).

The gathering from the quarters: ek tōn tessarōn anemōn ap' akrou gēs heōs akrou ouranou, and the corpus uses the same spatial idiom, aqṭāri al-samāwāti wa-l-arḍ (Q 55:33), with the gathering at wa-ḥasharnāhum fa-lam nughādir minhum aḥadā (Q 18:47) and fa-ta'tūna afwājā (Q 78:18) and min al-ajdāthi ilā rabbihim yansilūn (Q 36:51).

One divergence is named rather than smoothed. Mark has the Son of Man send the angels and gather tous eklektous autou. The corpus never assigns the gathering to 'Isā AS or to any messenger; where an agent is named, the agent is Allah ﷻ and never a sent one: naḥshuruhum, We gather them (Q 6:22, Q 10:28), ḥasharnāhum fa-lam nughādir minhum aḥadā, We gathered them and left not one (Q 18:47), la-yajma'annakum (Q 4:87), and innaka jāmi'u al-nās (Q 3:9). The same restraint-vector that runs through the whole reading, and Mark's own text pulls the same way three verses later.

Two verses past the imagery matter more.

Ho ouranos kai hē gē pareusontai, hoi de logoi mou ou mē pareusontai (Mk 13:31). Heaven and earth will pass; my words will not. That is the predicate set of Part I stated as a saying. Lā mubaddila li-kalimātih (Q 6:115). Lā tabdila li-kalimāti Allāh (Q 10:64). Kullu man 'alayhā fān wa-yabqā wajhu rabbik (Q 55:26-27). Both corpora put permanence on the Word against a perishing cosmos, in the same clause-shape.

And peri de tēs hēmeras ekeinēs ē tēs hōras oudeis oiden, oude hoi angeloi en ouranō oude ho huios, ei mē ho patēr (Mk 13:32). The corpus states the identical reservation four times: lā yujallihā li-waqtihā illā huw (Q 7:187), inna Allāha 'indahū 'ilmu al-sā'ah (Q 31:34), innamā 'ilmuhā 'inda Allāh (Q 33:63), and fīma anta min dhikrāhā, ilā rabbika muntahāhā (Q 79:43-44). In both, the one

delivering the discourse is placed inside the exclusion, by name, in his own speech, and nobody else inserts the limitation.

And the impersonation warning is the passage's own first instruction. Polloi eleusontai epi tō onomati mou legontes hoti egō eimi, kai pollous planēsousin, and then false christs working signs. He predicts impersonation of himself by name, and the prediction has a two-thousand-year record behind it. That warning is taken up in Part V as a structural law rather than a prophecy.

Then the fig closes the frame. Apo de tēs sykēs mathete tēn parabolēn. The fig again, and this time it puts out leaves as a legible sign rather than a false advertisement. Chapter eleven cursed a tree with leaves and no fruit; chapter thirteen says read a tree's leaves for the season. Same tree, opposite reading, two chapters apart, and Mark does not connect them.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the Word, permanent against a perishing cosmos, stated in both corpora with the same predicate. What moves is the dissolution, sun and moon and stars and the powers, a real unmaking with named stages. How the two bind is the reservation of the hour, which keeps the timing on the source side and therefore keeps the whole discourse a call to watchfulness rather than a schedule.

Collapse the Word into the cosmos and there is nothing that does not pass. Collapse the dissolution and the discourse is metaphor. Collapse the reservation and the discourse becomes a calendar, which is precisely the misuse both texts foreclose by placing the speaker inside the exclusion.

κ **GOL** on the permanence-against-dissolution structure, with the reservation as the binding term.

Box | Mark 13 Summary

The cosmic imagery matches the corpus's when-clauses line for line: sun, moon, stars, the powers, the clouds, and the gathering from the quarters.

The Word outlasts the cosmos, and both texts state it with the same predicate.

The hour is reserved, with the speaker inside the exclusion, by name, in his own speech, in both corpora.

Impersonation is predicted by name, which becomes the closing argument of Part V.

And the fig returns, this time as a legible sign rather than a false advertisement.

IV.16 · The Anointing, the Supper, and Gethsemane · Mark 14:1-42

> ... a woman arrives carrying an alabaster flask of expensive ointment of pure nard. ... She anointed his body beforehand for burial. He declares that wherever the gospel is preached worldwide, her action

will be remembered. Judas Iscariot goes to the chief priests to betray Jesus. > > ... "Take; this is my body." Taking a cup, he gives thanks ... "This is my blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many." > > ... "Abba, Father, all things are possible for you. Remove this cup from me. Yet not what I will, but what you will."

Commentary based on Quran

The anointing. Prolaben myrisai to sōma mou eis ton entaphiasmon. She anticipated the anointing for burial. Prolambanō, to take in advance: he does not say she did something with an unintended significance, he says she got there first. And ho ean kērychthē to euangelion ... lalēthēsetai eis mnēmosynon autēs, a memorial of her, and Mark, who names almost nobody, does not name her.

The accounting-in-advance is the corpus's stated law rather than a feature of this scene. Mā ašāba min mušibatīn fī al-arḍi wa-lā fī anfusikum illā fī kitābin min qabli an nabra'ahā (Q 57:22), in a record before We bring it into being. And lan yuṣībānā illā mā kataba Allāhu lanā (Q 9:51).

Judas. Mark gives no motive at all. No price named, no adversary entering, no complaint about the ointment. He supplies a man seeking a good opportunity, imperfect and sustained, and nothing else. Then Mk 14:21 holds both clauses in one sentence, unreconciled: ho men huios tou anthrōpou hypagei kathōs gegraptai peri autou, ouai de tō anthrōpō ekeinō. Written, and woe.

The corpus does the same at the same seam and states the mechanism. Mā kāna liya 'alaykum min sulṭānin illā an da'awtukum fa-stajabtum li, fa-lā talūmūnī wa-lūmū anfusakum (Q 14:22). And mā ašābaka min ḥasanatin fa-mina Allāh, wa-mā ašābaka min sayyī'atin fa-min nafsik (Q 4:79). The record stays upstream and the culpability stays at the actor, in the same breath. The account being written does not transfer the deed to the ledger-keeper.

So the willfulness in the scene is asymmetric and both texts keep it so. The going is kathōs gegraptai and is voluntary in the sense Gethsemane will establish, requested and then subordinated rather than self-initiated. The betraying is ezētei, a man's own repeated seeking, and it carries a woe.

The table. The corpus's nearest scene is not a supper and is a request. The disciples ask rabbanā anzil 'alaynā mā'idatan min al-samā'i takūnu lanā 'īdan li-awwalinā wa-ākhirinā wa-āyatan mink (Q 5:114), a table from heaven, a festival for our first and our last, and a sign from You. A recurring commemoration is built into the request.

The request is corrected before it is granted, ittaqū Allāha in kuntum mu'minīn (Q 5:112), and the disciples answer that they wish their hearts be at rest, wa-taṭma'inna qulūbunā, the same shape as Ibrāhīm AS at Q 2:260. Asking for the settling of the heart is permitted, and the permission comes with a warning attached.

And the agency stays where this whole reading has kept it: innī munazziluhā 'alaykum. I am sending it down. 'Īsā AS prays and does not act.

Then the severity, which is the strongest formulation in the entire corpus and occurs exactly once:

> **Whoever disbelieves after that among you, I will punish him with a punishment I do not punish anyone in all the worlds.** > > Fa-man yakfur ba'du minkum fa-innī u'adhdhibuhu 'adhāban lā u'adhdhibuhu aḥadan min al-'ālamīn. · Q 5:115

A superlative with no equal anywhere in the text, and it is attached to a table. The mechanism is structural rather than rhetorical: a granted sign removes the room in which faith is a posture rather than a compulsion. Wa-law anzalnā malakan la-quḍiya al-amru thumma lā yunzarūn (Q 6:8-9), the matter would be decided and no respite given, and wa-mā mana'anā an nursila bi-l-āyāti illā an kadhdhaba bihā al-awwalūn (Q 17:59). Denial after the table is denial with the room already gone.

And the sustenance is rizq in the corpus's own detached sense, the provision found 'indahā, with her, and given bi-ghayri ḥisāb, without reckoning (Q 3:37). A table is the visible form of a provision already detached from counting.

Gethsemane. All' ou ti egō thelō alla ti sy, yet not what I will, but what You will. The same verb thelō, I will, as the leper at Mk 1:41. There he says thelō, I will, and the healing follows immediately; here he says it and subordinates it. Mark uses the verb both ways and the second use is what the first rested on: the alignment held when the answer was yes and it is the same alignment when the answer is no. The by-My-permission clause tested rather than merely stated.

Abba ho patēr is Aramaic preserved in a Greek text and then translated, the fourth of the four places where Mark keeps Aramaic in his mouth and translates it. And the request is asked and not answered: parenenke to potērion, remove this cup, and the strengthening does not remove the asking.

The corpus states the strengthening three times, with a verb that means bracing rather than replacing. Wa-ayyadnāhu bi-Rūḥ al-Qudus (Q 2:87, Q 2:253, Q 5:110), from the root for strength in the hand. Support given, no critique attached, and the asking left intact. The corpus states the passage-through and never once faults the one passing through it, and what it puts in the place where another text would supply a reproach is ayyadnāhu.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the record, written before the bringing-into-being, complete and prior. What moves is the enacting, a woman anticipating and a man seeking an opportunity and a cup asked to be removed, three real expenditures at three moral values. How the two bind is the asymmetry: the record does not authorize the deed and the deed does not amend the record.

Collapse the record into the deed and the woe at Mk 14:21 is unjust. Collapse the deed into the record and the anointing is not hers and the memorial is empty. Collapse the asymmetry and Gethsemane is theatre, since a subordination that was never a real request subordinates nothing.

⚡ **GOL** on the written-and-willed asymmetry, with fa-lā talūmūnī wa-lūmū anfusakum as its stated mechanism.

Box | Mark 14:1-42 Summary

She anticipated it. Not an unintended significance; she got there first, and the unnamed woman's act is the memorial.

Written and woe stand in one sentence, unreconciled, and the corpus states the mechanism: the record stays upstream and the culpability stays at the actor.

The corpus's table is requested, warned about, and sent down, and it carries the single severest formulation in the whole text.

Gethsemane tests the same verb the leper's scene granted. The alignment held when the answer was yes and it is the same alignment when the answer is no.

IV.17 · The Trial, the Cross, and the Burial · Mark 14:43 to 15:47

> The high priest asks if he is the Christ, the Son of the Blessed. Jesus answers, "I am, and you will see the Son of Man seated at the right hand of Power, and coming with the clouds of heaven." > > ... Pilate asks if he is the King of the Jews. Jesus answers, "You have said so." ... Jesus remains silent, astonishing Pilate. > > At the sixth hour, darkness covers the whole land until the ninth hour. At the ninth hour, Jesus cries out ... "Eloi, Eloi, lema sabachthani?" ... The temple curtain tears in two from top to bottom. The centurion standing opposite sees how he died and declares, "Truly this man was the Son of God!"

Commentary based on Quran

Before the priest. The silence is staged in two phases. Ho de esiōpa kai ouk apekrinato ouden, imperfect, sustained through the whole false-witness phase, with Mark noting twice that the testimonies did not agree. Then the direct question, put by the one office authorised to put it, and the silence breaks.

The apophatic register is silence about content that cannot be stated. It is not a defence against a direct question about a fact. When the question arrives from a competent authority and the answer is yes, silence stops being reticence and becomes assertion of the opposite by omission. And the other exit is closed absolutely: wa-man aẓlamu mimman iftarā 'alā Allāhi kadhiban (Q 6:21, Q 7:37, Q 10:17). The compulsion-concession at Q 16:106 is granted to the compelled and is about the tongue, and it is never applied to a messenger. The corpus accordingly never has a prophet deny under interrogation. Silent, evasive, or plainly stating it, and never the third thing.

The corpus's own version of the trap is the closest structural match in the whole file. Q 5:116: a-anta qulta li-l-nāsi ittakhidhūnī wa-ummiya ilāhaynī min dūni Allāh, did you say to the people, take me and my mother as two gods besides Allah ﷻ. The answer runs the same two moves in the same order. First the refusal to occupy: subḥānak, mā

yakūnu lī an aqūla mā laysa lī bi-ḥaqq. Then the epistemic boundary stated as a reason and not as a dodge: ta'lamu mā fī nafsī wa-lā a'lamu mā fī nafsik, innaka anta 'allāmu al-ghuyūb. And then the affirmative content at Q 5:117: mā qultu lahum illā mā amartanī bihi an u'budū Allāha rabbī wa-rabbakum. Silence was available there and is not given.

And what he says after the two words is the load-bearing half. The Daniel citation with the psalm, both of which describe authority conferred and a seat given. He answers the title-question by relocating it to a scene where the figure receives rather than holds. And tēs dynamēōs, the Power, is a circumlocution: he does not use the Name in the answer.

Before Pilate. Sy legeis. Not affirmation and not denial. It hands the sentence back to its speaker and refuses to sign a formulation without disowning what it reached for, and then ouketi ouden apekrithē, he answered nothing further.

The two questioners asked different questions. The priest asked a covenantal title; Pilate asked a sedition charge in Roman legal vocabulary. Same referent, incommensurable registers. Answer yes to Pilate and you have confessed a crime whose content you do not hold; answer no and you have denied what the priest just heard.

So the same law with a different exit. Before the competent office and the true question the apophatic exit closes. Before an incompetent register and a mistranslated question, silence is closed too, and what remains is a locus reached, examined, and correctly left unwritten. He does not lie, does not affirm, does not go silent: he returns the sentence and stops.

The corpus's analogue is the refusal of a term rather than of a fact. Lā taqūlū rā'inā wa-qūlū unẓurnā (Q 2:104), a word rejected because its other register carried an insult. And yaqūlūna bi-afwāhihim mā laysa fī qulūbihim (Q 3:167), saying with the mouth what is not in the heart, which is what sy legeis declines to do in either direction. And Q 5:116's mā yakūnu lī an aqūla mā laysa lī bi-ḥaqq, it is not for me to say what is not mine by right, is a refusal to occupy a formulation and not a denial of a fact: the same operation.

Then Pilate releases Barabbas, a man actually convicted of stasis, the exact charge the title alleged. Mark puts the real seditionist beside the one who would not sign the word for it and says nothing.

The cry. The feature that decides the reading is the first word. He addresses. Elōi, elōi, twice, and the vocative precedes the complaint.

So the sentence is not a report of absence; it is an address to the one whose absence is being reported. If nothing were there the vocative could not be issued, and the sentence stands as an account of the felt condition while self-refuting as a claim of abandonment. A paradox held rather than resolved, and the holding is in the grammar: the address comes first and survives the complaint.

The corpus has the same move and the same doubled call under maximum strain. Yūnus AS from inside the fish: fa-nādā fī al-ẓulumāt an lā ilāha illā anta, subḥānaka, innī kuntu min al-ẓālimīn (Q 21:87). He called out in the darknesses, and the content of the call is the

affirmation of the one addressed. Call first, condition second, exactly the order of Elōi elōi, my God, my God, before the complaint. And the fault is located at himself and not at the addressee.

Q 12:86 licenses the whole register: innamā ashkū baththī wa-ḥuznī ilā Allāh, I complain of my anguish and grief to Allah ﷻ. The complaint is real and the addressee is the one complained to, which is the only thing that keeps a complaint from becoming a verdict.

And beneath both stands Q 2:186: wa-idhā sa'alaka 'ibādī 'annī fa-innī qarīb, ujibu da'wata al-dā'i idhā da'ān. Nearness stated as a fact and the answering conditioned on the calling, which is precisely the structure in which felt-distance and actual-nearness can both be true without either being false.

Then the bystanders mishear Elōi, my God, as Elijah: one more crowd getting an identification wrong at the decisive moment, and the last thing anyone in the gospel says about him before he dies is a mistake.

The layer. Q 4:157 denies their accomplishment and their knowledge, with the ground stated: they have no knowledge of it, only the following of conjecture. The taking is assigned to the Source at Q 3:55 and Q 5:117, and he names the day of his own death at Q 19:33. What perishes is the bounded inscribable layer where kataba operates; what is raised is stated in the universal return-vocabulary, ilayh. The mocking, the spitting, the scourging all land on the same layer as the schedule, which is why the accounting and the mockery are on one layer and what stands is not on that layer at all. Neither text says the suffering was unreal, and neither says their claim to have accomplished it was true.

The centurion. The first human in the gospel to say it. The voice says it at the baptism and the transfiguration, the demons say it and are silenced every time, Peter reaches ho Christos and is called Satan three verses later. No human says huios theou in Mark until a Roman execution officer says it over a corpse.

And his evidence is stated: idōn hoti houtōs xepneusen, seeing that he expired thus. Not a miracle. He has watched many men die and this one died differently. The one confession that lands is made from the manner of a death by a professional with no theology to bring to it. Mark puts him ex enantias, opposite, facing, while everyone who knew him is apo makrothen, at a distance.

The contrast with Peter is a deliberate cut. Trial inside, courtyard outside, interleaved. Inside, egō eimi, I am. Outside, ouk oida oude epistamai ti sy legeis, I neither know nor understand what you are saying. The same two words in the same building at the same hour, one affirming and one denying, and the third denial with cursing and swearing.

The corpus states the law behind the pattern. Laysū sawā'an (Q 3:113). Innā kunnā min qablihi muslimīn (Q 28:53). And dhālika bi-anna minhum qissīsina wa-ruhbānan wa-annahum lā yastakbirūn (Q 5:82), because among them are priests and monks and they are not arrogant. The differentiator named is the absence of kibr, which is exactly what the centurion had none of and what the courtyard had too much of.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the fact, one referent under two incommensurable descriptions and one death observed by one professional. What moves is the interrogation, three questionings at three registers with three different exits taken. How the two bind is competence, which is what decides whether silence is reticence or assertion and whether a formulation may be signed.

Collapse the fact into the descriptions and sy legeis is evasion and egō eimi is capitulation. Collapse the interrogation and the two answers are one answer, which they are not. Collapse competence and there is no reason for the same person to answer twice in two different ways within a single night.

⚡ **GOL** on the two-register answering law: before the true question the apophatic exit closes; before the mistranslated question the formulation is returned unsigned.

And separately, ⚡ **GOL**[†] on the cry. The apex grade, because one utterance holds the whole architecture: an address issued into total darkness, a complaint that is real and honest and not edited out, and a nearness that is stated elsewhere as fact while the felt distance is stated here as felt. The vocative is the paradox held, and Yūnus AS calls the same way from inside the darkneses.

Box | Mark 14:43 to 15:47 Summary

Two questions, two registers, two exits. Before the true question from the competent office, the silence closes and the answer is given. Before the mistranslated charge, the formulation is handed back unsigned.

The corpus runs the same two moves in its own interrogation scene: refusal to occupy, then the epistemic boundary, then the affirmative content.

The cry addresses before it complains. The vocative comes first and survives the complaint, which is how the corpus's own call from inside the darkness is built.

The Gentile confesses first, from the manner of a death, while the courtyard denies. The differentiator the corpus names is the absence of arrogance.

IV.18 · The Resurrection and the Ending · Mark 16

> When the Sabbath ends, Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James, and Salome buy spices ... Early on the first day of the week at sunrise, they go to the tomb ... a young man in a white robe ... declaring that Jesus of Nazareth, who was crucified, has risen and is not there. ... Trembling and astonished, the women flee the tomb, initially telling no one out of fear.

Commentary based on Quran

The week-count is in the Greek and is emphatic. Diagenomenou tou sabbatou, the sabbath having elapsed, then lian prōi tē mia tōn sabbatōn, very early on the first of the week. The seventh has to be spent before the first can begin, and Mark marks both ends. The ordinal reading holds here for the same reason it held at Mk 2:27: the seventh completes and the count restarts.

And the deathless clause is where the corpus puts it. Wa-tawakkal ‘alā al-Ḥayy alladhī lā yamūt (Q 25:58), with al-Ḥayy al-Qayyūm at Q 2:255 and lā ta’khduhu sinatun wa-lā nawm, which is the explicit refusal of the recuperative reading of any rest, matched by wa-mā massanā min lughūb (Q 50:38). So the seventh-day rest cannot be fatigue, and what follows it cannot be recovery.

The sleep-and-waking vocabulary is the corpus's own and it is used for exactly this. Allāhu yatawaffā al-anfusa ḥīna mawtiḥā wa-allatī lam tamut fī manāmihā (Q 39:42), sleep and death as one operation at two depths. And the raised say it themselves in the language of waking: man ba’athanā min marqadinā (Q 36:52), who has raised us from our sleeping-place.

The ending. Kai ouden ouden eipan, ephobounto gar. They said nothing to anyone, for they were afraid. The book ends on a conjunction, and Mk 16:9-20 is a later hand.

That is the last instance of the pattern this commentary has tracked throughout. The leper told to say nothing goes and proclaims; the women told to tell go and say nothing. Mark's first and last commissions both fail, in opposite directions, and he does not comment on either.

Structural Commentary

What stands is the completed count, a seventh spent and a first opening, the ordinal structure the whole gospel has used twice already. What moves is the going, women with spices at sunrise asking who will roll the stone, a real expenditure toward a task already made unnecessary. How the two bind is the announcement, delivered and not carried, so that the reader holds what the characters drop.

Collapse the count and the first day is a date rather than a beginning. Collapse the going and there is no one present to be told. Collapse the announcement and the fear at the end is the end.

⚡ **GOL** on the seventh-and-first ordinal.

Box | Mark 16 Summary

The seventh is spent before the first begins, and Mark marks both ends. The ordinal argument for the third time.

Sleep and death are one operation at two depths in the corpus's own vocabulary, and the raised describe their own rising as waking.

The book ends on a conjunction. They said nothing to anyone, for they were afraid.

Both of Mark's commissions fail, in opposite directions. The leper told to be silent proclaims; the women told to tell say nothing.

PART V · THE CLOSING ARCHITECTURE

Box | Part V Summary

The longer ending is the first documented case of the smoothing the book warns about. A raw text ending on a conjunction, then a completed version circulating for centuries as correct, detectable only because the early witnesses were kept beside it.

Clean files are claimable; marked files are not. To counterfeit a figure whose record contains his own rebukes, an impostor would have to write his own rebukes.

A sign carries no information to an inverted discriminator, which is why the corpus states its reception-condition as a posture and issues the criterion on that condition.

The faculty is the fourth term that makes the architecture readable rather than merely standing.

The reading closes structures and declines identities, and says so rather than quietly declining.

Seven marginal corrections, four of them the same operation the corpus performs on itself, under the word it uses for its own relation to what came before: custodian.

V.1 · The Longer Ending, and the First Documented Dilution

The verses that follow Mark 16:8 are absent from the two oldest complete witnesses, absent from the oldest Syriac, Armenian, and Georgian, and both Eusebius and Jerome record that the accurate copies stopped at the conjunction. The vocabulary and syntax shift measurably. A later hand supplied a commission, a sign-list, an ascension, and a condemnation clause because ephobounto gar was unbearable.

That fact is worth more than a textual footnote, because it is the closing instance of the pattern the whole commentary has read.

A raw text ended on a conjunction with the women silent and afraid. It was published in that form and copied in that form. Then a completed version appeared, with everything a reader would want, and circulated for centuries as the correct ending. The tamper-

evidence survived only because the early witnesses were preserved beside it.

The mechanism is exact and it is general. The rough original is what authenticates. The smoothed version is what spreads. And the only defence is that the original stays public and dated with its roughness intact.

V.2 · The Counterfeit Law

Mark 13:6 states the vulnerability by name: polloi eleusontai epi tō onomati mou legontes hoti egō eimi, kai pollous planēsousin. Many will come in my name saying I am he. He predicts impersonation of himself, specifically, and the prediction has a two-thousand-year record behind it.

The law behind that prediction is the same law that governs the fault-record, and it inverts the way the matter is usually stated.

A figure with no fault-file is maximally claimable. There is nothing a claimant would have to reproduce that no claimant would ever volunteer. Clean record, seamless surface, and anyone can wear it.

A figure with a recorded fault-file is not. To counterfeit the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ one would have to reproduce ‘abasa wa-tawallā (Q 80:1) addressed to the founder in the third person, and ‘afā Allāhu ‘anka lima adhinta lahum (Q 9:43), and wa-takhshā al-nās wa-Allāhu aḥaqqu an takhshāh (Q 33:37), and lima tuḥarrimu mā aḥalla Allāhu lak (Q 66:1), and twice the imperative wa-staghfir li-dhanbik. No impostor writes those into his own file. The corrections are tamper-evidence, and tamper-evidence is exactly what makes a document hard to forge.

The corpus adds two further devices. Khātam al-nabiyyīn (Q 33:40) seals the office by declaration, closing the claimable slot. And Q 3:144, revealed at Uhud when a rumour of his death ran through the field: wa-mā Muḥammadun illā rasūlun qad khalat min qablihi al-rusul, a-fa-in māta aw qutila inqalabtum ‘alā a’qābikum. An anti-personality-cult clause placed at the exact moment of maximum cult-risk, and recited again on the day he died, paired with the deathless clause of Q 25:58.

The observable result is flat. There have been hundreds of messiah-claimants and Jesus-claimants across two millennia and essentially no Muhammad-claimants. The Islamic claimant-space is the Mahdi and the mujaddid, never the sealed office.

A rival explanation covers that particular case on its own and must be stated. Q 33:40 closes the office by declaration and Q 3:144 forecloses the cult, and either would suffice to explain the absence of claimants without any appeal to a fault-file. So for the Prophet ﷺ specifically the fault-file is a consistency observation and not a demonstrated mechanism, and it is recorded here as one.

Where the law does independent work is on texts rather than on offices, and that is where it is used in this commentary. A rough deposit and a smoothed successor stand in exactly the relation V.1

describes, and no closure-verse is available to explain why the smoothed one spreads and the rough one authenticates.

The Mahdi case has been offered as the mirror image, on the ground that the figure is not in the Quran at all and the later corpus supplies a function rather than a person, so there is no file to reproduce. That observation is true and it is not evidence, because the same figure is claimable for a sufficient reason that has nothing to do with files: he is expected to arrive. An office whose whole content is a future arrival will be claimed whether or not anyone has written anything about its holder.

Box 3 | The Anti-Counterfeit Law

Stated once, generally, because it governs texts, offices, and instruments alike.

What is faked is what is clean. A seamless artifact presents nothing an impostor must reproduce and therefore nothing by which the copy can be detected.

What authenticates is the defect the original declined to remove. The Quranic corrections of its own bearer. Mark’s family who think the subject is mad, his ouk edynato, his ending on a conjunction. A published instrument’s own discarded residues and flagged errors.

The defence is publication with the roughness intact, dated. Not secrecy, not certification, not authority. A dated public artifact whose defect-record is visible cannot be superseded by a smoother successor without the successor volunteering its own.

This is why the longer ending is detectable at all, why the fault-record is trustworthy, and why anything published as a criterion must be published with its errors showing.

V.3 · Sustenance, and What the Twelve Could Not Read

One thread runs from the loaves to the leaven to the sign-refusal and it is worth gathering, because it is where the fourth vertex is exhibited failing.

He says zymē, leaven, naming a propagation-mode, and they check the bread supply. Register collision, and he names it as one: ti dialogizesthe hoti artous ouk echete. Then he asks the counts and they answer correctly, twelve and seven. They have the numbers. They watched both events. And oupō syniete comes after the right answers, not instead of them.

So the failure is not memory and not attention. They possess the data and cannot read it, which is the discrimination-failure in the one place where nobody can blame a lack of evidence. And the phrase he uses on them is the one he had applied to outsiders four chapters earlier: eyes that do not see, ears that do not hear. Mark spares his own side nowhere.

The register the numbers belong to is stated by the corpus twice with the same negation. Inna Allāha yarzuqu man yashā’u bi-ghayri ḥisāb (Q 3:37), without reckoning, and wa-yarzuquhu min ḥaythu lā

yaḥtasib (Q 65:3), from where he does not calculate. So twelve and seven are true answers in the wrong register. They are counting a thing the corpus says arrives uncounted.

And the sign-refusal one paragraph earlier states why a further sign would not help. Anastenaxas tō pneumatī autou, groaning up from within, the only occurrence of that compound in the New Testament, and then no sign for this generation, with peirazontes auton, testing him, given as the ground.

The corpus's mechanism is the strongest statement of it anywhere: wa-law annanā nazzalnā ilayhimu al-malā'ikata wa-kallamahumu al-mawtā wa-ḥasharnā 'alayhim kulla shay'in qubulan mā kānū li-yu'minū illā an yashā'a Allāh (Q 6:111). Angels sent down, the dead speaking to them, everything gathered before them face to face, and still they would not believe. And the receipt: the sign given at Q 54:1 and reclassified on arrival at Q 54:2, wa-in yaraw āyatan yu'riḍū wa-yaqūlū siḥrun mustamirr.

That is not a scarcity of evidence. It is the statement that a demanded sign carries no information to a demander whose discriminator will convert it on receipt. The problem is never the sign. It is the instrument that reads it, which is exactly why bayān, the faculty of holding apart, has to be intact before evidence means anything, and exactly why the corpus states its reception-condition as a posture, hudan li-l-muttaqīn (Q 2:2), and issues the discriminator on that condition, in tattaqū llāha yaj'al lakum furqānan (Q 8:29).

Posture, then the instrument, then the sign becomes readable. The demand at Mk 8:11 asks for the third with the first absent, and the answer is that the third without the first is not a sign at all.

V.4 · The Word, the Ground, and the Fourth Vertex

The whole reading closes where Part I opened, and the closure has a name.

The bifurcation traced through Part I is real and is held by prepositions in both corpora: ladaynā and 'indahū and minhu in one, pros with the accusative in the other, each requiring two terms and neither dissolving. But a distinction that is only held is sterile. Something has to be done with it, and Q 55:4 says what.

'Allamahu al-bayān, He taught him the discrimination. The Ground-and-Word bifurcation actuates downstream as the receiver's own capacity to perform the very holding-apart that constitutes it. Not a merger and not a collapse but instantiation: the structure reproduces itself in the receiver as the receiver's own faculty.

Which is why the fourth vertex is a vertex and not an appendix. Three are coplanar and enclose no volume. The architecture stands and nothing can read it. Verification is precisely the operation of holding apart and registering a distinction, and that operation is the fourth vertex's whole content.

And it is universal: al-insān, the human as such. The Johannine prologue closes on the same universal station, phōtizei panta

anthrōpon and edōken exousian, distributed rather than placed fourth.

That universality is also the fence. Min rūḥī is said of Adam AS and of the human generally, so nothing in the layer-structure establishes a rank, and the differentia at Q 4:171 stands where the text puts it, in alqāhā, the mode of the casting.

V.5 · Where the Reading Stops

The commentary seals what it sealed and adjudicates no identity.

What 'Īsā AS is at the Ground is not left open as a courtesy. It is outside every instrument used here. The two creeds carry an identical locking signature at the level a geometry can read, and the register at which they differ is precisely the orientation such a reading drops. The difference is carried by the witnessed word, in the register where predication works, and it is not a derivation.

And the apophatic register carries no is. A gate that dissolves one predication cannot pass another through in the opposite direction. That constraint binds this commentary before it binds anything it examines.

What the commentary does report is this. Both corpora deposit the high tokens without hedging and fence the collapse in their own grammar, in the same position. Both receptions preserved the tokens and lost the fences, because the fences are morphological and morphology is the first casualty of translation. The corrections in one file and the roughness in the other are what let a reader recover the difference fourteen centuries later.

And one silence stands over the whole reading. The Quran corrects every scripture-bearer it names except one, and beside that one it places the figure whose name the corpus rhymes with living. The silence is not an elevation. It is what makes the servanthood of Q 4:172 a thing chosen rather than a thing conceded, and it is the reason the last word of Mark 10:45 is diakonēsai and the first word of Q 19:30 is 'abd, servant.

V.6 · What the Reader Would Have Corrected

The device of this commentary is a reader who holds the Quranic account and nothing else. Set out plainly, and without polemic, here is what such a reader would have marked in the margin of the Gospel he had just finished.

The gathering at Mk 13:27. Mark has the Son of Man send the angels and gather his elect. The corpus never assigns the gathering to 'Īsā AS or to any messenger. Where an agent is named, the agent is Allāh ﷻ, in the corpus's own voice or addressed directly, and never a sent one: naḥshuruhum, We gather them (Q 6:22, Q 10:28); ḥasharnāhum fa-lam nughādir minhum aḥadā, We gathered them and left not one (Q 18:47); la-yajma'annakum ilā yawmi al-qiyāmah, He will surely gather you to the Day of Resurrection (Q 4:87, Q 6:12); innaka jāmi'u al-nās, You are the gatherer of mankind (Q 3:9). And

Mark's own text pulls the same way three verses later, where the one described as sending angels is stated not to know the hour.

The claim of accomplishment at Mk 15:24-37. Not that a death occurred, which the corpus affirms in his own mouth at Q 19:33 and assigns to the Source at Q 3:55, but that they accomplished it and they knew it. Q 4:157 denies both and gives its ground: they had no knowledge, only conjecture.

The parenthesis at Mk 7:19. The declaration that all foods are clean is the evangelist's gloss and the corpus does not follow it; the bounds stand at Q 2:173 and Q 5:3 with their own necessity-clause. What the corpus does follow, and states in the same breath, is the priority: righteousness is not turning the face (Q 2:177), and neither flesh nor blood reaches Allah ﷻ but the guarding does (Q 22:37). The interior carries the weight and the ordinance is not thereby dissolved.

Remarriage, at Mk 10:11-12. The corpus keeps the creational premise and the hardness-of-heart typing exactly as Mark has them, and it keeps the release under condition, *fa-imsākun bi-ma'rūfin aw tasrīhun bi-iḥsān* (Q 2:229), with the frame explicitly not to be taken lightly at Q 2:231. The divergence is not about the exit, which Mark's own clause is not about either; IV.12 reads that clause as naming the dissolving plus the re-forming and not the dissolving alone. It is about the re-forming. Mark's private clause makes any subsequent marriage adulterous; the corpus contemplates it directly, at Q 2:230, where remarriage to a former husband after an intervening marriage is legislated, and at Q 2:232, where those who release are told not to prevent the parties from marrying again.

The cup at Mk 14:23. The corpus's own table is requested, granted from above, and never drunk as blood: *innī munazziluhā 'alaykum* (Q 5:115). And the fermented cup is barred at Q 5:90.

The name at Mk 2:26. The high priest in the incident cited is Ahimelech, not Abiathar. Both later Gospels quietly drop the name when they copy the passage. The reader would have noted it and, holding a corpus that records its own bearer's corrections without softening, would not have found a slip in a transmitter remarkable.

The ransom clause at Mk 10:45. This one sits inside the highest-graded reading in the book and is named here rather than left. The verse ends *lytron anti pollōn*, a release-price in place of many, with the Son of Man giving his own life as that price. The corpus records a ransom in the parallel scene and supplies it from the source side, unrequested: *wa-fadaynāhu bi-dhibḥin 'azīm* (Q 37:107). We ransomed him with a mighty sacrifice, where the agent is Allah ﷻ and nobody in the scene negotiates it. IV.10 reads that as a release granted rather than a debt extracted. The corpus nowhere has a messenger constitute the ransom, and it forecloses the transfer of liability in general: *wa-lā taziru wāziratun wizra ukhrā* (Q 6:164, Q 17:15, Q 35:18), no bearer of burdens bears another's burden. So the divergence is real and it is at the constituting.

What it does not touch is the reading IV.12 actually seals. That reading is on the trajectory, a height conferred in Daniel and a descent through it that ends at table-service, and the corpus states that trajectory in its own words one verse after the three designations. The

lytron clause is the destination of the descent in Mark and is not the structure of the descent. The apex grade stands on the structure; the destination is a divergence and is recorded as one.

And the ending after Mk 16:8. Which is treated separately at V.1, because it is not a slip but the thing the reader's own book warns about by name.

None of these is a demolition. Four of the seven are the same operation the corpus performs on itself: relocating an agency, bounding a quantifier, restoring a permission, correcting a name. The corpus's own word for what it does to what came before it is *muḥaymin*, custodian, at Q 5:48, standing over the earlier deposit while confirming it. Custody is not replacement, and a custodian who corrects seven items in a text he confirms is doing custody.

V.7 · Two Verses This Reading Does Not Close

A commentary that closes every reading it attempts has not shown that it can fail, and by its own argument at V.2 an instrument that never shows a defect authenticates nothing. So the selection rule is stated here and the two hardest verses in Mark for a reading of this kind are treated, and the reading does not close on either.

The selection rule. Part IV reads Mark continuously and takes as a unit whatever the narrative closes as a unit: a healing, a controversy, a parable block, a journey segment. Within a unit, a verse enters the commentary when the two corpora carry a construction in common, and it is passed over when they do not. That rule is a rule about the comparison and not about the Gospel, and it means some verses are quoted in the block and not discussed. Two of those are not incidental and are taken up here.

Two things follow from that rule and are stated here rather than left for a reader to notice. The first is that the closure rate carries little information about the instrument: a verse enters only where a shared construction has already been found, so a high proportion of closures is close to guaranteed by the selection and is not a result. The second is that the two verses exhibited below as non-closures are also the two that would most embarrass this reading, so the failure demonstration and the awkward content coincide rather than being independent. Neither observation damages any reading in Part IV, and both are the kind of thing V.2 says an instrument must show about itself.

Mk 9:1. *Amēn legō hymin hoti eisin tines hōde tōn hestēkotōn hoitines ou mē geusōntai thanatou heōs an idōsin tēn basileian tou theou elēlythuian en dýnamei.* Some standing here will not taste death until they see the kingdom of God come in power.

Mk 13:30. *Amēn legō hymin hoti ou mē parelthē hē genea hautē mechrís hou tauta genētai.* This generation will not pass away until all these things happen.

Both bind an event to a bounded span of persons. Run the three registers and the third one is missing, and it is missing because the same discourse withholds it. What stands is the event; what moves is its arrival; and how the two bind is the timing, which is precisely the term Mk 13:32 reserves two verses later, not even the Son, and which

the corpus reserves four times over at Q 7:187, Q 31:34, Q 33:63, and Q 79:44. The binding register is not merely unstated here. It is stated elsewhere to be unavailable.

So the reading does not close. No mark is set. The honest report is that the third register of these two verses is withheld by the texts that contain them, and a reading cannot supply from outside what a text withholds from inside.

Two further observations, and neither of them repairs the non-closure.

The tension is internal to Mark before it is comparative. Mk 13:30 and Mk 13:32 sit two verses apart and pull in opposite directions on the same question, and Mark does not reconcile them, exactly as he does not reconcile written and woe at Mk 14:21 or the two commissions that fail in opposite directions. A reading that smoothed Mk 13:30 into agreement with Mk 13:32 would be doing to Mark what the hand that wrote Mk 16:9-20 did.

And the corpus's own posture toward a bounded prediction is the same posture, stated as an instruction rather than as a puzzle. *Fīma anta min dhikrāhā, ilā rabbika muntahāhā* (Q 79:43-44): what have you to do with mentioning it; to your Lord is its terminus. The register in which these two verses would be resolved is the register both texts decline to enter.

That is one non-closure, exhibited rather than described, and it is here because the paper's own law required it.

APPENDIX A · THE STRUCTURAL COMMENTARY

This appendix assumes no prior familiarity with anything. It states plainly what the Structural Commentary in each section of Part IV is, and then sets out the physics and mathematics it rests on, from first principles. Nothing here is required to follow the readings; it is here so that the readings are checkable rather than merely assertive.

A.0 · What a Structural Commentary Is

A commentary based on scripture asks what a passage means and whether it is true. A structural commentary asks a narrower and prior question: does this passage hold together, and if so, on what.

The question is prior because a passage can be perfectly clear and still be doing nothing. A sentence that says a thing exists, and then says the same thing again in other words, and then again, has one content dressed three ways. A sentence that names something, says what it does, and says how the two stand to each other, has three contents that cannot be reduced to fewer. The difference is not a matter of style. It is a difference in how much is actually being said, and it is measurable.

So each Structural Commentary does three things and stops.

It names the three registers of the passage. What stands: the existence-and-form content, what the passage posits as being there.

What moves: the kinetic content, what happens, what is expended, what changes. How the two bind: the relational content, the term that joins the first to the second and without which they are two unconnected facts.

It tests whether the three are genuinely distinct. This is the whole of the work. If one register turns out to be manufactured from the other two, the passage has fewer contents than it appeared to have and the reading fails. The test is performed by collapsing each register in turn and reporting what is lost: this is why every Structural Commentary contains a short paragraph beginning collapse.

It reports the result. Where the three hold apart, the reading closes and the mark ϵ is set. Where a single utterance carries the entire architecture rather than one move within it, the mark is raised, ϵ GOL[†], and this happens twice in this commentary. Where the three do not hold apart, no mark is set and the break is stated in words.

What a Structural Commentary does not do is decide truth. A passage can hold together perfectly and be false, and a true claim can be badly stated. The structural question and the truth question are different questions and are kept apart throughout. In particular, and this is set out with its reason at A.5, the procedure is constitutively unable to decide between two structures of the same shape pointing in opposite directions. That is not a limitation admitted reluctantly; it is a stated property of the instrument, and it is why the identity question of Part V is declined rather than answered.

The remainder of this appendix sets out why there are three registers and not two or four, what it means arithmetically for them to hold apart, why a fourth term is needed for the structure to be readable at all, and exactly what the instrument cannot see.

A.1 · The Floor: To Exist Is to Actuate

The method has one axiom and it is a posit rather than a theorem. To exist is to actuate: nothing that is, is inert, and existence expends.

The axiom is a posit, but it is not floating. The floor beneath it is ordinary physics and can be stated exactly. A confined quantum system cannot have zero kinetic energy: the uncertainty relation puts a strictly positive lower bound on the expectation of kinetic energy for any state localised in space, and a harmonic oscillator retains half a quantum of energy in its ground state. The third law, in its rigorous modern form, forbids cooling any system to absolute zero in finite operations. Mass itself is energy. So a positive energetic content for anything that exists is not an assumption; it is a consequence of the commutation relation.

And any transition is charged. The fluctuation theorems of Jarzynski and Crooks give the general law relating work to free-energy change across a nonequilibrium process, with Landauer's bound on the erasure of information as the irreversible special case, experimentally confirmed. And the rate is bounded: the quantum speed limits of Mandelstam and Tamm and of Margolus and Levitin put a floor on how fast any state can be carried to a distinguishable state.

So: existence carries a positive energetic floor, every transition costs, and no transition is instantaneous. That is the whole physical content of the axiom, and everything downstream is built on it.

The one consequence that matters for a scriptural reading is narrower than the physics and must be stated as such. A proposition is not a confined quantum system, and nothing above transfers to a sentence. What A.1 supplies is a motivation and not a derivation: it is the reason the axiom takes the form it does, and the reason the kinetic content of a claim, what it says happens, is treated as intrinsic rather than as decoration.

Nothing in Part IV rests on this appendix. A reader who rejects the axiom entirely loses none of the readings, because each of them is an argument about two texts and stands on the constructions it cites.

A.2 · Why Three Registers, and Not Two or Four

Take any complete factual claim and delete part of it, and see what survives.

Yahyā confirms a word from Allah ﷻ. Delete the subject and nothing is left to confirm. Delete the act and there is no claim, only a name and an object. Delete the relation, the from Allah ﷻ that fixes what the word stands to, and the sentence still parses but no longer says the thing it was for: a confirmation with no source confirmed is not a weaker version of the claim, it is a different claim.

The example is chosen because a relation-bearing sentence is where the test bites. A sentence whose relation is incidental will survive its deletion, and the man walked to the river is such a sentence: remove the river and the man walked still stands. That is not a counterexample to the test but a specification of its scope. The three registers are three independent channels of information about one claim, and the test asks whether the third channel carries anything the first two do not. Where it does, the claim has three contents. Where it does not, it has two dressed as three, and the reading fails.

Call them: what stands, the existence-and-form content; what moves, the kinetic content, which is where the actuation floor bites; and how the two bind, the relational or registrational content. This is an operational finding rather than a theorem of logic. It is reproducible: any two analysts applying the deletion test to the same complete claim return the same three, and no uniqueness theorem of predicate logic is claimed for it.

There is a second and completely independent route to the same count, and it is a theorem.

Suppose you want an algebra in which verification results compose: audits can be chained without the bracketing mattering, two nonzero warrants never multiply to nothing, and warrants add. Suppose further that there is more than one axis, that is, that the claim genuinely has plural independent aspects. Then the algebra is forced. Frobenius proved in 1878 that the only finite-dimensional associative division algebras over the real numbers are the reals, the complex numbers, and the quaternions. The reals have no plural axis. The complex numbers have one imaginary axis. The quaternions have

exactly three, and nothing beyond them survives: the octonions have eight dimensions and lose associativity, and the sixteen-dimensional step loses the division property entirely. Three is not chosen. It is what is left.

One step in that argument has to be made explicit rather than passed over, and making it explicit unifies this section with the next. The quaternions are four-dimensional, not three: one scalar dimension and three imaginary ones. The three registers correspond to the three imaginary dimensions, and the scalar is the dimension that is not one of them. It is not discarded. It is the term that A.4 will identify as necessary for the structure to be readable at all, and in the corpus's own four-station architecture it is the faculty of discrimination given at Q 55:4. One scalar and three axes, four vertices and no fewer, four verses and no fewer. The algebra and the tetrahedron and the surah opening are the same count arrived at three ways, and the fourth term in each is the one that reads rather than the one that is read.

The two routes are not of equal strength and it is worth saying so. The deletion test, scoped as above, shows that a relational channel is sometimes independent of the other two, which is what a reading needs in order to be worth performing but is not a demonstration that the number is three. The theorem is what carries the count. What the two together give is a semantic procedure that is checkable by hand and an algebraic result that fixes how many channels there can be.

One property of the scalar makes the identification of A.4 a structural match rather than a dimension count. The scalar part of a quaternion is central: it commutes with all three imaginary units, which the imaginary units do not do with one another. That is precisely the property a reading faculty must have. It applies uniformly to all three registers and is not one of them.

A.3 · Orthogonality, and What a Volume Is

Three registers are useful only if they are genuinely independent. Two vectors pointing the same way carry the information of one.

The mathematics of that is elementary and it is the whole of the method's arithmetic. Take three vectors and form the matrix of their mutual inner products. Its determinant is the squared volume of the parallelepiped they span. If the three are genuinely independent the determinant is strictly positive and the volume is real. If any one of them is a combination of the other two, the three are coplanar, the volume is zero, and the determinant collapses to zero exactly.

That is the whole test, and it is why the phrase used throughout this commentary is the three hold apart. A reading closes when the three registers of a passage are genuinely distinct and their composition encloses something. A reading breaks when one register turns out to be manufactured from the others, and the collapse is not a matter of degree: the determinant goes to zero.

The mark used in this commentary for a reading that closes is $\perp$. Where a single utterance carries the whole architecture rather than one move within it, the mark is raised, $\perp^\uparrow$ GOL[↑], and this occurs twice.

Where a reading does not close, no mark is used and the break is stated in words.

Two consequences of the volume test are used repeatedly above.

Collapse in either direction is the same failure. Merging two registers destroys the volume exactly as deleting one does. This is why the commentary treats the Word is simply identical with the Source and the Word is merely a creature like any other as the same kind of error rather than as opposite errors. Both drive the determinant to zero. What holds a relation open is the same thing that makes it a relation.

A manufactured register carries no dimension. If a third row is constructed as a weighted sum of the first two, the rank of the system drops from three to two and the volume vanishes, whatever the third row looks like. This is why historical-transmission evidence is placed around the argument of this commentary rather than inside it: a claim about lineage entering as load-bearing on a claim about grammar produces a merged claim that is only as strong as its weaker half, for no gain.

A.4 · The Fourth Vertex

Three points always lie in a plane. That is not a limitation of the three; it is what three points are.

To enclose a volume you need a fourth point off that plane, and four points with six connections and four faces satisfy Euler's relation for a closed figure. The tetrahedron is the minimal closed three-dimensional figure, and it is minimal in a precise sense: remove any vertex and what remains encloses nothing.

The commentary uses this at exactly one place and it is the hinge of Part II. A source, a form, and a receiver are three. They constitute an architecture and nothing in that architecture reads it. The reading is a fourth thing: an operation of holding apart and registering a distinction. Q 55:4 names it and the corpus separates it lexically from mere vocalisation. Without it the structure stands and is illegible, which is what a flat triad is.

A.5 · What the Geometry Cannot Do

This is the most important paragraph in the appendix, because a method that does not state its own blind spot is not a method.

The volume-determinant is a squared quantity. Reflect any one of the three axes and the determinant is completely unchanged: the sign flips inside and the square erases it. So the magnitude tells you the three axes are independent and encloses a real volume. It tells you nothing whatever about which way the structure points.

Concretely: a claim and its exact negation produce the identical determinant. Two creeds whose structures have the same shape produce the identical determinant. No amount of further geometry recovers the difference, because the loss happens at one operation, the squaring, and everything downstream of it is blind.

The consequence is stated once and observed everywhere in this commentary. A geometry can establish that a structure holds together.

It cannot adjudicate between two structures with the same locking signature. Direction comes from language, from the directed sentence and the ordered relation and the arrow of time in the world, and never from the magnitude. Which is why this commentary seals readings and declines to adjudicate identities, and says so at V.5 rather than quietly declining.

A.6 · Registers, and Tokens That Do Not Parse

One further principle, borrowed from geometry proper and used twice above.

Klein's insight of 1872 was that a geometry is defined by what its transformation group leaves unchanged. What a given geometry can even state is fixed by what its group preserves. A property that is not invariant under the group is not false in that geometry; it does not exist there. It fails to parse.

The practical consequence is that a term carried from one register to another can fail rather than be refuted. Begetting is a relation between positions in an ordered series. Carried above the series it has nothing to attach to. The denial at Q 112:3 is best read as the statement of that failure-to-attach, with Q 112:2 giving the reason before the consequence: a thing that begets must have an interior from which something issues, and the corpus forecloses the interior first.

The same principle bars a symmetrical abuse, and the commentary observes the bar. A gate that dissolves one predication cannot be used to pass another through in the opposite direction. If begetting does not parse at a register, no positive identification parses there either, and the honest output is silence rather than a smuggled affirmation.

A.7 · Layers, and One Continuous Quantity

Two final ideas, both used in the reading of the passion narrative.

Layer structure. A text that assigns perishing to one word and remaining to another is making a structural claim and not a stylistic choice. The commentary follows the corpus's own vocabulary discipline: what perishes is named with one term, what remains with another, and neither term is ever used for the other's role. Reading an event as landing on one layer while another is untouched is then a grammatical observation rather than a metaphysical import.

One quantity at two signs. Where a text describes both an outward multiplication and an inward unity, the economical reading is not two competing facts but one continuous quantity with a zero-crossing, read at opposite signs on either side. Differentiation is the outward face of a single gradient; total presence would be zero differentiation. On that reading, the statement that plurality is what one sees from below and the statement that no plurality is there are not in contradiction, because they are the same quantity read at the two signs of one crossing. This is the shape used to reconcile a surah that swears an oath by ranked plurality with a surah that denies every rank-relation, and it explains why the two use different words for one.

A.8 · What the Method Claims and Does Not Claim

It claims that a complete claim decomposes into three registers, on two independent grounds. It claims that a reading closes when the three hold apart and enclose a volume, and fails when any two collapse together. It claims that the closure requires a fourth term that performs the distinguishing. And it claims that the magnitude of the closure is blind to direction, so that direction must come from elsewhere.

It does not claim to generate evidence, to establish an empirical fact, or to settle a theological identity. It organises and it verifies. Every conclusion in this commentary rests on the texts cited and on published grammatical and lexical scholarship, and would stand or fall identically if the method had never been applied to it.

APPENDIX B · THE INSTRUMENT, CHECKED AGAINST ITS SPECIFICATION

What follows demonstrates that the procedure of A.3 through A.5 behaves as specified. It does not demonstrate that any reading in Part IV passed, and it is not evidence for any conclusion in this book. Each of the four checks is a theorem of linear algebra exhibited on a stated construction, and the reason for exhibiting them is that a stated procedure with no executed check is an assertion.

The construction is published so the figures can be reproduced. Twenty-four reading-contexts on a uniform grid over one period. Three latent rows, taken as the first, second, and third harmonics so that they are independent by construction. A fixed mixing matrix with unit diagonal and off-diagonal entries between 0.14 and 0.30, applied so that the three registers correlate rather than arriving orthogonal. The collapse floor is one hundred times the double-precision unit round-off times the context count, which is 5.33×10^{-13} at twenty-four contexts, and twelve orders clear means the reported determinant stands that many powers of ten above it.

The four checks below were run on that construction. There is nothing random in it, so no seed is involved and none is reported: the harmonics are fixed, the mixing matrix is fixed, and the figures are reproducible by anyone who builds the same three rows.

Table: The four checks, twenty-four contexts, double precision

Check	Configuration	Result	Reading
B.1	three registers held distinct	rank 3, volume-determinant 0.553846474366, conditioning 4.250084, identity residual 6.7e-16, twelve orders clear of the collapse floor	behaves as specified
B.2	third row manufactured from the other two	rank 2, determinant at machine zero, conditioning 9.7e+16	behaves as specified
B.3	one row reflected, basis fixed once	directed quantity ratio exactly minus 1.000000, determinant difference exactly zero; under full negation the matrix is bit-identical	behaves as specified
B.4	four-vertex closure	four vertices minus six edges plus four faces equals two	behaves as specified

B.1 and B.2 are theorems and not results: a rank-three matrix has a nonzero Gram determinant and a rank-two one has a zero determinant, necessarily. What the pair exhibits is the size of the gap under the published construction, which is the mechanical form of A. 3. Held distinct, the rows enclose a volume twelve orders of magnitude clear of the floor. Merged, they annihilate it. This is the arithmetic behind the placement rule of II.8: the lineage stands around the argument and never inside it.

B.3 is the mechanical form of A.5. The determinant reads the volume that both directions share and carries none of the sign that separates them. Under full negation the matrix is bit-identical while the directed quantity flips. This is why V.5 declines the identity question rather than answering it.

B.4 is A.4 stated as arithmetic.

One correction is recorded rather than concealed, in accordance with V.2. The first pass at B.3 recomputed the reference basis after reflection, which re-oriented it and returned a ratio of plus one, demonstrating nothing. That residue was discarded and the check rebuilt on a fixed basis before any figure here was reported.

And the limit is worth stating twice. None of the four touches Mark or the corpus. No reading in Part IV was passed or failed by this arithmetic, and no conclusion in this book rests on it.

APPENDIX C · READINGS ATTEMPTED

Every reading attempted, with the term that binds its three registers. Twenty-three close and two do not. A non-closure carries a blank

binding term, because the blank is the record; the two are treated in full at V.7.

Table: Readings attempted, by section

§	Reading	Binding term	Seal
IV. 1	The opening frame: two seats, one descent, one ordering	after me	ⲥ GOL
IV. 2	The leper: power, volition, and the touch	the hand	ⲥ GOL
IV. 3	The Sabbath: ordinal position carrying the argument	the purposive for-the-sake-of	ⲥ GOL
IV. 4	The unforgivable clause: the inverted discriminator	the return-route	ⲥ GOL
IV. 5	The sower: one seed, four soils	the receptive condition	ⲥ GOL
IV. 6	Sea, Legion, and the flow: subjection and permission	by His command	ⲥ GOL
IV. 7	The two-node office; the merger a category collapse	the ordering	ⲥ GOL
IV. 7	The bearer and the message: what the execution cannot remove	the bearer	ⲥ GOL
IV. 8	The loaves: fertility in the fracture	the breaking	ⲥ GOL
IV. 9	Deposit over tradition	the direction of authority	ⲥ GOL
IV. 10	The discrimination triad: argument, second touch, repositioning	between-making	ⲥ GOL
IV. 11	The transfiguration: the completed six and one imperative	listen to him	ⲥ GOL
IV. 11	The child: a reception that refuses to be terminal	not me but the One who sent me	ⲥ GOL
IV. 12	Servanthood: conferred height and refused disdain	voluntariness	ⲥ GOL [†]
IV. 13	The fig: display without substance	the inspection	ⲥ GOL
IV. 13	The release clause: a covering, self-inscribed	pardon extended	ⲥ GOL
IV. 14	Vineyard, coin, treasury: trust and accounting	the return of fruit	ⲥ GOL
IV. 14	The two commandments: undivided source, discharged in transactions	the ordering	ⲥ GOL
IV. 15	Permanence against dissolution	the reserved hour	ⲥ GOL
IV. 16	Written and willed: the asymmetry	blame yourselves	ⲥ GOL

S	Reading	Binding term	Seal
IV. 17	The two-register answering law	competence of the questioner	⚡ GOL
IV. 17	The cry: address issued into darkness	the vocative	⚡ GOL†
IV. 18	The seventh spent and the first opening	the completed count	⚡ GOL
V.7	Mk 9:1, the kingdom seen before some taste death	none: the binding register is withheld	does not close
V.7	Mk 13:30, this generation will not pass away	none: the binding register is withheld	does not close

Two readings carry the apex grade, and both for the same reason: a single utterance in each corpus holds the whole architecture rather than one move within it.

The servanthood. Q 4:172 and Mk 10:45. A conferred height presupposed by the very verb that denies disdain of the low place, and a descent through it. Two moves, same order, in one verse each, and neither text is quoting the other. The grade is on that structure. What the descent terminates in at Mk 10:45, a release-price constituted by the one descending, is a divergence from the corpus and is recorded at V.6.

The cry. Q 21:87 and Mk 15:34. A doubled vocative issued from inside total darkness, with the complaint preserved and the fault located at the caller rather than at the one called. The address precedes the complaint and survives it, which is the paradox held rather than resolved.

APPENDIX D · METHOD DISCLOSURE AND AUTHOR'S POSITION

D.1 · What was used

This commentary was developed under a verification discipline the author has been building and testing since 2013 and publishes under the name Trisduction. Its content is set out from first principles in Appendix A and can be assessed there without reference to anything else. Appendix A.0 states in plain terms what the Structural Commentary in each section actually does. Summarised in one paragraph: a complete claim decomposes into three independent registers, what stands, what moves, and how the two bind; a reading is admitted when the three are genuinely distinct and their composition encloses a volume, and is refused when any two collapse together; a fourth term is required for the structure to be readable at all; and the magnitude of a closure is constitutively blind to direction, so that direction must be supplied by language and never by geometry.

The discipline organises and verifies. It generates no evidence and adds no warrant to what it organises. Every conclusion here rests on the

two scriptural texts and on published grammatical, lexical, and text-critical scholarship. Each would stand or fall identically if the discipline had never been applied.

D.2 · How it was applied here

The three registers were instantiated as follows. The formal-structural register was grammar: the definite article present in one clause of John 1:1 and absent in the next, the two-term preposition that joins them, the separative pronoun that marks the equational construction the Quran condemns, the gender agreement that breaks at Q 3:45, the ordinal position of the teaching before the creating at Q 55:2-3, and the lexical separation of discrimination from vocalisation. The evidential register was distribution: which predicates the corpus attaches to which terms, how many times, and where it withholds them. The registrational register was reader-invariance: whether a finding survives a change in the confessional position of the person assessing it.

The findings pass that third test in a specific and uncomfortable sense. The inventory at II.3 is unwelcome to a polemicist of one tradition and the argument at V.6 is unwelcome to an apologist of the other, and neither section could have been written to please a reader of either commitment.

D.3 · Sources, and how they were weighted

The two scriptures are the primary evidence and the only register permitted to seal. Every post-canonical interpretive corpus of every tradition enters as witness only, is noted where it corroborates and named where it diverges, and carries no conclusion. This applies evenhandedly: classical Quranic exegesis, patristic and conciliar literature, rabbinic material, and modern critical scholarship all stand downstream of the texts they gloss and are treated the same way. Where a grammatical observation is credited to a named scholar, the credit is for noticing the datum; the datum stands on the text.

Consensus carries no evidential weight in either direction. That a reading is standard is a fact about reception; that a reading is unusual is also a fact about reception. Neither is a fact about the text.

D.4 · What is not claimed

No historical claim is made that the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ read the Gospel of Mark. The reading device is stated as a device in the Prologue and is used as an organising position, licensed by the fact that the Quran performs an extensive reading of the same material.

No determination is made about the identity of ʿĪsā AS at the level the two traditions actually differ. That is not withheld as a courtesy. It is beyond the reach of the instrument used, for the reason set out at A.5, and an instrument returning a verdict there would be reporting its operator rather than its data.

No transmission claim is made anywhere. The convergence recorded at II.8 is convergence of independent strata on one architecture, which is evidence about the architecture and not about descent.

And no new philology, no new mathematics, and no new textual discovery is claimed. The contribution is the arrangement. Every ingredient is available to any reader with a concordance, a lexicon, and a standard grammar.

D.5 · The author's position

This commentary is uncomfortable for standard positions in at least two places, and both are named here rather than left for a reader to find.

The corpus applies to its own Word a set of attributes it applies to nothing created, and the community that noticed this drew the obvious inference and defended it at cost. The same community reads the Word-language about 'Īsā AS as though it carried no share of those attributes. That is two treatments of one term and no textual ground for the split has been offered here or elsewhere. Section II.4 states the problem and II.5 offers the resolution, which costs the received position nothing it needs: the attributes belong to the Word of Allah ﷻ in its residence, the casting proceeds from the Word that carries them and is an act rather than a transfer of the predicated item, and the vessel is a servant who ate food and named the day of his own death.

And Section V.6 marks seven places where the Gospel would be corrected, four of which are the same operation the corpus performs on itself. The corpus's own word for what it does to what came before it is custodian, at Q 5:48, standing over the earlier deposit while confirming it.

Finally, and in the register the author regards as governing everything above: the commentary issues no certificate, least of all to itself. Fa-lā tuzakkū anfusakum, huwa a'lamu bi-mani ttaqā. Do not certify your own purity; He knows best who guards himself.

APPENDIX E · GLOSSARY OF ARABIC AND GREEK TERMS

The non-English terms that carry argument in this commentary, with the sense each carries here. Arabic first, then Greek.

Arabic

aḥad · one, in the sense of one-without-a-second; the word used in negative constructions for not-a-single-one. Contrast wāḥid.

al-amr bi-l-ma'rūf wa-l-nahy 'an al-munkar · enjoining what is recognised as good and forbidding what is wrong.

amr · command, matter, affair. At Q 16:40 the creative command by which a thing comes to be.

aṣṣār · helpers, supporters. Used of the disciples at Q 3:52.

'abd · servant, bondsman. The first word 'Īsā AS speaks in the corpus, at Q 19:30, and the term Q 4:172 says the Messiah does not disdain.

awwāb · ever-returning, one who turns back repeatedly. The epithet of Ayyūb AS and of Dāwūd AS.

āya, plural **āyāt** · a sign; also a verse of the Quran.

barzakh · a partition or isthmus; a barrier passed one way only at Q 23:100, and two waters that meet without mixing at Q 55:19-20.

bayān · the faculty of between-making, of holding two things apart and registering the distinction. From the root of bayna, between. Given to the human at Q 55:4 and retained as a divine undertaking at Q 75:19.

bi-idhnī, bi-idhni Allāh · by My permission, by the permission of Allah ﷻ.

dhanb · offence, fault.

al-Furqān · the criterion, the splitter; from the root meaning to separate. A name of the revelation at Q 25:1 and a gift promised at Q 8:29.

ghayb · what is beyond the reach of sight or report; the unseen.

Ghafūr · the Covering One, from the root meaning to cover; the mighfar from the same root is the helmet.

ḥawāriyyūn · the disciples of 'Īsā AS.

ḥikma · wisdom.

ḥisāb · reckoning, counting. Bi-ghayri ḥisāb, without reckoning.

ikhtilāf · discrepancy, disagreement; the thing Q 4:82 challenges the reader to find and not find.

Injīl · the Gospel, treated by the corpus as a book given to 'Īsā AS.

kalima, plural **kalimāt** · word. Used of 'Īsā AS at Q 3:45 and Q 4:171 and of the divine speech at Q 18:109.

khalīfa · a successor entrusted with a charge; a delegated custodian.

khaṭī'a · a fault, a lapse; the word Ibrāhīm AS applies to himself at Q 26:82.

kibr · arrogance, self-magnification; its absence is the reason given at Q 5:82.

kitāb · book, writing, that which is inscribed. Kitāb mubīn, the distinguishing Book.

kufuw · an equal in rank, a peer.

mā'ida · a table set with food; the table requested at Q 5:114.

al-Masīḥ · the Messiah.

mīthāq ghalīz · a solemn covenant. Used of the prophets at Q 33:7 and of marriage at Q 4:21.

muhaymin · custodian, one who watches over and safeguards. Used of the Quran's relation to earlier scripture at Q 5:48.

muqarrabūn · those brought near.

muṣaddiq · one who confirms or attests. Taṣdīq is the act of confirming.

musakhkhar · made subject, placed under command; used of the sea at Q 45:12.

mujaddid · a renewer; a later term, not Quranic, noted at V.2.

muttaqīn · those who guard themselves; the shield-keepers. From the root meaning to shield.

nafs · the self, the soul; the bounded layer that tastes death at Q 3:185.

naskh · the supersession of an earlier ruling by a later one.

nasab · lineage, kinship; a relation between positions in a descent.

nuṭq · vocalisation, the physical production of speech. Predicated of birds and of all things, in contrast to bayān.

qurʿān · recitation, and also gathering, from a root carrying both senses.

rasūl · a sent one, a messenger.

rizq · provision, sustenance; not restricted to material food.

rūḥ · spirit, breath. Rūḥ al-Qudus, the Holy Spirit. Rūḥ al-Amīn, the Trustworthy Spirit.

ṣadaqa, ṣiddīqa · truthfulness; a woman of truth, used of Maryam AS at Q 5:75.

aṣ-Ṣamad · the solid without hollow; a divine name at Q 112:2.

shubbiha · it was made to resemble; from the root of mutashābihāt, the resembling verses of Q 3:7.

ṣuḥuf · scrolls, sheets; the scriptures of Ibrāhīm AS and Mūsā AS at Q 87:19.

sulṭān · authority, warrant, licence.

sūra, anglicised **surah** · a chapter of the Quran.

taqwā · guardedness; the practised habit of keeping oneself shielded.

tawaffā · to take in full, to receive back; used of the taking of a self at death and at sleep.

Tawrāt · the Torah.

wajh · face; what remains at Q 55:27, and never placed under the death-law.

wazīr · a support, one who bears a burden alongside; asked for by Mūsā AS at Q 20:29.

wāḥid · one, in the sense of first-of-a-count; a countable one. Contrast aḥad.

wahy · revelation given from above.

walad · a child in the generative sense, offspring; the term whose denial at Q 6:101 is explained by the absence of a consort.

yastankif · he disdains, he holds himself above; the verb denied of the Messiah at Q 4:172.

yatadabbar · to follow a thing through to its end, from the root for the back or outcome of a thing.

Zabūr · the Psalms.

Greek

anastenaxas tō pneumatī autou · groaning deeply within himself; Mark 8:12.

apolyō · to release, to unbind; the divorce verb at Mark 10:11, standing against synzeugnymi.

archē · beginning.

automatē · of itself, without an agent's intervention; Mark 4:28.

deō · to bind fast; the verb of the strong-man saying at Mark 3:27.

dei · it is necessary; the impersonal necessity of Mark 8:31.

diakoneō, diakonos · to wait at table, a table-servant.

dia ton anthrōpon · for the sake of the human; Mark 2:27.

doulos · a slave; the word Mark trades down to at Mark 10:44.

dynamis · power. Hē dynamis, the Power, used as a circumlocution for the divine name at Mark 14:62.

egō eimi · I am.

eikōn · image; the word on the coin at Mark 12:16.

ephobounto gar · for they were afraid; the last three words of Mark.

epitimaō · to rebuke with authority; Mark's silencing verb, used of unclean spirits, of the wind, and once in each direction between Peter and the one he follows.

euthys · immediately; Mark's characteristic adverb, roughly forty times.

hōs paidion · as a child.

huios tou anthrōpou · son of man; a citation of Daniel 7:13, where the figure is presented and given dominion.

klasmata · broken pieces, fragments.

kynaria · little dogs, household animals; the diminutive used at Mark 7:27, not the word for scavenging dogs.

logos · word, account, reasoned utterance.

lytron · a release-price, the sum paid to free a captive.

paidion · a young child.

prasiai prasiai · garden-plot by garden-plot; Mark's arrangement of the crowd at Mark 6:40.

prolambanō · to take in advance, to anticipate; Mark 14:8.

prōton · first, in sequence. The word that lets the Syrophoenician woman grant the order and deny the exclusion at Mark 7:27.

pros ton theon · toward God, in relation to God; John 1:1, a construction requiring two terms.

psychē · life, self, soul; one word carrying both senses at Mark 8:35-37.

schizō · to tear; used of the heavens at Mark 1:10 and of the temple curtain at Mark 15:38 and nowhere else in the book.

skēnē · a tent or shelter.

stasis · insurrection; the charge on which Barabbas was actually held.

sy legeis · you say it; Mark 15:2.

synzeugnymi · to yoke together; the joining verb at Mark 10:9, from zygos, a yoke.

thelō · I will, I am willing.

zymē · leaven.

APPENDIX F · INDEX OF PRINCIPAL QURANIC CITATIONS

Grouped by the function each verse performs in this commentary.

The fault-record. Q 2:37 · Q 7:23 · Q 7:143 · Q 7:150-151 · Q 9:114 · Q 11:46 · Q 11:78-80 · Q 12:24 · Q 12:42 · Q 12:67 · Q 12:84-86 · Q 18:73 · Q 20:93 · Q 20:115 · Q 20:121 · Q 21:87 · Q 26:14 · Q 26:82 · Q 27:20-22 · Q 28:15-16 · Q 37:140 · Q 38:24 · Q 38:31-34 · Q 38:44 · Q 68:48. And of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, at Q 8:67-68, Q 9:43, Q 17:73-75, Q 33:37, Q 40:55, Q 47:19, Q 48:2, Q 66:1, Q 80:1, and Q 94:2.

The two clean files. Q 3:39 · Q 3:45 · Q 4:163 · Q 4:171-172 · Q 5:46 · Q 5:116-117 · Q 6:85 · Q 19:7 · Q 19:12-15 · Q 19:19 · Q 19:30-33 · Q 43:59 · Q 87:19.

The Word: residence and predicates. Q 6:115 · Q 10:64 · Q 13:39 · Q 16:40 · Q 17:85 · Q 18:109 · Q 26:193-194 · Q 31:27 · Q 36:82 · Q 43:4 · Q 56:77-78 · Q 85:21-22 · Q 97:1.

The Christology, affirmed. Q 2:87 · Q 2:253 · Q 3:37 · Q 3:42 · Q 3:45-52 · Q 4:163 · Q 5:46 · Q 5:75 · Q 5:82 · Q 5:110 · Q 5:112-115 · Q 19:16-33 · Q 21:91 · Q 33:7 · Q 42:13 · Q 43:59 · Q 43:61 · Q 57:27 · Q 61:6 · Q 61:14 · Q 66:12.

The Christology, denied. Q 4:171 · Q 5:17 · Q 5:72 · Q 5:73 · Q 5:116 · Q 6:101 · Q 9:30 · Q 19:35 · Q 43:81 · Q 112:1-4.

The taking, the raising, and the layers. Q 2:156 · Q 3:9 · Q 3:55 · Q 3:185 · Q 4:87 · Q 4:157-158 · Q 5:117 · Q 6:12 · Q 6:22 · Q 10:28 · Q 11:123 · Q 18:47 · Q 25:58 · Q 28:88 · Q 39:42 · Q 55:26-27 · Q 57:3.

Transmission and comprehension. Q 6:50 · Q 7:188 · Q 10:15 · Q 18:65-82 · Q 20:114 · Q 46:9 · Q 53:3-4 · Q 69:44-46 · Q 75:16-19.

The faculty and the criterion. Q 2:2 · Q 2:53 · Q 4:82 · Q 8:29 · Q 8:41 · Q 12:1 · Q 25:1 · Q 26:2 · Q 27:1 · Q 27:16 · Q 28:2 · Q 41:21 · Q 43:2 · Q 44:2 · Q 55:1-4.

Signs, permission, and reception. Q 3:49 · Q 5:110 · Q 6:8-9 · Q 6:111 · Q 17:59 · Q 40:78 · Q 54:1-2.

Provision, mercy, and release. Q 3:37 · Q 6:12 · Q 6:54 · Q 7:156 · Q 24:22 · Q 39:53 · Q 65:3.

The counterfeit law and the sealed office. Q 3:144 · Q 25:58 · Q 33:40.

The bearer and the message. Q 2:87 · Q 3:144 · Q 6:34 · Q 9:32 · Q 61:8.

Register, rank, and the two words for one. Q 37:1-4 · Q 37:158 · Q 37:164-166 · Q 112:1-4.

Custody and continuity. Q 2:79 · Q 2:230 · Q 2:232 · Q 3:67 · Q 3:113 · Q 4:46 · Q 4:155 · Q 5:13 · Q 5:48 · Q 5:54 · Q 6:164 · Q 9:31 · Q 17:15 · Q 35:18 · Q 42:13 · Q 47:38.

REFERENCES

Three works are cited throughout. Everything else named in this commentary is identified in place.

The Gospel According to Mark. The Greek text as established in the modern critical editions, with the ending at Mk 16:8 in Codex Sinaiticus and Codex Vaticanus, and the longer ending of Mk 16:9-20 treated as a later addition on the grounds set out at V.1. Where a word carries the argument it is given in transliteration and glossed.

The Qurʾān. The received text in the ʿUthmānic recension, cited throughout as surah:verse. Renderings are the author's own, made to carry the grammatical feature under discussion rather than to serve as a devotional translation, and the Arabic is given wherever a rendering is doing work.

Islam, Mohammad F. Condensed Trisduction: A Linguistically, Topologically, and Mathematically Sealed Verification Architecture. Triaxial Orthogonality, Twelve-Gate Closure, the Quaternionic Completion. Zenodo, version 3, 29 July 2026. DOI 10.5281/zenodo.21664543, <https://zenodo.org/records/21664543>. Also deposited at PhilArchive, record ISLCTA, <https://philpapers.org/rec/ISLCTA>. The verification discipline whose method is set out from first principles in Appendix A and whose application to this commentary is disclosed in Appendix D.

The word is the seal. The geometry is the memory. The corrections are the receipt. And the silence over two names is not an elevation but a guard, so that the servanthood declared from the cradle would read as chosen.

Fa-lā tuzakkū anfusakum, huwa aʿlamu bi-mani ttaqā. Do not certify your own purity; He knows best who guards himself.